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SYSTEM AND METHOD FOR CARDIAC VALVE REPAIR

Abstract

A delivery device for cardiac valve repair implants includes a delivery catheter, a sheath extending around the delivery catheter and including a distal opening, and a control arm assembly releasably coupleable to a cardiac valve repair implant and configured to selectively expand the frame of the cardiac valve repair implant. The sheath is translatable relative to the delivery catheter and control arm assembly from a distal position to a proximal position and the control arm assembly is configured to be coupled to the cardiac valve repair implant such that, with the sheath in the distal position, a central occluder of the cardiac valve repair implant protrudes from the distal opening and a frame of the cardiac valve repair implant is retained within the sheath. In the former configuration, the occluder may provide a temporary nosecone for the delivery device.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS [0001] This application is a continuation-in-part of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/206,577, filed Jun. 6, 2023, titled “System and Method for Cardiac Valve Repair”. [0002] U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/206,577 is a continuation-in-part of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/550,660, filed Dec. 14, 2021, and titled “System and Method for Cardiac Valve Repair”. U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/206,577 is also related to and claims priority under 35 U.S.C. § 119(e) from U.S. Patent Application No. 63/349,222, filed Jun. 6, 2022, and titled “System and Method for Cardiac Valve Repair”. [0003] U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/550,660 is a continuation-in-part of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/227,847, filed Apr. 12, 2021, now U.S. Pat. No. 11,266,502 and titled “System and Method for Cardiac Valve Repair”. [0004] U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/227,847 is related to and claims priority under 35 U.S.C. § 119(e) from U.S. Patent Application No. 63/125,035, filed Dec. 14, 2020, and titled “System and Method for Cardiac Valve Repair”. [0005] The entire content of each of the foregoing applications is incorporated herein by reference for all purposes.

FIELD

[0006] The present disclosure relates to medical systems and methods for repairing a cardiac valve. More specifically, the present disclosure pertains to a cardiac valve repair implant that is minimally invasively deliverable and implantable via an associated minimally invasive delivery tool.

BACKGROUND

[0007] Cardiac valve regurgitation occurs when a cardiac valve does not close completely, causing blood to leak back through the valve. The causes of regurgitation may vary. Functional regurgitation is caused by changes to the heart geometry near the valve, where, for example, the heart enlarges, inducing both geometrical distortion around the valve annulus and insufficient leaflet coaptation during valve closure.

[0008] Degenerative regurgitation is caused by a disease of the valve itself, where, for example, the leaflets may thicken and be unable to seal completely. In both cases, the patient suffers because high-pressure blood in the ventricle regurgitates through the valve into the low-pressure venous system.

[0009] Surgical repair and replacement may successfully treat tricuspid and mitral regurgitation, but surgery is costly and traumatic. Specifically, the surgical treatments require general anesthesia, a stopped heart with extracorporeal bypass, and either valve replacement or repair. The surgical treatments require painful recovery over a period of approximately three weeks. As a result, surgical treatment is often not performed because cost, recovery time, pain, and, for older patients, mortality risk may be prohibitive.

[0010] Cardiac valves may also be repaired via percutaneous systems and methods. For example, a

percutaneous treatment may navigate a Nitinol clip between the valve leaflets to permanently clip the leaflets together. The percutaneous clip procedure results in a relatively pain-free recovery within days, and this procedure has successfully treated hundreds of thousands mitral regurgitation patients. Unfortunately, the percutaneous clip procedure is costly and difficult to perform, particularly by inexperienced operators. Further, the feasibility of the percutaneous clip procedure for the tricuspid valve is unproven and may be less effective in a three-leaflet valve. In addition, the mechanisms of valvular regurgitation are multiple and fixing a single mechanism of disease (e.g., leaflet grasping) may temporarily reduce the severity of regurgitation but not improve the natural history of the disease (e.g., deterioration over time).

[0011] Accordingly, there is a need for a system for repairing a cardiac valve that is simple to deliver, targets several disease components simultaneously, and improves overall results as compared to conventional treatments. There is also a need for a method of making such a repair.

SUMMARY

[0012] In one aspect of the present disclosure, a delivery device for cardiac valve repair implants is provided. The delivery device includes a delivery catheter, a sheath extending around the delivery catheter and including a distal opening, and a control arm assembly releasably coupleable to a cardiac valve repair implant and configured to selectively expand the frame of the cardiac valve repair implant. The sheath is translatable relative to the delivery catheter and control arm assembly from a distal position to a proximal position and the control arm assembly is configured to be coupled to the cardiac valve repair implant such that, with the sheath in the distal position, a central occluder of the cardiac valve repair implant protrudes from the distal opening and a frame of the cardiac valve repair implant is retained within the sheath. Among other benefits, in the former configuration, the occluder may provide a temporary nosecone for the delivery device during delivery of the implant to an implantation location.

[0013] In another aspect of the present disclosure, a cardiac valve repair system is provided. The system includes a cardiac valve repair having a central occluder and a frame extending proximally from and supporting the central occluder. The system further includes a delivery device including a delivery catheter, a sheath extending around the delivery catheter and including a distal opening, and a control arm assembly releasably coupled to the cardiac valve repair implant. The control arm assembly is configured to selectively expand the frame of the cardiac valve repair implant. The sheath is translatable relative to the delivery catheter and control arm assembly from a distal position to a proximal position such that, when the sheath is in the distal position, the central occluder protrudes from the distal opening and the frame is retained within the sheath.

[0014] In yet another aspect of the present disclosure, a method of repairing target cardiac valves is provided. The method includes delivering an implant in a collapsed state into an atrium adjacent a target cardiac valve where the implant includes a central occluder and a frame extending proximally from the central occluder and delivering the implant includes transporting the implant using a delivery device having a sheath that is selectively retractable such that, during delivery, the central occluder extends from a distal opening of the sheath while the frame is retained within the sheath. The method further includes deploying the implant by each of retracting the sheath and transitioning the implant into an expanded state. When in the expanded state, the central occluder and the frame form an annular structure defining an inner circular opening centered about a central longitudinal axis of the central occluder. The method also includes approaching the target cardiac valve with the implant in the expanded state and positioning each of the central occluder in an orifice of the target cardiac valve and a distal side of the annular structure against an annular region of cardiac tissue surrounding the target cardiac valve such that the inner circular opening opens over the orifice of the target cardiac valve.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0015] FIGS. **1A-1D** are illustrations of a system for repairing a cardiac valve, the system including a minimally invasive delivery tool and an implantable cardiac valve repair implant supported on a distal end of the delivery tool and that is deliverable and implantable via the delivery tool.

[0016] FIG. **2** is a perspective distal-side view of the implantable cardiac valve repair in an expanded state that is used when the implant is implanted in the cardiac valve.

[0017] FIG. **3** is a perspective proximal-side view of the implantable cardiac valve repair implant in the expanded state.

[0018] FIG. **4** is a perspective proximal-end view of the implantable cardiac valve repair implant in the expanded state.

[0019] FIG. **5** is a side elevation view of the implantable cardiac valve repair implant in the expanded state.

[0020] FIG. **6** is a distal plan view of the implantable cardiac valve repair implant in the expanded state.

[0021] FIG. **7** is a side elevation view of the implantable cardiac valve repair implant in a collapsed state.

[0022] FIG. **8** is an enlarged view of the distal region of the cardiac repair system of FIG. **1A**.

[0023] FIG. **9** is a side cross-sectional elevation view of a sheath of the delivery tool with the implantable cardiac valve repair implant maintained in the collapsed state by being confined within the sheath, the implant being coupled to a distal end of a catheter that extends through the sheath.

[0024] FIG. **10** is a view of the implantable cardiac valve repair implant implanted in a target cardiac valve, as viewed from an atrial position looking towards the valve and the ventricle chamber below.

[0025] FIGS. **11A-11C** are illustrations of a system for repairing a cardiac valve and, more specifically, a plan view, side elevation view, and a plan view illustrating a range of motion of a delivery tool of the system, respectively.

[0026] FIG. **12** is a distal plan view of an implantable cardiac valve repair implant in the expanded state and including a tension control line.

[0027] FIG. **13** is an illustration of an example implantable cardiac valve repair system in a disassembled configuration and including each of an implant and a delivery tool.

[0028] FIG. **14** is a side cross-sectional elevation view of a distal portion of the delivery tool of FIG. **13**.

[0029] FIG. **15** is a side cross-sectional elevation view of a distal portion of the delivery tool of FIG. **13** coupled to the implant.

[0030] FIG. **16** is a distal perspective view of the implant coupled to the delivery tool and in an expanded state.

[0031] FIG. **17** is a detailed view of a connection between the delivery tool and the tension control line of the implant and, more specifically connection between a tension control member of the delivery tool and the control line of the implant using a release line of the delivery tool.

[0032] FIG. **18** is a second detailed view of a connection between the delivery tool and the tension control line of the implant.

[0033] FIG. **19** is a plan view of the delivery tool illustrating protrusion of tension control members through a release catheter of the delivery tool.

[0034] FIG. **20** is a side cross-sectional view of the delivery tool coupled to the implant with the implant in an expanded configuration.

[0035] FIG. **21** is a side cross-sectional view of the delivery tool and the implant during release of the implant from the delivery tool.

[0036] FIG. **22** is a side cross-sectional view of the delivery tool and the implant following release of the implant from the delivery tool.

[0037] FIG. **23** is a side elevation view of a distal portion of an implant.

[0038] FIG. **24** is a side cross-sectional view of the distal portion of the implant of FIG. **23**.

[0039] FIG. **25** is a perspective distal-end view of an implant including an occlusive assembly having an inner sheet.

[0040] FIG. **26** is perspective proximal-end view of the implant of FIG. **25**.

[0041] FIG. **27** is perspective distal-end view of a proximally concave implant.

[0042] FIG. **28** is a perspective proximal-end view of the implant of FIG. **27**.

[0043] FIG. **29A** is a simplified elevation view of a proximally concave implant.

[0044] FIG. **29B** is a simplified elevation view of a distally concave implant.

[0045] FIG. **29C** is a simplified elevation view of an implant including a proximal portion having a proximally concave shape and a distal portion having a distally concave shape.

[0046] FIG. **30A** is a simplified elevation view of a frustoconical implant.

[0047] FIG. **30B** is a simplified elevation view of a planar implant.

[0048] FIG. **31** is a perspective distal-end view of an implant having a frame including arcuate petal portions connected by elongate longitudinal members.

[0049] FIG. **32** is a distal-end view of an implant having a frame including distally open arcuate petal portions.

[0050] FIG. **33** is a distal-end view of an implant having arcuate petal portions formed by arcuate members extending between longitudinal members.

[0051] FIG. **34** is a distal-end view of an implant having arcuate petal portions formed by arcuate members extending between longitudinal members and having an overall shape that includes a proximal portion having a proximally concave shape and a distal portion having a distally concave shape.

[0052] FIG. **35A** is a first distal-end view of an implant having arcuate petal portions formed by arcuate members extending between longitudinal members and having an overall shape that includes a proximal portion having a proximally concave shape and a distal portion having a distally concave shape.

[0053] FIG. **35B** is a second distal-end view of the implant of FIG. **35A** including each of inner and outer sheets.

[0054] FIG. **36** is a distal-end view of an alternative delivery device according to the present disclosure in a collapsed state.

[0055] FIG. **37** is a distal-end view of the delivery device of FIG. **36** in an expanded state.

[0056] FIG. **38** is a proximal view of a distal end of the delivery device of FIG. **36** including a valve repair implant coupled to the distal end of the delivery device.

[0057] FIGS. **39-44** are side views of the delivery device of FIG. **36** with various components removed to illustrate the internal construction of the delivery device.

[0058] FIG. **45A** is a side view of a distal end of the delivery device of FIG. **36** illustrating steerable sections of the delivery device.

[0059] FIGS. **45B** and **45C** are illustrations of the delivery device of FIG. **36** illustrating steering of a distal steering section of the delivery device.

[0060] FIGS. **45D** and **45E** are illustrations of the delivery device of FIG. **36** illustrating steering of a proximal steering section of the delivery device along a first plane.

[0061] FIGS. **45F-45H** are illustrations of the delivery device of FIG. **36** illustrating steering of the proximal steering section along a second plane, orthogonal to the first plane.

[0062] FIG. **46** is an illustration of a control assembly for steering the delivery device of FIG. **36**.

[0063] FIGS. **47-49** are detailed views of specific steering controls of the control assembly of FIG. **46**.

[0064] FIG. **50** is an illustration of a delivery device according to this disclosure with an implant coupled to a distal end and a sheath extended over the implant.

[0065] FIG. **51** is a radiographic image of a delivery device according to this disclosure including a

sheath with an embedded radiopaque marker.

[0066] FIGS. **52** and **53** are detailed views of a control assembly for selectively extending and retracting a sheath of the delivery device of FIG. **36**.

[0067] FIGS. **54A** and **54B** are illustrations of the distal end of the delivery device of FIG. **36** including a deployed implant in a fully extended and a de-extended/retracted configuration, respectively.

[0068] FIG. **55** is an illustration of a control assembly for use with the delivery device of FIG. **36**, the control assembly including controls for each of extending/retracting an extension member, expanding and collapsing a control arm assembly, and controlling tension of a cinch line.

[0069] FIG. **56** is a side view of a distal portion of the delivery device of FIG. **36** with a control arm assembly in a collapsed state.

[0070] FIG. **57** is a detailed side view of a distal portion of the delivery device of FIG. **36** with the control arm assembly in an expanded state.

[0071] FIG. **58** is a detailed view of the delivery device showing coupling of a proximal and distal arm of the control arm assembly.

[0072] FIG. **59** is a detailed view illustrating coupling of an implant to the control arm assembly via a cinch line.

[0073] FIG. **60** is an illustration of a control assembly of a delivery device according to the present disclosure.

[0074] FIG. **61** is an illustration of a control assembly and mount for use with delivery devices of the present disclosure.

[0075] FIG. **62** is a flow chart illustrating a method of implanting a valve repair implant using a delivery device according to this disclosure.

[0076] FIG. **63A** is a proximal-side perspective view of another implant according to the present disclosure.

[0077] FIG. **63B** is a distal-side perspective view of the implant of FIG. **63A**.

[0078] FIGS. **63C** and **63D** are distal views of the implant of FIG. **63A**.

[0079] FIGS. **64A-C** are isometric, distal-side, and side elevation views of a frame of the implant of FIG. **63A**.

[0080] FIGS. **64D** and **64E** are additional views of the implant of FIG. **63A** indicating the location of specific structures of the implant.

[0081] FIG. **64F** is a detailed view of a spoke of the frame of FIGS. **64A-64E**.

[0082] FIG. **64G** is a detailed view of an anchor member of the frame of FIGS. **64A-64E**,

[0083] FIGS. **64H** and **64I** are detailed views of an outer petal portion of the frame of FIGS. **64A-64E**.

[0084] FIG. **64J** is a detailed view of inner petal portions of the frame of FIGS. **64A-64E**.

[0085] FIG. **64K** is a detailed view of outer petal portions of the frame of FIGS. **64A-64E**.

[0086] FIGS. **64L** and **64M** are dimensioned side views of the frame of FIGS. **64A-64E**.

[0087] FIG. **64N** is a detailed and dimensioned side view of a spoke of the frame of FIGS. **64A-64E**.

[0088] FIGS. **65A** and **65B** are a distal view and a proximal-side perspective view, respectively of a laminated occluder.

[0089] FIG. **65C** is a distal-side isometric view of the frame of FIGS. **64A-64E** with the laminated occluder attached.

[0090] FIG. **65D** is an exploded view of the frame and laminated occluder of FIG. **65C**.

[0091] FIGS. **65E** and **F** are dimensioned distal and elevation views of the frame and laminated occluder of FIG. **65C**.

[0092] FIG. **66A** is a distal-side perspective view of an alternative laminated occluder including a proximally convex back.

[0093] FIG. **66B** is a proximal-side perspective view of the alternative laminated occluder of FIG.

66A.

[0094] FIG. **67A** is an elevation view of the implant of FIG. **63A** illustrating an outer sheet coupled to the implant frame.

[0095] FIGS. **67B-D** are detailed views of the coupling between the outer sheet and frame of the implant of FIG. **63A**.

[0096] FIG. **68** illustrates the outer sheet prior to attachment to the frame.

[0097] FIG. **69A** is a proximal-side perspective view of the implant of FIG. **63A** illustrating eyelets distributed about the frame of the implant.

[0098] FIG. **69B** is a detailed view of the implant of FIG. **63A** further illustrating eyelets of the implant.

[0099] FIGS. **70** and FIGS. **71A-71C** are views of the eyelets of FIGS. **69A-69B**.

[0100] FIG. **72** is a detailed view of a junction of the frame of the implant of FIG. **63A** including a slot for receiving an eyelet.

[0101] FIGS. **73A** and **73B** are cross-sectional views of the implant of FIG. **63A** illustrating coupling of the eyelet to the frame with FIG. **73B** further illustrating coupling of the implant to a delivery device control arm.

[0102] FIG. **74** is an elevation view of an example delivery system and implant, the delivery system including a catheter assembly.

[0103] FIG. **75** is an elevation view of an internal tubular member of the catheter assembly of FIG. **74**.

[0104] FIGS. **76A-76D** are detailed views of specific sections of the internal tubular member of FIG. **75**.

[0105] FIGS. **77A** and **77B** are perspective views of a mounting assembly and delivery system illustrating insertion of the delivery system.

[0106] FIGS. **78A-78C** are additional views of the mounting assembly and delivery system of FIGS. **77A** and **77B** illustrating rotation of the delivery system.

[0107] FIGS. **79A** and **79B** are elevation views of a handle assembly and a distal end of a delivery system illustrating distal extension of an implant coupled to the delivery system.

[0108] FIGS. **79C** and **79D** are elevation views of the handle assembly and the distal end of the delivery system illustrating distal retraction of the implant coupled to the delivery system.

[0109] FIGS. **80A** and **80B** are internal views of the handle assembly in the extended and retracted states, respectively.

[0110] FIGS. **81A** and **81B** are elevation views of the handle assembly and the distal end of the delivery system illustrating the system in a collapsed state.

[0111] FIGS. **81C** and **81D** are elevation views of the handle assembly and the distal end of the delivery system illustrating the system in an expanded state.

[0112] FIG. **82A** is an internal view of the handle assembly in the collapsed state.

[0113] FIG. **82B** is a detailed view of a cinch line mechanism of the handle assembly.

[0114] FIG. **82C** is an internal view of the handle assembly in the expanded state.

[0115] FIGS. **83A-83H** are proximal views of an implant coupled to a delivery system during progressive stages of an implant release sequence.

[0116] FIG. **84** is a perspective view of a handle assembly including a control ring for releasing an implant from a delivery system.

[0117] FIGS. **85A** and **85B** are internal views of the handle assembly of FIG. **84**.

[0118] FIG. **85C** is a proximal internal view of the handle assembly of FIG. **84**.

[0119] FIGS. **86A-86D** proximal internal views of the handle assembly of FIG. **84** during progressive stages of an implant release sequence.

[0120] FIG. **87A** is an isometric view of a mounting assembly for use with delivery devices according to this disclosure.

[0121] FIG. **87B** is an isometric view of a handle mount assembly of the mounting assembly of

FIG. 87A.

[0122] FIG. 87C is a detailed view of a rail assembly of the of the mounting assembly of FIG. 87A.

[0123] FIGS. 87D and 87E are isometric views of a rail assembly, carriage assembly, and interface of the mounting assembly of FIG. 87A in a decoupled state.

[0124] FIGS. 87F and 87G are isometric views of an interface block of the mounting assembly of FIG. 87A in a disengaged and engage state, respectively.

[0125] FIGS. 87H and 87I are perspective views of the mounting assembly of FIG. 87A including a sterile drape.

[0126] FIGS. 87J and 87K are isometric views of a carriage assembly of the mounting assembly of FIG. 87A.

[0127] FIG. 87L is a detailed view of the carriage assembly as shown in FIG. 87K.

[0128] FIG. 87M is an isometric view of a yoke of the mounting assembly of FIG. 87A.

[0129] FIG. 87N is an isometric view of a structural coupling of the mounting assembly of FIG. 87A.

[0130] FIG. 88A is an isometric view of a distal portion of a delivery device and implant according to an implementation of this disclosure.

[0131] FIG. 88B is the view of FIG. 88A with select components removed to better illustrate a control arm assembly.

[0132] FIG. 88C is a side elevation view of the control arm assembly of FIG. 88B.

[0133] FIGS. 88D and 88E are detailed views of a joint between control arms of the control arm assembly of FIG. 88B.

[0134] FIG. 88F is a partially dimensioned side view of the control arm assembly of FIG. 88B.

[0135] FIG. 89 is a side view of the distal portion of the delivery device of FIG. 88A with the control arm assembly in a collapsed and retracted configuration.

[0136] FIG. 90 is a flow chart illustrating an example method of delivering a cardiac valve repair implant according to this disclosure.

[0137] FIGS. 91A and 91B are a proximal and detailed view of an alternative control arm assembly for a delivery device according to this disclosure.

[0138] FIGS. 92A and 92B are a proximal and detailed view of an alternative control arm assembly for a delivery device according to this disclosure and including unitary control arms.

[0139] FIGS. 93A-93D are illustrations of yet another alternative control arm assembly for a delivery device according to this disclosure including unitary, wire-based control arms.

[0140] FIGS. 94A-94E are cross-sectional views of a delivery system for an implant according to this disclosure at different stages of a delivery procedure with FIG. 94A specifically illustrating the user of a central occluder of an implant as a nosecone for the delivery system.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0141] For a brief overview of the cardiac valve repair system 10 disclosed herein, reference is made to FIGS. 1A-1D. In particular, FIG. 1A is an illustration of the cardiac valve repair system 10 while FIGS. 1B-1D are isometric, plan, and side elevation views, respectively of the valve repair system 10. As can be understood from FIG. 1A, the system 10 includes a delivery and deployment tool 15 and an implantable cardiac valve repair device or implant 20 supported on a distal end 25 of the tool 15. The tool 15 includes a proximal end 30 opposite the tool distal end 25. The tool proximal end 30 includes a control handle 35 used by a physician to manipulate the tool 15 in positioning the implant 20 at the target site and deploying the implant 20 within the target site, which is a cardiac valve in need of repair, as discussed in detail later in this Detailed Description. In one embodiment, the tool 15 is used for minimally invasive delivery and deployment of the implant 20 in the cardiac valve in need of repair.

[0142] The system and its implant are advantageous in that the implant may be delivered and deployed at the target site via an antegrade percutaneous route (e.g., a trans-femoral or trans-jugular route) with the patient consciously sedated during the procedure. It is anticipated the

implantation stage may take less than 60 minutes, and the implant and delivery system will have a cost substantially less expensive than prior cardiac valve repair systems. Finally, the regurgitation grade afforded by a cardiac valve repair completed via the implant **20** disclosed herein will be 2+ or lower. Accordingly, the cardiac repair system **10** is a significant improvement over prior art systems as it is atraumatic, materially less expensive and less time intensive, all while providing a significant improvement in the reduction of regurgitation.

I. CARDIAC VALVE REPAIR IMPLANT

[0143] To begin a detailed discussion of the cardiac valve repair implant **20**, reference is made to FIGS. 2-6, which are various views of an embodiment of the implant **20** when the implant is in an expanded state that exists when the implant is implanted in the cardiac valve to be repaired. As illustrated in these figures, the implant includes distal end **40** and a proximal end **45**. The distal end **40** serves as the leading end of the implant **20** during implantation, as can be understood from FIG. 1A-1D.

[0144] As illustrated in FIGS. 2-6, the implant **20** further includes a central occluder **50**, a frame **55** and a thin sheet **60** (also referred to herein as a thin layer **60**) supported on the frame. The frame **55** extends proximally from a proximal end **65** of the central occluder **50**. When in the expanded state, the frame **55** radiates laterally outwardly relative to a central longitudinal axis **70** (see FIG. 5) of the implant **20**, and the thin sheet **60** forms an annular surface **62** supported on the expanded frame **55**.

[0145] The annular surface **62** has a distal radially inward edge **63** and a proximal radially outward edge **64**. The distal radially inward edge **63** defines a central opening **66** in the thin sheet **60** and the implant **20**. The proximal radially outward edge **64** forms the extreme proximal radially outward boundary of this embodiment of the implant when in the expanded state. The central longitudinal axis **70** passes through the extreme distal tip **75** of the central occluder **50** and a center point **80** (see FIG. 4) of the proximal end **65** of the central occluder. In light of the foregoing and in at least certain embodiments, the frame **55** is generally designed to sit on the floor of the atrium, to induce annular reduction, and to produce a neo-annulus.

[0146] As can be understood from FIGS. 2-6, in addition to being annular, the annular surface **62** may also be conical, or relatively so (e.g., parabolic), such that its proximal side, which faces the atrial chamber when the implant **20** is implanted in the target cardiac valve as depicted in FIG. 10, serves as a funnel arrangement distally leading from the atrial chamber towards the central opening **66** of the implant **20** and the valve opening distal the central opening **66**. Similarly, the distal side of the annular surface **62** may also be conical to generally make mating surface contact with the semi-conical regions of the atrial wall surface and surrounding annular region of the target cardiac valve, as can be understood from FIG. 10.

[0147] When in the collapsed state, as depicted in FIG. 7, which is a side view of the implant collapsed to allow its delivery to the target site via the tool **15**, the frame **55** and thin sheet **60** collapse symmetrically about the central longitudinal axis **70**. Thus, a comparison of the implant **20** in FIGS. 2-6 when in the expanded state to the implant **20** in FIG. 7 in the collapsed state indicates that the implant can transition from the collapsed state to the expanded state similar to an umbrella.

[0148] As can be understood from FIG. 9 and discussed in greater detail later in this Detailed Disclosure, during delivery, the implant **20** is maintained in the collapsed state of FIG. 7 by the tool **15** so as to allow the implant to be negotiated through the patient vascular system and into an atrial chamber of the heart for implantation of the implant within a target cardiac valve. For example, with the implant **20** maintained in the collapsed state by virtue of being confined within a tubular sheath **76** of the delivery tool **15**, the implant may be delivered and deployed at the target site via an antegrade percutaneous route (e.g., an antegrade trans-femoral or trans-jugular route) with the patient consciously sedated during the procedure.

[0149] Upon being properly positioned in the target cardiac valve for repair, the physician actuates the tool **15** such that the tool no longer maintains the implant **20** in the collapsed state, as can be

understood from FIG. 1A. Since the frame 55 of the implant 20 is biased to self-expand into the expanded state of FIGS. 2-6, the implant self-expands into the expanded state to anchor itself within the target cardiac valve and reduce regurgitation, as shown in FIG. 10.

[0150] Returning to FIGS. 2-6, it can be understood that the central occluder 50 may take the form of a bullet or conical shape. In doing so, the central occluder may have a cylindrical side 85 extending distally from the central occluder proximal end 65 and then transitioning to a bullnose 90 that distally extends to the central occluder extreme distal tip 75. Such a bullet or conical shape results in the central occluder 50 being atraumatic for delivery and implantation purposes. Further, such a shape facilitates the cylindrical side 85 of the central occluder substantially sealing against the cardiac valve leaflets, thereby materially reducing, if not eliminating, central regurgitation past the cardiac valve leaflets.

[0151] Without limitation and depending on the embodiment, the central occluder 50 may be formed from polytetrafluoroethylene (PTFE), polyether ether ketone (PEEK), acetal, silicone, nylon, polyethylene, polypropylene, polyethylene terephthalate (PET), polyurethane, or other thermoplastic elastomers. In certain embodiments, the material of the central occluder 50 may be angio- and/or echolucent.

[0152] In certain embodiments, the central occluder 50 may be filled with saline, a combination of saline with a radio-opaque contrast agent, or other fluid. In such embodiments, the central occluder 50 may be delivered in a first configuration having a reduced diameter and then expanded into a second configuration having an increased diameter by introducing fluid into the central occluder 50 following delivery. The amount of saline delivered during implantation may be determined in real-time, for example, by monitoring a size of the central occluder 50, e.g., using an X-ray image, and/or by monitoring a reduction of regurgitation, e.g., using ultrasound imaging.

[0153] In certain embodiments and without limitation, the central occluder 50 may be formed from a material having a durometer from and including 10A to and including 100D, from and including 10D to and including 100D, or from and including 40D to and including 80D. In one specific embodiment, the material of the central occluder 50 has a durometer of 80D. As indicated in FIG. 5, the central occluder may have an overall diameter DO that, in certain embodiments and without limitation, may be between approximately 5 millimeters (mm) and approximately 25 mm, between approximately 5 mm and approximately 15 mm, or between approximately 8 mm and approximately 12 mm. The central occluder 50 further has an overall length LO from its proximal end 65 to its extreme distal tip 75 that, in certain embodiments and without limitation, may be between approximately 5 mm and approximately 40 mm or between approximately 10 mm and approximately 20 mm. The bullnose 90 may have a length LB that, in certain embodiments and without limitation, may be between approximately 2.5 mm and approximately 12.5 mm, between approximately 2.5 mm and approximately 7.5 mm, or between approximately 4 mm and approximately 6 mm. In certain embodiments and without limitation, the radius of curvature R of the bullnose 90 may be between approximately 2.5 mm and approximately 12.5 mm, between approximately 2.5 mm and approximately 7.5 mm, or between approximately 4 mm and approximately 6 mm. The general shape of the bullnose 90 may also vary across embodiments. For example, the bullnose 90 may have any of a parabolic profile, a conical profile, a spherical profile, or any other atraumatic profile. In other example embodiments, the bullnose 90 may have a trihedral, frustoconical shape, or other non-rounded shape. In certain example embodiments, the central occluder 50 may have a triangular or tri-lobe shape that provides surfaces for sealing against respective leaflets. In yet another example, the central occluder 50 may have a rounded double-concave shape. In still other embodiments, the central occluder 50 may be configured to allow distention of a distal portion of the frame 55, thereby facilitating reintervention (e.g., valve implantation). In yet other embodiments, the central occluder 50 may include a frame (e.g., inner struts) covered in a flexible material, such as, but not limited to expanded polytetrafluoroethylene (ePTFE), polyester fabric, or a similar material. In such embodiments, the flexible covering may

allow the central occluder **50** to be compressed for delivery but to expand once positioned in the native valve to occlude and reduce regurgitation.

[0154] As can be understood from FIG. 5, in one embodiment, the central occluder **50** may have an overall diameter DO of approximately 10 mm, and its overall length LO may be approximately 16 mm. Additionally, the bullnose **90** may have an overall length LB of approximately 5 mm, and the radius of curvature of the bullnose **90** may or may not gradually transition over its length LB from proximal to distal. For example, the radius of curvature R may have a maximum value from approximately 2.5 mm to approximately 15 mm as measured from a center of curvature C to the distal tip **75** of the central occluder **50** but may transition to a radius of curvature R that is between approximately 2.5 mm and approximately 10 mm, but less than or equal to the maximum, at a location proximal the distal tip **75**. In one embodiment, however, the bullnose **90** may have a constant radius of curvature of approximately 5 mm.

[0155] As can be understood from FIGS. 2-6, the thin sheet **60** is supported on the frame **55** and secured thereto. For example and without limitation, in certain embodiments the thin sheet **60** may be secured to the frame **55** by suturing the skirt against an inner surface and/or an outer surface of the frame **55**. In other implementations, the thin sheet **60** may include a cuff or similar folded structure that is folded over an end of the frame **55**. In still other implementations, the thin sheet **60** may be secured to the frame by sewing, welding, gluing/adhering, stapling, or any other suitable securement method or combination of securement methods. Depending on the embodiment, the thin sheet **60** may be on the distal side of the frame **55**, the proximal side, or both such that the frame extends through and along the thin sheet. In one embodiment, the frame **55** is covered with a thin sheet **60** on the distal side of the frame where the frame contacts atrial tissue when the implant **20** is implanted in the target cardiac valve.

[0156] Depending on the embodiment, the thin sheet **60** may be formed of or include a woven or knit material or fabric that encourages tissue ingrowth. The porosity of the fabric of the thin sheet **60** assists in reducing commissural tricuspid regurgitation. Further reduction of commissural tricuspid regurgitation is provided by the angulation of the frame **55**, which provides close contact with the commissures in a circumferential manner. For example, with the implant **20** implanted in the target cardiac valve, tissue in-growth into the fabric of the thin sheet **60** buttresses the myocardium, helping to keep the tissue from expanding further and reducing the potential of future regurgitation.

[0157] The fabric can be made from various methods, i.e. knitting, weaving, single or multiple layers. These fabrics can be laminated together with a polymer to make a composite structure, i.e. two pieces of knit (high porosity) with a polymer coating like silicone or urethane. Example materials for the woven or knit materials may include, without limitation, polyester, polypropylene, polyethylene, etc. The thin layer **60** may have a material thickness of between approximately 0.03 mm and approximately 1 mm, between approximately 0.05 mm and approximately 0.2 mm, or between approximately 0.07 mm and approximately 0.12 mm. In one example embodiment, the thickness of the thin layer **60** is approximately 0.2 mm. In another example embodiment, the thickness of the thin layer **60** is approximately 0.55 mm. In one embodiment, an additional textile layer may be added on the proximal side of the thin sheet **60** to create a smooth surface to minimize clot formation in an atrial chamber immediately adjacent the cardiac valve in which the implant **20** is implanted.

[0158] As indicated in FIGS. 5, 6 and 7, the thin sheet **60** has an outer diameter DS. In certain embodiments, the outer diameter DS may be between approximately 40 mm and approximately 80 mm, between approximately 50 mm and approximately 70 mm, or between approximately 55 mm and approximately 65 mm. The thin sheet **60** has a radial width RW. In certain embodiments, the radial width RW may be between approximately 10 mm and approximately 30 mm, between approximately 13 mm and approximately 23 mm, or between approximately 17 mm and approximately 19 mm. The thin sheet **60** has a central opening **66** with an inner diameter DI. In

certain embodiments, the inner diameter DI may be between approximately 20 mm and approximately 60 mm, between approximately 25 mm and approximately 45 mm, or between approximately 28 mm and approximately 32 mm. For example, in one embodiment, the thin sheet **60** has an outer diameter DS of approximately 60 mm, a radial width RW of approximately 18.2 mm, and a central opening **66** with an inner diameter DI of approximately 30 mm. Due to its configuration, when the implant **20** is implanted in the target cardiac valve, the circumferential fabric of the thin sheet **60** covers a portion of the outer leaflet commissures to block leaks at the edges of the commissures.

[0159] As shown in FIGS. 2-6, the frame **55** includes spokes **95**, arcuate petal portions **100** and protruding anchor members **105**. The frame **55** may be made from a variety of super-elastic and/or shape memory materials, including, for example, nickel-titanium alloys (e.g., Nitinol), which may be laser cut from a tube or in the form of drawn wire. The features defined in the shape memory materials may be defined therein via various cutting methods known in the art, include laser, water jet, electrical discharge machining (EDM), stamping, etching, milling, etc.

[0160] In one embodiment, the frame **55** is made of super-elastic, shape memory nickel titanium alloy (e.g., Nitinol). Regardless of which shape memory material is employed, the shape memory aspects of the frame **55** allow the frame and, as a result, the implant **20** to self-bias from the collapsed state (see FIG. 7) to the expanded state (see FIGS. 2-6) when not physically maintained in the collapsed state by the delivery tool **15**.

[0161] In various embodiments, the frame **55**, central occluder **50** and the rest of the implant **20** remain implanted as a unit in the target cardiac valve. In other words, the implant **20** is implanted and remains so as configured in FIGS. 2-6.

[0162] There may be situations where it is desirable to remove the central occluder and then implant a replacement valve in the target cardiac valve. Accordingly, in alternate embodiments, the central occluder **50** and frame spokes or struts **95** may be removable after implantation, leaving the surrounding annular surface **62** of the implant in place, the annular surface **62** being formed by and including the frame arcuate petal portions **100** and the thin sheet **60** supported thereon. In such embodiments, a circumferential suture connection may exist between the spokes **95** and the rest of the frame **55** radially outward of the spokes **95**. Thus, this circumferential suture connection may be cut and the central occluder **50** and its spokes **95** may be removed through a catheter, leaving the annular portion of the implant, which then acts as an “annuloplasty” frame.

[0163] As indicated in FIG. 7, when the implant **20** is in the collapsed state, the spokes **95** proximally extend from the proximal end **65** of the central occluder **50** to the arcuate petal portions **100**. In doing so, the spokes **95** are substantially parallel with, and extend along and near to, the central longitudinal axis **70** of the implant **20**. As can be understood from FIG. 7, when the implant is in the collapsed state, each spoke **95** has a length L from the central occluder proximal end **65** to a distal boundary of an arcuate petal portion **100**. In certain embodiments, the length L may be between approximately 10 mm and approximately 40 mm or between approximately 15 mm and approximately 22 mm, with one embodiment having a length L of approximately 19 mm. As indicated in FIG. 7, the frame **55** in the collapsed state thus has an overall length OL that is the sum of the length L (shown in FIG. 7) and the radial width RW (shown in FIGS. 5 and 7), the candidate dimensions for the radial width RW being as discussed above with respect to FIG. 5.

[0164] As shown in FIGS. 2-6, when the implant **20** is in the expanded state, the spokes **95** proximally extend from the central occluder proximal end **65** and laterally radiate away from the central longitudinal axis **70** of the implant **20** to the arcuate petal portions **100**. In doing so, the spokes **95** have a radius of curvature RC of between approximately 5 mm and approximately 20 mm, between approximately 10 mm and approximately 18 mm, or between approximately 15 mm and approximately 16 mm with one embodiment having a radius of curvature RC of approximately 15 mm, as can be understood from FIG. 5.

[0165] Depending on the embodiment, the frame **55** may include between approximately 3 and

approximately 15 spokes **95**. In certain embodiments, the number of spokes **95** and gaps therebetween may be selected to facilitate passage of other tools and devices past the frame **55**. [0166] Embodiments may include spokes **95** with various cross-sectional shapes; however, in at least certain embodiments, spokes **95** have an annular sector cross-sectional shape, such as illustrated in Inset A-A of FIG. **6**. In such embodiments, the cross-sectional shape of the spokes **95** may be defined by each of a strut width SW (defined as the maximum width of the spoke) and a wall thickness WT of the spokes **95**. The spokes **95** may be further defined by a cross-sectional radius of curvature CSR as measured to a centerline CL of each spoke. In certain implementations, the wall thickness WT may be between approximately 0.2 mm and 0.8 mm, between approximately 0.3 mm and approximately 0.7 mm, or between approximately 0.4 mm and approximately 0.6 mm. In addition, in certain implementations, the spokes **95** may conform to certain spoke aspect ratios, which, in the context of the spokes **95** refers to the ratio of the wall thickness WT to the strut width SW. For example, and without limitation, embodiments may have a spoke aspect between 4:0.5 and 1:2, between 3:1 and 1:1.2, or between 2:1 and 1:1. In embodiments, the cross-sectional radius of curvature CSR may be between approximately 2 mm and approximately 6 mm, between approximately 3 mm and approximately 5 mm, or between approximately 3.5 mm and approximately 5 mm. In one particular embodiment, the frame **55** is made of Nitinol and the frame **55** has 12 spokes **95**, with each spoke **95** having a wall thickness WT of approximately 0.46 mm, an aspect ratio of approximately 2:1 (resulting in a strut width SW of approximately 0.23 mm), and a cross-sectional radius of curvature CSR of approximately 5 mm. In certain embodiments, the spokes **95** may be arranged such that they extend distally from the frame **55** at an angle such that the thin sheet **60** occludes coaptation gaps. In certain embodiments of the present disclosure, each of the spokes **95** may be dimensionally identical; however, in other embodiments, one or more of the spokes **95** may differ in any of the various characteristics noted above.

[0167] As illustrated in FIGS. **2-6**, each arcuate petal portion **100** is located between a pair of spokes **95** and forms a section of the circumference of a radially outward half of the expanded frame **55**. As can be understood from FIG. **5**, unlike the spokes **95**, which are curved in the expanded state, the arcuate petal portions **100** in the expanded state are generally straight in a laterally radiating direction and have approximately the same radial width RW as that of the thin sheet **60**. Each petal portion **100** has an outer arcuate member **110** and an inner arcuate member **115**, both of which point radially outward. These arcuate members **110**, **115** intersect at a junction portion **120** that extends from a respective spoke **95** and surrounds a protruding anchor member **105** that distally projects from a distal side of its junction portion **120**.

[0168] Depending on the embodiment, the frame **55** may include different numbers of petal portions **100**. For example, in certain example embodiments, the frame **55** may include between 3 and 18 petal portions **100**, between 6 and 15 petal portions **100**, or between 10 and 14 petal portions **100**. In one embodiment, the frame **55** has 12 petal portions **100**. Similarly, the frame **55** may include different numbers of protruding anchor members **105**. For example, in certain example embodiments, the frame **55** may include between 6 and 60 protruding anchor members **105**, between 12 and 36 protruding anchor members **105**, or between 18 and 30 protruding anchor members **105**. In one embodiment, the frame **55** has 24 protruding anchor members **105**.

[0169] The frame **55** engages the atrial tissue via the protruding anchor members **105**, which may be in the form of small barbs. The protruding anchor members **105** are designed to securely engage the atrial tissue without penetrating through the tissue or to the coronary vessels. Depending on the embodiment, the protruding anchor members or barbs **105** may be curved to slide before engaging tissue. There may be one row or multiple rows of retention barbs **105**.

[0170] As indicated in the enlarged view of a junction portion **120** of FIG. **6**, each protruding anchor member **105** is defined in the surrounding junction portion **120** via a slot **125** that extends around the protruding anchor member **105** such that the anchor member **105** is peninsular in the surrounding junction portion **120**. A radially inward end **105A** extends uninterrupted to the rest of

the surrounding junction portion **120** and is opposite a radially outward free end **105B** of the anchor member **105**, the radially outward free end **105B** forming a tip of the protruding anchor member **105**. As can be understood from FIGS. **2**, **3** and **5**, the radially outward free end of the anchor member projects distally from the rest of the frame **55**.

[0171] Depending on the embodiment, each protruding anchor member **105** may have a length of between approximately 0.5 mm and approximately 6 mm, between approximately 1 mm and 4 mm, or between approximately 1 mm and approximately 3 mm. Similar to the spokes **95**, the protruding anchor members **105** may have various cross-sectional shapes. In at least certain embodiments, the protruding anchor members **105** have an annular sector cross-sectional shape, similar to that discussed above in the context of the spokes **95** and as illustrated in Inset A-A of FIG. **6** and which is referenced for purposes of the following discussion. Like the spokes **95**, the cross-sectional shape of the protruding anchor members **105** may be defined by each of a strut width SW (defined as the maximum width of the spoke) and a wall thickness WT. The protruding anchor members **105** may be further defined by a cross-sectional radius of curvature CSR as measured to a centerline CL of each anchor member. In certain implementations, the wall thickness WT may be between approximately 0.2 mm and 0.8 mm, between approximately 0.3 mm and approximately 0.7 mm, or between approximately 0.4 mm and approximately 0.6 mm. In addition, in certain implementations, the protruding anchor members **105** may conform to certain aspect ratios between the wall thickness WT to the strut width SW. For example, and without limitation, protruding anchor members **105** according to certain embodiments may have an aspect between 4:0.5 and 1:2, between 3:1 and 1:1.2, or between 2:1 and 1:1. In certain embodiments, the cross-sectional radius of curvature CSR may be between approximately 2 mm and approximately 6 mm, between approximately 3 mm and approximately 5 mm, or between approximately 3.5 mm and approximately 5 mm. Each protruding anchor member **105** has a wall thickness WT of approximately 0.46 mm, an aspect ratio of approximately 2:1 (resulting in a strut width SW of approximately 0.23 mm), a cross-sectional radius of curvature CSR of approximately 5 mm, and a length of approximately 1.5 mm. In certain embodiments of the present disclosure, each of the protruding anchor members **105** may be dimensionally identical; however, in other embodiments, one or more of the protruding anchor members **105** may differ in any of the various characteristics noted above.

[0172] In one embodiment, as can be understood from FIGS. **2**, **3** and **5**, the protruding anchor members or barbs **105** are oriented distally and radially outward. As a result, as the frame **55** is pushed towards the ventricle, the anchor members **105** slide along the atrial tissue. Ventricular pressure pushes the implant **20** towards the atrium, embedding the anchors or barbs **105** into the atrial tissue.

[0173] In an alternate embodiment, the anchors or barbs **105** are directionally reversed such that they project distally and radially inward. In this alternative embodiment, the delivery system over-expands the frame **55** during delivery and when the frame is released from the delivery system with the frame **55** in contact with tissue, the anchors or barbs **105** engage the atrial tissue as the frame **55** contracts to its relaxed state.

II. DELIVERY TOOL AND METHOD OF IMPLANTATION

[0174] As illustrated in FIGS. **1A-1D**, the delivery tool **15** includes a proximal end **30**, a distal end **25** opposite the proximal end, a control handle **35**, a tubular sheath **76**, and a catheter **77**. The control handle **35** extends distally from the proximal end **30** and is used by a physician to manipulate the tool **15** in positioning the implant **20** at the target site and deploying the implant **20** within the target cardiac valve in need of repair. The sheath **76** and catheter **77** extend distally away from the control handle **35** towards the distal end **25** of the tool **15**. The catheter **77** extends longitudinally through the sheath **76**, the distal end **25** of the catheter **77** forming the distal end **25** of the tool **15**. The sheath **76** is used to minimize tissue trauma while the catheter **77** and implant **20** are advanced to the implantation site. Thus, the delivery tool **15** is designed to deliver the implant

20 to the implantation site, position the implant in the target cardiac valve, and control the opening of the frame **55** of the implant **20**, all in an atraumatic manner.

[0175] As depicted in FIG. **8**, which is an enlarged view of the distal region of the cardiac repair system **10** of FIG. **1A**, sutures **130** extend between a distal region of the catheter **77** and points of connection on the frame **55** of the implant **20**. The sutures **130** further extend from the distal region of the catheter up into the handle **35** and, in one embodiment, may even extend out of the handle, as shown in FIG. **1A**. Depending on the embodiment, the control sutures **130** could be replaced by cables or wire.

[0176] As can be understood from FIGS. **1A** and **8**, before the implant **20** is completely freed of the delivery tool **15**, the sutures **130** can be manipulated via the handle **35** of the tool **15** to control the opening of the implant frame **55**. Suture actuation may have one or two speeds, which may be in the form of a slow speed and/or a fast speed. The slower speed may be controlled by a spooling mechanism or a lead screw mechanism **135** within the handle. The fast speed may be controlled by a plunger style linear actuator **140** within the handle. The sutures **130** may be routed within the handle **35** to provide a 2-to-1 mechanical advantage to facilitate increased precision of control when deploying the implant **20**.

[0177] The catheter **77** may employ steering via selective actuation (e.g., tension increase/decrease) of certain sutures to better control the position of the implant during deployment. This steering feature may be controlled at the handle **35**.

[0178] FIG. **9** is a side cross-sectional elevation view of the sheath **76** of the delivery tool **15** with the implantable cardiac valve repair implant **20** and distal region of the catheter **77** located therein. As can be understood from FIG. **9**, during delivery the implant **20** is maintained in the collapsed state by being confined within the sheath **76**, and the implant **20** is coupled to a distal end of a catheter **77** that extends through the sheath **76**. The control sutures **130**, while not shown in FIG. **9** for clarity purposes, would extend through the catheter **77** and/or the sheath **76**, as can be understood from FIGS. **1A** and **8**.

[0179] With the implant **20** maintained in the collapsed state by virtue of being confined within the sheath **76** of the delivery tool **15**, the implant may be delivered and deployed at the target site via an antegrade percutaneous route (e.g., a trans-femoral or trans-jugular route) with the patient consciously sedated during the procedure. A distal end **25** of the catheter **77** is coupled with the proximal end **65** of the central occluder **50** to maintain the implant **20** within the sheath **76** in the collapsed state until the physician decides to deploy the implant within the target cardiac valve.

[0180] Upon the implant being properly positioned in the atrium and beginning to approach the target cardiac valve for repair, the physician actuates the tool **15** to cause the catheter **77** to act as a plunger and/or stopper, thereby driving the collapsed implant **20** distally from the confines of the sheath **76** and/or allowing the sheath **76** to be withdrawn proximally from about the implant **20**. Upon the collapsed implant **20** becoming exposed by action of exiting the distal end **129** of the sheath, the implant **20** self-biases into its expanded state, as depicted in FIGS. **2-6**. However, as indicated in FIG. **8**, despite having exited the sheath distal end **129** and assuming the expanded state, the proximal end **65** of the central occluder **50** of the implant **20** remains coupled to the catheter distal end **25** and the implant frame **55** is coupled to the sutures **130**, thereby allowing the physician to use the delivery tool **15** to drive the implant into the target valve and manipulate the implant therein for implantation.

[0181] The configuration of the implant **20** facilitates delivery and implantation that is very easy and fast. The implant's ease of delivery is facilitated by it generally only requiring the user to approximately center the frame and push it into the valve.

[0182] Upon arrival of the implant **20** within the atrium and at the target cardiac valve, the physician simply uses the tool **15** to actuate the sutures **130** to allow the frame **55** to self-bias open over the atrial side of the target cardiac valve in a controlled manner. The catheter **77** of the tool **15** is then used to push the implant **20** towards the ventricle to engage the frame barbs **105** into the

atrial tissue surrounding the target cardiac valve. The control sutures **130** can be used to collapse the frame **55** of the implant **20** to facilitate repositioning of the implant if necessary. Once the implant is fully implanted as desired by the physician, the exposed ends of the control sutures **130** are cut near their points of securement to the implant frame **55**, and the catheter distal end **25** is released (e.g., unscrewed or otherwise decoupled) from the proximal end **65** of the central occluder **50**. With the tool **15** so decoupled from the implanted implant, the tool can be withdrawn from the patient.

[0183] FIG. **10** is a view of the implant **20** implanted in a target cardiac valve, as viewed from an atrial position looking towards the valve and the ventricle chamber below. As depicted in FIG. **10**, upon being implanted in the target cardiac valve, the implant anchors itself within the target cardiac valve and is configured to reduce regurgitation in the target cardiac valve. When implanted, the implant **20** is located on the atrial side of the target cardiac valve. The frame engages the atrial tissue via the small barbs **105**. The thin sheet **60**, which is supported on the frame **55**, forms an annular surface **62** supported on the expanded frame **55**. This annular surface **62** extends across the atrial tissue circumferentially around the circumference of the target cardiac valve. The central occluder **50** is suspended off the frame **55** and located in the middle of the valve orifice or opening. So positioned, the implant provides the following advantages and reduces regurgitation through multiple mechanisms-of-action.

[0184] First, the metal frame **55** supports a central occluder **50** that is positioned to block a central leak in the target cardiac valve, the central occluder thereby reducing central regurgitation through the target cardiac valve. Specifically, the central occluder may block part or all of the central regurgitation in the valve.

[0185] Second, the thin sheet **60** covering the frame **55** encourages ingrowth with the atrial and annular tissue surrounding the target cardiac valve. With such tissue ingrowth, the thin sheet and its supporting frame **55** can act as an annuloplasty ring to buttress the native tissue and reduce myocardial stretching that could increase regurgitation.

[0186] Third, the thin sheet **60** covering the frame **55** may overlap the edges of the leaflet commissures, reducing the possibility of commissural leak.

[0187] Finally, the frame **55** may be over-expanded before engaging the retention barbs **105** in the tissue. When the frame is allowed to relax, the frame **55** may reduce the valve orifice of the target cardiac valve and improve apposition of the valve leaflets, thereby reducing or eliminating regurgitation.

III. STEERABLE DELIVERY TOOL

[0188] FIGS. **11A** and **11B** are plan and side elevation views, respectively, of an alternative valve repair system **1100** according to the present disclosure. Similar to valve repair systems previously discussed herein, the valve repair system **1100** is generally configured to deliver and deploy an implant **20** at a target site, which is generally in a cardiac valve requiring repair. Embodiments of the valve repair system **1100** may be used with, but are not limited to being used with, any implants discussed herein or that are otherwise consistent with this disclosure.

[0189] As shown in FIGS. **11A** and **11B**, the valve repair system **1100** includes a delivery tool **1115**. The tool **1115** includes a proximal end **1130** opposite a tool distal end **1125**. The delivery tool **1115** further includes a tubular sheath **1176**, and a catheter **1177**. A control handle **1135** extends distally from the proximal end **1130** and is used by a physician to manipulate the tool **1115** in positioning the implant **20** at the target site and deploying the implant **20** within the target cardiac valve in need of repair. The sheath **1176** and catheter **1177** extend distally away from the control handle **1135** towards the distal end **1125** of the tool **1115**. The catheter **1177** extends longitudinally through the sheath **1176**, the distal end **1125** of the catheter **1177** forming the distal end **1125** of the tool **1115**. The sheath **1176** is used to minimize tissue trauma while the catheter **1177** and implant **20** are advanced to the implantation site. Thus, the delivery tool **1115** is designed to deliver the implant **20** to the implantation site, position the implant in the target cardiac valve, and control opening of the

implant **20**, all in an atraumatic manner.

[0190] To facilitate delivery of the implant **20** to the implantation site, the catheter **1177** of the tool **1115** may be steerable. In the specific implementation illustrated in FIGS. **11A** and **11B**, for example, the control handle **1135** of the tool **1115** includes a bidirectional steering control **1180** that may be rotated to steer the distal end **1125** of the tool **1115**. As illustrated in FIG. **11C**, the steering control **1180** may be rotatable between two extents, illustrated by dashed outlines **1190A**, **1190B**, to steer the distal end **1125** between corresponding extents, illustrated by dashed outlines **1192A**, **1192B**. In the specific example illustrated, the steering control **1180** facilitates steering of the distal end **1125** across a range of motion of approximately 180 degrees. Stated differently, the steering control **1180** may rotate the distal end **1125** between a first position in which the distal end **1125** points in a first lateral direction and a second position in which the distal end points in a second lateral direction that is opposite the first lateral direction.

[0191] In certain embodiments, steering of the distal end **1125** is achieved by coupling the steering control **1180** to a steering segment **1182** disposed along the catheter **1177**, distal the steering control **1180**. More specifically, the steering control **1180** may include lateral members **1184A**, **1184B**, each of which is coupled to a respective side of a distal end of the steering segment **1182** by respective pull wires **1186A**, **1186B**. Accordingly, when the steering control **1180** is rotated, the corresponding pull wire is pulled and the steering segment **1182** is made to bend in the same direction. For example, referring to FIG. **11C**, when the steering control **1180** is rotated counterclockwise with respect to the view of FIG. **11C**, as illustrated by dashed outline **1190A**, the lateral member **1184A** pulls the pull wire **1186A**, resulting in the distal end **1125** curling in a counterclockwise direction, as illustrated by dashed outline **1192A**. Similarly, when the steering control **1180** is rotated clockwise with respect to the view of FIG. **11C**, as illustrated by dashed outline **1190B**, the lateral member **1184B** pulls the pull wire **1186B**, resulting in the distal end **1125** curling in a clockwise direction, as illustrated by dashed outline **1192B**.

[0192] The steering segment **1182** may take various forms; but, in general, is a flexible and manipulable segment of the catheter **1177** or a separate sleeve or sheath coupled to the catheter **1177**. In certain embodiments, for example, the steering segment **1182** may be a sleeve or a portion of the catheter **1177** that is formed from a flexible material. In other embodiments, the steering segment **1182** may be segmented or otherwise include slits, cutouts, or similar voids along its length to provide flexibility. In one specific implementation, the steering segment **1182** may have a helical shape. In still other embodiments, the steering segment **1182** may be a segment of the catheter **1177** having a reduced wall thickness. The foregoing are merely examples and other techniques for forming the steering segment **1182** that may be used are contemplated.

[0193] In certain embodiments, the pull wires **1186A**, **1186B** are run within an annular space defined between the sheath **1176** and the catheter **1177**. Alternatively, the pull wires **1186A**, **1186B** may be run through a lumen defined within a wall of the catheter **1177**, a wall of the sheath **1176**, or a third annular body disposed along the distal length of the tool **1115**. For example, the catheter **1177** or an additional tubular sheath disposed between the catheter **1177** and the sheath **1176** may be formed as a triple lumen extrusion including a central lumen and a pair of smaller lumens disposed on opposite sides of the central lumen and through which the pull wires **1186A**, **1186B** extend.

[0194] Although illustrated in FIG. **11C** as having a 180-degree range of motion, embodiments of the present disclosure may be configured to have other ranges of motions. For example, certain embodiments may be configured to rotate the distal end **1125** through 360 degrees of rotation, e.g., from a first position in which the distal end **1125** points proximally on a first side of the tool **1115** to a second position in which the distal end **1125** also points proximally on a second side of the tool **1115** opposite the first side. In other embodiments, the distal end **1125** may have a reduced range of motion such as but not limited to 135 degrees, 90 degrees, 45 degrees, or 15 degrees. In addition, while the range of motion illustrated in FIG. **11C** is illustrated as being substantially even in both

directions, embodiments of the present disclosure may have ranges of motion that are uneven in different directions. For example, a tool with a 135-degree range of motion may travel 90 degrees in a first direction but only 45 degrees in a second direction opposite the first direction. Moreover, while the tool **1115** has a neutral position in which the catheter **1177** is substantially straight, the catheter **1177** may alternatively be configured to have a bias in a particular direction.

IV. IMPLANT WITH TENSION CONTROL LINE

[0195] FIG. **12** is a distal plan view of the implant **20** in an expanded state and incorporating a tension control line **200**. As previously discussed in the context of FIGS. **2-6**, the implant **20** generally includes a central occluder **50**, a frame **55** and a thin sheet **60** supported on the frame **55**. Further details regarding the components and construction of the implant **20** and the frame **55** are provided above in the context of FIGS. **2-6**.

[0196] As illustrated in FIG. **12**, the tension control line **200** may be in the form of a wire, suture, cord, or similar elongate body coupled to the frame **55** and radially inward of the thin sheet **60** relative to the longitudinal axis **70** (shown in FIG. **5**) of the implant **20**. The tension control line **200** may form a loop extending around the frame **55** and may be formed from a single length of wire, suture, etc. In other implementations, the tension control line **200** may instead be formed from multiple discrete segments of wire, suture, etc., with each discrete segment coupled to the frame **55** and optionally coupled to adjacent segments of the control line **200**.

[0197] During operation and, more specifically, during deployment of the implant **20**, the tension control line **200** is releasably coupled to tension control members (e.g., tension control members **320** illustrated in FIGS. **13-22** and discussed below in further detail) of a delivery tool (e.g., delivery tool **300**, similarly illustrated in FIGS. **13-22** and discussed below). The tension control members may be coupled to a handle or similar actuatable component of the delivery tool (such as the handle **35** of the tool **15** previously discussed), to vary tension applied to the tension control line **200** by the tension control members. For example, rotating the handle **35** in a first direction may cause the tension control members to translate proximally/retract, thereby increasing tension on the tension control line **200**, while rotating the handle **35** in an opposite direction may cause the tension control members to translate distally/extend, thereby reducing tension on the tension control line **200**. Stated differently, manipulating the handle **35** in a first direction generally stops expansion of and/or collapses the frame **55** of the implant **20** (e.g., to allow repositioning of the implant **20**) while manipulating the handle **35** in a second direction generally stops collapse of the frame and/or expands the frame **55**, whether by action of the handle **35** or as a result of a bias of the frame **55** to into the expanded configuration.

[0198] In general, the tension control line **200** is releasably retained by the tension control members at discrete locations along the length of the tension control line **200**. The tension control line **200**, however, extends across the frame **55** and is coupled to the frame **55** at multiple locations. As a result, even though tension modifications may be applied at the connection point between the tension control members and the tension control line **200**, tension is distributed relatively evenly across the tension control line **200** and the frame **55**, thereby providing even expansion and collapse of the frame **55** and improved control during deployment and placement of the implant **20**.

[0199] In the implementation of FIG. **12**, the tension control line **200** is coupled to (e.g., tied or adhered to) the inner arcuate members **115** of the frame **55**. More generally, the tension control line **200** may be coupled to any suitable portion of the frame **55** such that the tension control line **200** substantially extends about the frame **55**. For example, and without limitation, in other implementations of the present disclosure, the tension control line **200** may instead be fixed to spokes **95**, outer arcuate members **110**, or any other suitable portion of the petal portions **100** of the frame **55**.

[0200] In certain implementations, the tension control line **200** may be additionally coupled to other locations of the frame **55** by additional control segments or linking structures. For example, FIG. **12** illustrates the tension control line **200** coupled to the inner arcuate members **115** of the

frame **55**.

[0201] The tension control line **200** is further coupled to each of the outer arcuate members **110** by corresponding links, such as the link **202**. Similar to the control line **200**, the link **202** may be formed of wire, suture, or similar material and, in certain cases, may be formed of the same material as the control line **200**. In operation, the link **202** helps to further distribute tension to the outer arcuate members **110** and, as a result, further improves control of expansion and collapse of the frame during deployment of the implant **20**.

[0202] Although illustrated in FIG. **12** as coupling the tension control line **200** to the outer arcuate members **110**, in other implementations, links may be used to couple the tension control line **200** to other elements of the frame **55** depending on how the tension control line **200** is configured. For example, in implementations in which the tension control line **200** is coupled to the outer arcuate members **110**, links may be used to couple the tension control line **200** to the inner arcuate members **115**.

V. DEPLOYMENT OF IMPLANTS WITH TENSION CONTROL LINES

[0203] As previously discussed, implants according to the present disclosure may include tension control lines for enhanced control during deployment and implantation. Such delivery and implantation may be further facilitated by corresponding delivery tools configured to modify and control tension applied to the tension control lines and to selectively release the implant when properly positioned.

[0204] FIG. **13** is an illustration including a delivery tool **300** in accordance with the present disclosure in a disassembled state. As illustrated, the delivery tool **300** generally includes a sheath **302**, a release catheter **304**, and a tension control assembly **306**. An implant **20** including a tension control line **200** is also pictured. The sheath **302** generally forms an exterior of the delivery tool **300** and houses the other components during insertion into the patient. More specifically, the release catheter **304** is generally disposed within the sheath **302** and the tension control assembly **306** is, in turn, disposed within the release catheter **304**.

[0205] As described below in further detail, the tension control line **200** of the implant **20** is releasably coupled to the tension control assembly **306** by the release catheter **304** and is maintained in a collapsed state within the sheath **302** during initial insertion into the patient. During deployment, the release catheter **304** is distally extended from the sheath **302**, thereby allowing the implant **20** to expand. Subsequent control of expansion and collapse of the implant **20** is facilitated by tension control members **320** extending from the tension control assembly **306**, which are coupled to the tension control line **200** of the implant **20** by release lines **350** of the release catheter **304**. Following location of the implant **20** within the patient, the release lines **350** are retracted to decouple the tension control members **320** from the tension control line **200**, thereby releasing the implant **20**.

[0206] FIG. **14** is a cross-sectional view of a distal portion **301** of the delivery tool **300** in an assembled state and with each of the release catheter **304** and the tension control assembly **306** in an extended configuration for purposes of illustrating various elements of the delivery tool **300**. FIG. **15** is also a cross-sectional view of the distal portion **301** of the delivery tool **300** but further includes an implant **20** and illustrates the delivery tool **300** in a retracted state, such as would be the case during initial insertion of the delivery tool **300** into the patient. For purpose of illustrating coupling of the implant **20** to the release catheter **304**, the frame **55** and associated components of the implant **20** are only partially illustrated in FIG. **15**.

[0207] As previously discussed, tension control assembly **306** generally includes tension control members **320** that are releasably coupled to the control line **200** of the implant **20**. As illustrated in FIGS. **14** and **15**, the tension control members **320** may be in the form of cables, control sutures, wires, or similar elongate structures that extend distally from a distal end of a tension control shaft **324**. In at least certain implementations, the tension control members **320** may terminate in a loop (e.g., loop **322**) or similar structure to facilitate coupling to the tension control members **320** to the

tension control line **200** of the implant **20**. FIG. **19** is an illustration of the tension control assembly **306** disposed within the release catheter **304** with the tension control members **320** extending distally out of a catheter body **352** of the release catheter **304**.

[0208] The release catheter **304** includes release lines **350** disposed within and extending through the catheter body **352**. The catheter body **352** further defines two sets of lateral holes for facilitating tensioning and release functionality of the delivery tool **300**. More specifically, the catheter body **352** defines a set of proximal holes **360** and a set of distal holes **362**. The catheter body **352** further defines a distal opening **357**. As illustrated in FIGS. **14** and **19**, the tension control assembly **306** is generally assembled with the release catheter **304** such that the tension control members **320** extend distally through the proximal holes **360**.

[0209] The implant **20** is generally coupled to the delivery tool **300** by coupling the implant **20** to the tension control members **320** using the release lines **350**. FIG. **16** is a proximal perspective view of the implant **20** coupled to the delivery tool **300** in an expanded state to illustrate such coupling. As illustrated in Detail B of FIG. **16**, a loop **201** of the tension control line **200** is pulled through the loop **322** of the tension control member **320**. The release line **350** is then passed through the loop **201** of the tension control line **200** and across the loop **322** of the tension control member **320**, thereby retaining the loop **201** of the tension control line **200** through the loop **322** of the tension control member **320**. To release the coupling between the control line **200** and the tension control member **320**, the release line **350** is slid out of the loop **201**, thereby enabling the loop **201** to pass through the loop **322** of the tension control member **320** and decoupling the tension control member **320** from the control line **200**. Detailed illustrations of the loop **201** of the tension control line **200** coupled to the loop **322** of the tension control member **320** are provided in FIGS. **17** and **18**.

[0210] Referring back to FIG. **15**, routing of the release lines **350** generally includes routing the release lines **350** (shown in dashed lines for clarity and distinction over other illustrated elements) through the catheter body **352** to an exterior thereof, such as by passing the release lines **350** through the distal holes **362** of the catheter body **352**. The release lines **350** may then be routed proximally to join the control line **200** to the tension control members **320**, as noted above and as illustrated in FIGS. **16-18**. The release lines **350** may then be routed proximally and back into the catheter body **352** through the proximal holes **360** where the release lines **350** may be retained, e.g., by friction, until the implant **20** is to be released.

[0211] As shown in FIG. **15**, in at least certain implementations, the occluder **50** of the implant **20** may include a proximally extending annular protrusion **51** defining each of a proximally open annulus **53** and laterally extending holes **57** in communication with the annulus **53**. In such implementations, the annular protrusion **51** may be disposed within the distal opening **357** (shown in FIG. **14**) of the release catheter **304** during insertion and delivery to an implantation location and the release lines **350** may be further routed into the annulus **53** and through the holes **57** before being passed through the distal holes **362** of the catheter body **352**.

[0212] FIGS. **20-22** illustrate the general process of releasing the implant **20** from the delivery tool **300**. Referring first to FIG. **20**, the delivery tool **300** and implant **20** are shown with the frame **55** of the implant **20** in an expanded configuration but still coupled to the delivery tool **300**. More specifically, the implant **20** is coupled to the delivery tool **300** by virtue of the release lines **350** of the release catheter **304**, each of which is routed, in order, through the catheter body **352**, through the annular protrusion **51** of the implant **20**, through one of the distal holes **362** of the catheter body **352**, through one of the loops **201** of the tension control line **200** extending through a loop **321** of one of the tension control members **320**, and back into the catheter body **352** through one of the proximal holes **360**. As previously noted, in at least certain implementations, the ends **356** of the release lines **350** may be retained within the catheter body **352** by friction.

[0213] In the state illustrated in FIG. **20**, the tension control shaft **324** of the tension control assembly **306** may be actuated (e.g., by translating and/or rotating the shaft or a handle assembly

coupled to the shaft) to vary the tension applied to the frame 55 of the implant 20. By doing so, the frame 55 may be expanded and/or collapsed to facilitate placement of the implant 20 prior to release of the implant 20 from the delivery tool 300.

[0214] Referring next to FIG. 21, the delivery tool 300 and implant 20 are illustrated part way through release of the implant 20 from the delivery tool 300. In general, release of the implant 20 from the delivery tool 300 is performed by pulling the release lines 350 proximally through the catheter body 352. As illustrated and for each release line 350 and as indicated by the open arrows, such pulling causes the end 356 of the release line 350 to exit the catheter body 352 through one of the proximal holes 360, pass through one of the loops 201 of the tension control line 200 to release the loop 201 from a corresponding control member 320, pass through one of the distal holes 362 of the catheter body 352 and the annular protrusion 51 of the implant 20, and reenter the catheter body 352 through the distal opening 357 of the catheter body 352. As a result, pulling the release lines 350 decouples the implant from the delivery tool and allows removal of the delivery tool 300 with the implant 20 remaining in place, as shown in FIG. 22. Following release of the implant 20, each of the release catheter 304 and the tension control assembly 306 may be proximally retracted and/or proximally removed from the sheath 302.

[0215] Notably, the process of releasing the implant 20 from the delivery tool 300 by pulling the release lines 350 applies a net force on the implant 20 that expands the frame 55 and/or resists collapse of the frame 55. More specifically, as the release lines 350 are pulled to release the implant 20, the release lines 350 apply a net distal force on the implant 20, thereby pressing the implant 20 into its current implantation location. Moreover, because such distal force is applied at the connection between the control line 200 and the tension control member 320 it acts to further expand or otherwise provide additional counterforce against collapse of the frame 55. In contrast, if a net proximal force were to be applied, the implant 20 may be pulled out of place and/or the frame 55 may undergo a partial collapse, each potentially leading to the implant 20 becoming dislodged or losing its orientation. Accordingly, by routing the release lines 350 as noted above, proper placement of the implant 20 is more easily controlled and more likely to be maintained following release of the implant 20.

VI. MULTI-PART OCCLUDER

[0216] FIGS. 23 and 24 illustrate a distal portion of an example implant 400 that may be used in implementations of the present disclosure. More specifically, FIG. 23 is a side elevation view of the distal portion of the implant 400 while FIG. 24 is a cross-sectional view of the implant 400, each of which emphasize an occluder 401 of the implant 400.

[0217] As illustrated, the occluder 401 includes an occluder body 402 defining a cavity 403 within which an insert 404 is disposed. The insert 404 is coupled to the occluder body 402. In the specific implementation illustrated in FIGS. 23 and 24, the insert 404 is coupled to the occluder body 402 by a threaded connection 406; however, any suitable connection (e.g., adhesive, welding, etc.) may be used instead of a threaded connection.

[0218] The occluder 401 further includes a frame base 408 disposed within the cavity 403 of the occluder body 402 and distal the insert 404. The frame base 408 is coupled to a frame 455 of the implant 400 (shown in part and which may be substantially similar to other frames disclosed herein) which extends from the frame base 408 and exits proximally from the occluder body 402. The frame base 408 may be coupled to the occluder body 402 and/or may be maintained in place by the insert 404.

[0219] The insert 404 further includes a proximally extending annular protrusion 410. The annular protrusion 410 includes a sidewall 412 through which one or more laterally extending holes 414 may be defined. As previously discussed in the context of FIGS. 15 and 20-22, during use of systems disclosed herein, release lines of a delivery tool may be routed through the holes 414 to secure the implant 400 to a delivery tool and, more specifically, to a release catheter of a delivery tool.

[0220] The occluder **401** further includes a marker **416** disposed within the occluder body **402**. In certain implementations, the marker **416** may be a radiopaque marker to facilitate fluoroscopic observation of the implant **400** during delivery and implantation. As shown, the marker **416** may be embedded within the occluder body **402**, such as by molding the occluder body **402** about the marker **416**. In other implementations, the cavity **403** may be shaped to receive the marker **416** in addition to the insert **404** and the frame base **408**. In still other implementations, the marker **416** may be disposed on an exterior surface of the occluder body **402**. Although illustrated as a spherical bead in FIG. **24**, the marker **416** may have any suitable shape. Similarly, any suitable number of markers may be incorporated into the occluder body **402**. In other implementations, the occluder body **402** may be formed from a material with radiopaque additives. In still other implementations, either or both of the frame base **408** and the insert **404** may be formed of radiopaque material or include one or more radiopaque markers.

VII. SKIRTED AND SHEET-BASED OCCLUSIVE ASSEMBLIES

[0221] As noted above, implementations of implants according to the present disclosure may include an occlusive body supported by a frame with a thin sheet supported by and extending around a proximal portion of the frame. When the implant is deployed within the heart to support function of a heart valve, the frame is supported by an annulus of the valve or by the walls of the atrium such that the occlusive body is disposed to interact with and seal against leaflets of the valve. In certain implementations, the thin sheet may be formed from a material that allows for tissue ingrowth such that, over time, the implant is retained more robustly within the heart. In addition to this structural function, the thin sheet may be configured to at least partially overlap one or more commissures of the valve leaflets to correct or reduce commissural regurgitation.

[0222] In addition to the outer thin sheet discussed above, implementations of this disclosure may alternatively or additionally include an inner sheet. For example, implants of the present disclosure may include an occlusive assembly that includes an occlusive body (such as the bullnose-style occluder or other occluders discussed above) and a sheet of material (generally referred to as a “skirt” or “inner sheet” herein) that extends from and circumferentially around the occlusive body. In such implementations, the inner sheet may be coupled to the occlusive body and/or portions of the implant frame extending from the occlusive body. In other implementations, the occlusive assembly may omit an occlusive body such that the inner sheet forms a cap-like structure on a distal end of the implant supported by and coupled to a distal portion of the frame. In such implants, the inner sheet may provide a sealing surface for the valve leaflets similar to that provided by the occlusive body. Like the outer sheet, the inner sheet may be formed of a material that promotes or allows tissue ingrowth to create a smooth layer of biological cells. The layer of biological cells may provide a barrier between the inner sheet and native valve leaflets to prevent wearing effects between the inner sheet and native valve leaflets. Alternatively, the inner sheet may be formed from a low friction material (such as PTFE or ePTFE) that resists cell in-growth to provide a smooth surface that prevents wearing effects between the inner sheet and native valve leaflets.

[0223] In certain implementations, either of the outer and inner sheets may have a multi-layered construction in which an internal pocket is defined between layers of sheet material. The pocket may contain an additional layer of fabric to serve as padding (e.g., a layer of PET, ePTFE, or other fabric). The pocket may also or alternatively contain a water-absorbing material, such as a hydrogel (e.g., sodium polyacrylate or polyvinyl alcohol) that expands following implantation. In any of the foregoing cases, the filling may form a pad. In implementations in which the inner sheet is formed to include an absorbing/expanding pocket, such pockets may generally pad or otherwise increase the distance between the occluding surface/sheet and the underlying frame of the implant, thereby preventing and padding contact between valve leaflets and the frame.

[0224] The foregoing aspects of this disclosure and related concepts are now discussed in further detail with reference to the figures.

[0225] FIGS. 25 and 26 illustrate an example of an implant 2500 including a skirted occlusive assembly. Specifically, FIG. 25 is a perspective distal-side view of implant 2500 while FIG. 26 is a perspective proximal-side view of implant 2500. FIGS. 25 and 26 illustrate implant 2500 when implant 2500 is in an expanded state, such as exists when implant 2500 is implanted in a cardiac valve to be repaired. As illustrated in FIG. 25, implant 2500 includes a distal end 2540 and a proximal end 2545. Distal end 2540 serves as the leading end of implant 2500 during implantation. [0226] Implant 2500 includes an occlusive assembly 2502 that includes a central occlusive body 2550 and an inner sheet 2552 extending about central occlusive body 2550. Implant 2500 further includes a frame 2555 and an outer sheet 2560 supported on frame 2555. In the implementation of FIGS. 25 and 26, frame 2555 extends proximally from central occlusive body 2550. When in the expanded state, the frame 2555 radiates laterally outwardly relative to a central longitudinal axis 2570 of implant 2500. In the expanded state, inner sheet 2552 forms a first annular surface 2561 and outer sheet 2560 forms a second annular surface 2564, each of which is supported on frame 2555.

[0227] First annular surface 2561 has a proximal radially outward edge 2563. Similarly, second annular surface 2564 has a distal radially inward edge 2565 and a proximal radially outward edge 2566. Proximal radially outward edge 2563 of first annular surface 2561 and distal radially inward edge 2565 of second annular surface 2564 define a central opening 2567 between inner sheet 2552 and outer sheet 2560. Proximal radially outward edge 2566 of outer sheet 2560 may form the extreme proximal radially outward boundary of the implant when in the expanded state; however, as shown in FIGS. 25 and 26, at least a portion of frame 2555 may extend beyond proximal radially outward edge 2566 of outer sheet 2560. Central longitudinal axis 2570 passes through the extreme distal tip 2575 of central occlusive body 2550. Considering the foregoing and in at least certain embodiments, frame 2555 is generally designed to sit on the floor of the atrium, to induce annular reduction, and to produce a neo-annulus.

[0228] In addition to being annular, either of first annular surface 2561 and second annular surface 2564 may also be conical, or relatively so (e.g., parabolic).

[0229] When implant 2500 is in the collapsed state, e.g., during delivery of implant 2500 to the target site via a corresponding tool (e.g., the tool 15 of FIG. 1A), frame 2555, inner sheet 2552, and outer sheet 2560 collapse symmetrically about the central longitudinal axis 2570. Thus, like implant 20 of FIGS. 2-6, implant 2500 can transition from the collapsed state to the expanded state like an umbrella. For example and as previously discussed herein in the context of implant 20, implant 2500 may be maintained in a collapsed state (similar to that illustrated in FIG. 7 for implant 20) by the tool 15 so as to allow implant 2500 to be negotiated through the patient vascular system and into an atrial chamber of the heart for implantation of the implant within a target cardiac valve. For example, with implant 2500 maintained in the collapsed state by virtue of being confined within a tubular sheath 76 of the delivery tool 15, implant 2500 may be delivered and deployed at the target site via an antegrade percutaneous route (e.g., an antegrade trans-femoral or trans-jugular route) with the patient consciously sedated during the procedure. Upon being properly positioned in the target cardiac valve for repair, the physician may actuate tool 15 such that tool 15 no longer maintains implant 2500 in the collapsed. Since frame 2555 of implant 2500 is biased to self-expand, implant 2500 self-expands into the expanded state to anchor itself within the target cardiac valve and reduce regurgitation.

[0230] Central occlusive body 2550 may take on various forms and shapes. For example, as previously discussed in the context of implant 20, central occlusive body 2550 may have a bullet or conical shape. Additional details regarding such shapes are provided above. Another alternative shape for central occlusive body 2550 is a bulb and is illustrated in FIGS. 25 and 26. In such implementations, central occlusive body 2550 may include a distal bulb 2580 (shown in FIG. 25) with a cylindrical side 2585 (shown in FIG. 26) extending proximally therefrom. In certain implementations, distal bulb 2580 may have a spherical shape; but may alternatively have an ovoid

or oblong shape. More generally, distal bulb **2580** may have a shape selected to be atraumatic during delivery and implantation purposes and that facilitates sealing of distal bulb **2580** against the cardiac valve leaflets to reduce or even eliminate central regurgitation past the cardiac valve leaflets.

[0231] In general, characteristics of central occlusive body **2550** may be similar to those of central occluder **50** of implant **20**. For example, central occlusive body **2550** may be formed various materials, including angio- and/or echolucent materials, may be filled or fillable (e.g., with saline) and may have properties and dimensional characteristics like those of central occluder **50** discussed above.

[0232] Like thin sheet **60** of implant **20** being supported by frame **55**, each of inner sheet **2552** and outer sheet **2560** is supported on frame **2555** and secured thereto. For example, and without limitation, inner sheet **2552** and/or outer sheet **2560** may be secured to frame **2555** by suturing the respective sheet against an inner surface and/or an outer surface of frame **2555**. In other implementations, inner sheet **2552** or outer sheet **2560** may include a cuff or similar folded structure that is folded over an end of frame **2555**. For example, as illustrated in FIG. **26**, inner sheet **2552** is folded over and sutured against a distal frame portion **2558**. More specifically, distal frame portion **2558** includes a circumferential arrangement of arcuate petal portions (e.g., arcuate petal portion **2557**) extending distally from central occlusive body **2550**. Inner sheet **2552** is then wrapped around a distal surface of distal frame portion **2558**, folded over each arcuate petal portion **2557** and sutured in place such that inner sheet **2552** is secured to distal frame portion **2558**.

[0233] Alternatively, each of inner sheet **2552** and outer sheet **2560** may be secured to frame **2555** by sewing, welding, gluing/adhering, stapling, or any other suitable securement method or combination of securement methods. Inner sheet **2552** and/or outer sheet **2560** may be on the distal side of frame **2555**, the proximal side of frame **2555**, or both such that the frame extends through and along inner sheet **2552** and/or outer sheet **2560**. In at least one specific implementation, each of inner sheet **2552** and outer sheet **2560** are supported on a distal side of frame **2555** such that, when implanted, outer sheet **2560** contacts the tissue of the atrial floor while inner sheet **2552** is positioned to interact with and seal against the valve leaflets.

[0234] Depending on the particular implementation, inner sheet **2552** and/or outer sheet **2560** may be formed of or include a woven or knit material or fabric that encourages tissue ingrowth. Fabric for inner sheet **2552** and/or outer sheet **2560** may generally have any of the properties or characteristics discussed above with respect to thin sheet **60** of implant **20**. Regarding outer sheet **2560**, the porosity of the fabric may assist in reducing commissural tricuspid regurgitation. Further reduction of commissural tricuspid regurgitation may be provided by the angulation of frame **2555**, which provides close contact between outer sheet **2560** and the commissures in a circumferential manner. For example, with the implant **2500** implanted in the target cardiac valve, tissue in-growth into the fabric of outer sheet **2560** buttresses the myocardium, helping to keep the tissue from expanding further and reducing the potential of future regurgitation. Regarding inner sheet **2552**, the porosity of the fabric may assist in reducing central regurgitation by providing an expanded surface relative to central occlusive body **2550** alone against which the valve leaflets may seal. In at least certain implementations, inner sheet **2552** may be formed from PTFE, ePTFE, or a similar low-friction polymer to provide a smooth surface for the native leaflets to abut against.

[0235] Frame **2555** may include spokes **2595** from which various arcuate petal portions extend. For example, as discussed above, a distal portion of frame **2555** may include distal or inner arcuate petal portions, such as arcuate petal portion **2557**, that support inner sheet **2552**. Frame **2555** may further include outer arcuate petal portions, such as arcuate petal portion **2559** configured to support outer sheet **2560**. The outer arcuate petal portions may be similar to or otherwise share characteristics and variations of petal portions **100** of implant **20**, which are described above in further detail.

[0236] Frame **2555** may be made from a variety of super-elastic and/or shape memory materials,

including, for example, nickel-titanium alloys (e.g., Nitinol), which may be laser cut from a tube or in the form of drawn wire. The features defined in the shape memory materials may be defined therein via various cutting methods known in the art, include laser, water jet, electrical discharge machining (EDM), stamping, etching, milling, etc.

[0237] Like central occluder **50** and frame spokes or struts **95** of implant **20**, occlusive assembly **2502** and spokes **2595** may be removable after implantation, leaving second annular surface **2564** formed by outer sheet **2560** in place. In such embodiments, a circumferential suture connection may exist between spokes **2595** and the rest of frame **2555** radially outward of spokes **2595**. Thus, this circumferential suture connection may be cut and occlusive assembly **2502** and spokes **2595** may be removed through a catheter, leaving the annular portion of the implant, which then acts as an “annuloplasty” frame.

[0238] Like spokes **95** of implant **20**, spokes **2595** may proximally extend from central occlusive body **2550** to the outer arcuate petal portions. In certain implementations, spokes **2595** may extend substantially parallel with, and extend along and near to, central longitudinal axis **2570** of implant **2500**. When implant **2500** is in the expanded state, spokes **2595** proximally extend from central occlusive body **2550** and laterally radiate away from central longitudinal axis **2570** to the outer arcuate petal portions. In general, spokes **2595** may be configured similar to and have characteristics to spokes of other frame embodiments discussed herein. For example, the dimensional characteristics and variations provided above with respect to frame **55** (and elements thereof) of implant **20** may be similarly applicable to frame **2555** and its components.

[0239] Outer arcuate petal portions, such as arcuate petal portion **2559** may be similar to petal portions **100** of implant **20**, discussed above. Inner arcuate petal portions, such as arcuate petal portion **2557**, may be located between a pair of spokes **2595**. When in the expanded state, the inner arcuate petal portions may be straight or curved in a laterally radiating direction. In certain implementations, when curved, the radius of curvature of the inner arcuate petal portions may be like that of spokes **2595** or may differ from that of spokes **2595**. Although illustrated as including only singular arcuate members, each inner arcuate petal portion **2557** may instead include multiple arcuate members, such as the inner and outer arcuate members of petal portions **100**.

[0240] In different implementations, frame **2555** may include different numbers of inner arcuate petal portions. For example, in certain example embodiments, frame **2555** may include between 6 and 8, between 4 and 10, or between 2 and 12 inner arcuate petal portions. In the specific implementation illustrated in FIGS. **25** and **26**, for example, frame **2555** includes 6 inner arcuate petal portions.

[0241] Like frame **55**, frame **2555** may engage the atrial tissue via the protruding anchor members **2597**, which may be in the form of small barbs. Anchor members **2597** are designed to securely engage the atrial tissue without penetrating through the tissue or to the coronary vessels. Depending on the embodiment, the protruding anchor members or barbs **2597** may be curved to slide before engaging tissue and there may be one or more rows of protruding anchor members **2597**. As shown in FIG. **25**, for example, frame **2555** includes three offset rows of protruding anchor members **2597** with a distal and intermediate row extending through outer sheet **2560** and a proximal row projecting from a distal end of frame **2555**. Further details and alternative configurations provided above with respect to protruding anchor members **105** are similarly applicable to anchor members **2597**, including implementations in which anchor members **2597** are directionally reversed such that they project distally and radially inward.

[0242] FIGS. **27** and **28** illustrate another implant **2700** according to the present disclosure. Specifically, FIG. **27** is a perspective distal-side view of implant **2700** while FIG. **28** is a perspective proximal-side view of implant **2700**. FIGS. **27** and **28** illustrate implant **2700** when implant **2700** is in an expanded state, such as exists when implant **2700** is implanted in a cardiac valve to be repaired. As illustrated in FIGS. **27** and **28**, implant **2700** includes a distal end **2740** (indicated in FIG. **27**) and a proximal end **2745**. Distal end **2740** serves as the leading end of

implant **2700** during implantation.

[0243] Implant **2700** includes an occlusive assembly **2702** disposed at distal end **2740**. In contrast to occlusive assembly **2502** of implant **2500**, occlusive assembly **2702** does not include an occlusive body. Rather, occlusion in occlusive assembly **2702** is provided entirely by an inner sheet **2752**, which forms a cap-like structure disposed on distal end **2740**. Like implant **2500**, implant **2700** further includes a frame **2755** and an outer sheet **2760**, with each of inner sheet **2752** and outer sheet **2760** supported on frame **2755**. When in the expanded state, frame **2755** radiates laterally outwardly relative to a central longitudinal axis **2770** (indicated in FIG. 27) of implant **2500**. In the expanded state, inner sheet **2752** forms a distal surface **2761** and outer sheet **2760** forms an annular surface **2764**, each of which is supported on frame **2755**.

[0244] Distal surface **2761** has a proximal radially outward edge **2763** while annular surface **2764** has a distal radially inward edge **2765** and a proximal radially outward edge **2766**. Proximal radially outward edge **2763** of distal surface **2761** and distal radially inward edge **2765** of annular surface **2764** define a central opening **2767** between inner sheet **2752** and outer sheet **2760**. Central longitudinal axis **2770** passes through an extreme distal tip **2775** of inner sheet **2752**. Given the parabolic shape of frame **2755**, implant **2700** may be configured to traverse at least partially up the atrial walls. However, in other implementations, frame **2755** may be configured such that implant **2700** is generally designed to sit on the floor of the atrium. In either case, implant **2700** may generally induce annular reduction and produce a neo-annulus.

[0245] Like implant **2500**, implant **2700** may be transitioned into a collapsed state, such as during delivery of implant **2700** to the target site. When collapsed, frame **2755**, inner sheet **2752**, and outer sheet **2760** may collapse symmetrically about central longitudinal axis **2570**. Thus, like implant **20** of FIGS. 2-6 and implant **2500**, implant **2700** can transition from the collapsed state to the expanded state like an umbrella. Also, like frame **55** of implant **20** and central occlusive body **2550** of implant **2500**, frame **2755** of implant **2700** may be biased to self-expand such that implant **2700** self-expands into the expanded state to anchor itself within the target cardiac valve.

[0246] Each of inner sheet **2752** and outer sheet **2760** is supported on frame **2755** and secured thereto using any suitable method. For example, and without limitation, inner sheet **2752** and/or outer sheet **2760** may be secured to frame **2755** by suturing, sewing, welding, gluing/adhering, stapling, or any other suitable securement method or combination of securement methods. In certain implementations, inner sheet **2752** or outer sheet **2760** may include a cuff or similar folded structure that is folded over a portion of frame **2755**. In the specific implementation illustrated in FIG. 28, inner sheet **2752** is sutured or otherwise coupled to a distal frame portion **2758** of frame **2755** without such a cuff or fold.

[0247] Like sheets previously discussed herein, inner sheet **2752** and/or outer sheet **2760** may be on the distal side of frame **2755**, the proximal side of frame **2755**, or both such that the frame extends through and along inner sheet **2752** and/or outer sheet **2760**. In at least one specific implementation, each of inner sheet **2752** and outer sheet **2760** are supported on a distal side of frame **2755** such that, when implanted, outer sheet **2760** contacts the tissue of the atrial floor and/or atrial wall while inner sheet **2752** is positioned to interact with and seal against the valve leaflets. Like previous embodiments discussed herein, inner sheet **2752** and/or outer sheet **2760** may be formed of or include a woven or knit material or fabric that encourages tissue ingrowth to provide the various advantageous discussed above.

[0248] Implementations of this disclosure are not limited to any sizes or dimensions and may be modified or customized to meet the needs of patients and specific applications. Nevertheless, in certain implementations, proximal radially outward edge **2763** of inner sheet **2752** may be from and including about 18 mm to and including about 28 mm. For example, in one specific implementation proximal radially outward edge **2763** may be 23 mm. Similarly, distal radially inward edge **2765** may be from and including about 35 mm to and including about 55 mm. For example, in one specific implementation, distal radially inward edge **2765** may be 44 mm. Finally,

proximal radially outward edge **2766** may be from and including about 45 mm to and including about 65 mm. In one specific example, proximal radially outward edge **2766** may be 55 mm.

[0249] While implant **20** and implant **2500** each included respective frames that relied primarily on a spoke-based design, frame **2755** illustrates an example of a petal-based frame structure. Referring to FIG. **28**, frame **2755** includes distal frame portion **2758**, which supports inner sheet **2752**, and a proximal frame portion **2759**, which supports outer sheet **2760**. In general, each of distal frame portion **2758** and proximal frame portion **2759** include a set of circumferentially distributed arcuate petal portions configured to collapse and expand as implant **2700** is similarly collapsed and expanded during delivery and implantation.

[0250] As shown in Detail C of FIG. **28**, distal frame portion **2758** may include arcuate petal portions that may be ovate, diamond-shaped, or that have other elongate shape (e.g., generally diamond shaped albeit with rounded vertices or curved edges). Each such arcuate petal portion may be defined by respective major and minor axes. For example, as shown in Detail C, arcuate petal portion **2780A** may have a major axis **2781A** that extends in a substantially longitudinal direction and a minor axis **2782A** that extends in a circumferential direction. In certain implementations, adjacent arcuate petal portions may be joined at or near the vertices along the minor axis, which are generally referred to as co-vertices. For example, and as indicated in FIG. **28**, arcuate petal portion **2780A** and arcuate petal portion **2780B** are joined at a junction **2784** disposed distal the co-vertices of arcuate petal portion **2780A** and arcuate petal portion **2780B**.

[0251] Proximal frame portion **2759** may similarly include arcuate petal portions that may be ovate, diamond-shaped, or have another elongate shape. Each such arcuate petal portion may be defined by respective major and minor axes. For example, arcuate petal portion **2785A** may have a major axis **2786A** that extends in a substantially longitudinal direction and a minor axis **2787A** that extends in a circumferential direction. In certain implementations, adjacent arcuate petal portions of proximal frame portion **2759** may be joined at or near the vertices along the minor axis (i.e., the co-vertices of the arcuate petal portions). For example, arcuate petal portion **2785A** and arcuate petal portion **2785B** are joined at a junction **2789** disposed at the corresponding co-vertices of arcuate petal portion **2785A** and arcuate petal portion **2785B**.

[0252] As further illustrated in FIG. **28**, arcuate petal portions of distal frame portion **2758** may be joined to respective arcuate petal portions of proximal frame portion **2759**. For example, arcuate petal portion **2780A** is coupled to arcuate petal portion **2785A** by a longitudinal member **2790** extending between a proximal vertex **2791** of arcuate petal portion **2780A** and a distal vertex **2792** of arcuate petal portion **2785A**.

[0253] Like previous frames discussed herein, frame **2755** may be made from a variety of super-elastic and/or shape memory materials, including, for example, nickel-titanium alloys (e.g., Nitinol), which may be laser cut from a tube or in the form of drawn wire. The features defined in the shape memory materials may be defined therein via various cutting methods known in the art, include laser, water jet, electrical discharge machining (EDM), stamping, etching, milling, etc.

[0254] Depending on the embodiment, frame **2755** may include different numbers of inner and/or outer arcuate petal portions. For example, in certain example embodiments, frame **2755** may include between 10 and 14, between 8 and 16, or between 6 and 18 inner and outer arcuate petal portions. In the specific implementation illustrated in FIGS. **27** and **28**, for example, frame **2755** includes 12 each of inner and outer arcuate petal portions with each inner arcuate petal portion joined to a respective outer arcuate petal portion. In other implementations, the number of inner arcuate petal portions may differ from the number of outer arcuate petal portions. For example, frame **2755** may include twice as many inner arcuate petal portions as outer petal portions.

Moreover, not every inner arcuate petal portion may be joined to a corresponding outer arcuate petal portion or vice versa regardless of whether the number of inner and outer arcuate petal portions matches. So, for example, in one implementation, an implant may include twice then number of inner arcuate petal portions as outer arcuate petal portions and every other inner arcuate

petal portion may be joined to an outer arcuate petal portion. In another implementation, the number of inner and outer arcuate petal portions may be the same; however, joining may still only be between every other inner and outer arcuate petal portion.

[0255] As shown in FIGS. 27 and 28, each inner arcuate petal portion is uniform as is each outer arcuate petal portion. In other implementations, the inner and outer arcuate petal portions may vary in any direction. For example, the inner arcuate petal portions may alternate between arcuate petal portions having a first major axis dimension and arcuate petal portions have a second major axis dimension different than the first major axis dimension.

[0256] Other examples of alternative frame configurations are discussed below in the context of FIGS. 31-33.

[0257] Although not illustrated in FIGS. 27 and 28, frame 2755 may engage atrial tissue via protruding anchor members, like protruding anchor members 105 of implant 20 or protruding anchor members 2597 or implant 2500, discussed above.

VIII. ALTERNATIVE IMPLANT FRAME SHAPES

[0258] The overall shape of implants according to the present disclosure when in the expanded state may vary across implementations to address various needs of a patient. Among other things, implant shape may be varied to accommodate variations in patient anatomy and pathology. For example, in cases where a patient may have weakened valves or valves exhibiting reduced travel, an implant configuration in which an occlusive assembly is positioned deeper into the ventricle may be advantageous such that contact and sealing between the occlusive assembly and leaflet occurs earlier in the leaflet's travel. In contrast, a more planar or flat implant structure in which the sheets of the implant cover a greater proportion of the tricuspid valve structure may be more advantageous when commissural regurgitation is present despite substantially normal leaflet function. These and other considerations are described below in further detail.

[0259] In one aspect, implants according to the present disclosure may vary in curvature when in the expanded state. Examples of varying curvature are provided in FIGS. 29A-29C. More specifically, FIG. 29A is an elevation view of an implant 2900A that has a proximally concave shape when deployed/expanded, FIG. 29B is an elevation view of an implant 2900B that has a distally concave shape when deployed/expanded, FIG. 29C is an elevation view of an implant 2900C including a proximally concave proximal portion and a distally concave distal portion. For clarity and simplicity, each of implant 2900A-2900C are shown in a simplified view in which overall shape is emphasized and certain elements of each implant are omitted. Accordingly, and unless stated otherwise, implants 2900A-2900C may generally include elements of and be in accordance with any other implementation discussed herein. For example, FIGS. 29A-29C generally omit details regarding the frames of the corresponding implants; however, it should be understood that such frames may be in accordance with any frame style disclosed herein.

[0260] Referring first to FIG. 29A, implant 2900A includes a distal end 2902A and a proximal end 2904A such that a longitudinal axis 2906A of implant 2900A extends between distal end 2902A and proximal end 2904A. Implant 2900A includes a frame 2908A that supports an occlusive assembly 2910A at distal end 2902A. As shown, occlusive assembly 2910A includes an inner sheet 2912A; however, in other implementations, occlusive assembly 2910A may include an occlusive body instead of or in addition to inner sheet 2912A. For example, occlusive assembly 2910A may include a bulb- or bullnose-shaped occluder about which inner sheet 2912A extends. Implant 2900A further includes an outer sheet 2914A supported on frame 2908A at proximal end 2904A such that an annular opening 2916A is defined between inner sheet 2912A and outer sheet 2914A.

[0261] FIG. 29A shows implant 2900 in the expanded state (e.g., following deployment). As shown, implant 2900A has a proximally concave shape defined by a radius of curvature (RC-A) such that implant 2900A has an overall bowl-like shape. Implant 2700 of FIGS. 27 and 28 is an example of a proximally concave implant according to this disclosure and is discussed above in further detail. Notably, while illustrated as being hemispherical, implant 2900A may alternatively

have an ovoid or similar rounded but non-spherical shape.

[0262] RC-A may differ in implementations of this disclosure depending on the specific application and needs of the patient. For example, when the overall diameter of proximal end **2904A** is held constant, RC-A generally controls the position of distal end **2902A** and occlusive assembly **2910A** relative to proximal end **2904A**. More specifically, as RC-A increases, implant **2900A** takes on a shallower geometry when in the expanded shape such that distal end **2902A** is closer to the valve annulus following deployment. Conversely, as RC-A decreases, implant **2900A** takes on a deeper shape such that distal end **2902A** and occlusive assembly **2910A** deploy further within the ventricle.

[0263] As noted above, placement of occlusive assembly **2910A** relative to the valve annulus determines how and when the valve leaflets contact and seal against occlusive assembly **2910A** and, as a result, RC-A may be chosen to account for various needs and idiosyncrasies of a particular patient.

[0264] For example, the proximally concave/distally convex shape illustrated in FIG. **29A** generally includes larger and more accessible gaps as compared to the distally concave/proximally convex design illustrated in FIG. **29B** and discussed below in further detail. As a result, proximally concave implants according to the present disclosure may allow for easier and more accurate placement of other cardiac devices, such as pacemaker leads, through the implant. Proximally concave implants according to this disclosure may also be readily inverted. Such invertibility can facilitate removal of the implant at a later date as the implant can be funneled and pulled back into a retrieval catheter.

[0265] Regardless of concavity, implants according to this disclosure having frames formed of metal or other radiopaque materials may further facilitate placement of a pacemaker lead by being visible on fluoroscopy and providing a target for delivering the pacemaker lead. The frame of the implant may also provide constraints for the pacemaker lead to reduce movement of the lead following delivery and implantation. Among other things, such reinforcement of the lead may prevent or reduce the likelihood that the pacemaker lead may obstruct or otherwise interfere with movement of the valve leaflets.

[0266] Referring next to FIG. **29B**, implant **2900B** includes a distal end **2902B** and a proximal end **2904B** such that a longitudinal axis **2906B** of implant **2900B** extends between distal end **2902B** and proximal end **2904B**. FIG. **29B** shows implant **2900B** in the expanded state about longitudinal axis **2906B**. Implant **2900B** includes a frame **2908B** that supports an occlusive assembly **2910B** at distal end **2902B** and that is shown including an inner sheet **2912B** as well as an occlusive body **2913B**.

[0267] In other implementations, occlusive assembly **2910B** may instead include only one of inner sheet **2912B** and occlusive body **2913B**. Implant **2900B** further includes an outer sheet **2914B** supported on frame **2908B** at proximal end **2904B** such that an annular opening **2916B** is defined between inner sheet **2912B** and outer sheet **2914B**. When in the expanded state (e.g., following deployment) implant **2900B** has a distally concave shape defined by a radius of curvature (RC-B) such that implant **2900B** has an overall funnel-like shape. Examples of implants with a similar shape include implant **20** and implant **2500**, discussed above in further detail.

[0268] Like RC-A of implant **2900A**, RC-B of implant **2900B** may differ in implementations of this disclosure depending on the specific application and needs of the patient. Among other things, the distally concave design of implant **2900B** ensures that initial contact between the valve leaflets and implant **2900B** is with occlusive assembly **2910B** as opposed to a portion of frame **2908B**, as may occur in the distally concave design of implant **2900A**. More generally, the distally concave shape reduces the overall size of the implant portion within the ventricle, reducing the likelihood that the implant may obstruct or otherwise interfere with cardiac structures and their respective functions. For example, the distally concave shape reduces contact between the valve leaflets and the implant, thereby reducing the likelihood that the implant will interfere with or otherwise

impede travel of the leaflets. As another example, the distally convex shape may reduce the likelihood that the implant will interfere with or obstruct the coronary sinus or similar vessels of the heart.

[0269] Implant **29000** includes a distal end **2902C** and a proximal end **2904C** such that a longitudinal axis **2906C** of implant **2900B** extends between distal end **2902C** and proximal end **2904C**. FIG. 29C shows implant **29000** in the expanded state about longitudinal axis **2906C**. Implant **29000** includes a frame **2908C** that supports an occlusive assembly **2910C** at distal end **2902C** and that is shown including an inner sheet **2912C**. In other implementations, occlusive assembly **2910C** may further or alternatively include an occlusive body. Implant **29000** also includes an outer sheet **2914C** supported on frame **2908C** at proximal end **2904C** such that an annular opening **2916C** is defined between inner sheet **2912C** and outer sheet **2914C**.

[0270] Implant **29000** includes both proximally and distally concave portions. More specifically, **29000** includes proximal portion **2920C** that has a proximally concave shape. Implant **29000** transitions into a distal portion **2922C** that has a distally concave shape. In the implementation illustrated in FIG. 29C, distal portion **2922C** further transitions into a proximally concave cap portion **2924C** that includes occlusive assembly **2910C** and, more specifically, inner sheet **2912C**. In other implementations, distal portion **2922C** may instead terminate in an occlusive body, such as central occluder **50** of implant **20** or central occlusive body **2550** of implant **2500**.

[0271] When in the expanded state (e.g., following deployment) the shape of implant **29000** may be defined by at least two radii of curvature. More specifically, the shape of implant **29000** may be defined by a radius of curvature (RC-C) corresponding to proximal portion **2920C** (i.e., the proximally concave portion of implant **29000**) and a radius of curvature (RC-D) corresponding to the distal portion **2922C** (i.e., the distally concave portion of implant **29000**). To the extent an implementation of this disclosure further includes proximally concave cap portion **2924C**, implant **29000** may be further defined by a radius of curvature (RC-E) corresponding to proximally concave cap portion **2924C**. In certain implementations, RC-E and RC-C may be the same; however RC-E and RC-C may also differ such that proximally concave cap portion **2924C** may have a more or less pronounced curvature than proximal portion **2920C**.

[0272] While each of implant **2900A**, implant **2900B**, and implant **29000** have an overall curved shape, implants according to this disclosure may also have non-curved shapes when deployed. Examples of such non-curved implants are provided in FIGS. 30A and 30B. More specifically, FIG. 30A is an elevation view of an implant **3000A** having a conical shape when deployed while FIG. 30B is an elevation view of an implant **3000B** having a flat or planar shape when deployed. Like FIGS. 29A and 29B, for clarity and simplicity, each of implant **3000A** and implant **3000B** are shown in a simplified view in which overall shape is emphasized and certain elements of each implant are omitted. Accordingly, and unless stated otherwise, implant **3000A** and implant **3000B** may generally include elements of and be in accordance with any other implementation discussed herein.

[0273] Referring to FIG. 30A, implant **3000A** includes a distal end **3002A** and a proximal end **3004A** such that a longitudinal axis **3006A** of implant **3000A** extends between distal end **3002A** and proximal end **3004A**. Implant **3000A** includes a frame **3008A** that supports an occlusive assembly **3010A** at distal end **3002A**. As shown, occlusive assembly **3010A** includes an inner sheet **3012A** and an occlusive body **3013A**. In other implementations, occlusive assembly **3010A** may instead include only one of inner sheet **3012A** and occlusive body **3013A**. Implant **3000A** further includes an outer sheet **3014A** supported on a proximal portion of frame **3008A** such that an annular opening **3016A** is defined between inner sheet **3012A** and outer sheet **3014A**.

[0274] FIG. 30A shows implant **3000** in the expanded state (e.g., following deployment). As shown and in contrast to the curved funnel shape of implant **2900B**, implant **3000A** has a straight-sided funnel shape. Stated differently, when deployed, implant **3000A** has a distally expanding conical or frustoconical shape.

[0275] Like implant **2900A** and implant **2900B**, implant **3000A** may be modified to vary the degree to which occlusive assembly **3010A** enters the ventricle when implant **3000A** is deployed within the heart. For example, the general shape of implant **3000B** may be determined by an angle θ , which may be defined as the angle between the sides of frame **3008A** and longitudinal axis **3006A** of implant **3000A** when implant **3000A** is in the expanded/deployed state. Assuming other dimensions of implant **3000A** (e.g., maximum diameter at proximal end **3004A**) remain substantially constant, varying θ changes overall length of implant **3000A** when expanded and, as a result, the depth of occlusive assembly **3010A** within the ventricle. More specifically, reducing θ increases the overall length of implant **3000A** and the depth of occlusive assembly **3010A** within the ventricle when implant **3000A** is deployed. Conversely, increasing θ reduces the overall length of implant **3000A** when deployed (e.g., results in implant **3000A** being more planar in the expanded state) and the depth of occlusive assembly **3010A** within the ventricle.

[0276] Referring next to FIG. **30B**, implant **3000B** expands into a flat or planar shape when deployed. Implant **3000B** includes a radially inward portion **3002B** and a radially outward portion **3004B** relative to a longitudinal axis **3006B**. When in the collapsed state (e.g., when implant **3000B** is collapsed about longitudinal axis **3006B** during delivery), radially inward portion **3002B** forms a distal or leading end of implant **3000B** while radially outward portion **3004B** forms a proximal end of implant **3000B**. Like other implants disclosed herein, implant **3000B** includes a frame **3008B** that supports an occlusive assembly **3010B** at radially inward portion **3002B**. As shown, occlusive assembly **3010B** includes an inner sheet **3012B**. In other implementations, occlusive assembly **3010B** may further or alternatively include an occlusive body **3013B**, which FIG. **30B** shows in dashed lines. Implant **3000B** further includes an outer sheet **3014B** supported on a proximal portion of frame **3008B** such that an annular opening **3016B** is defined between inner sheet **3012A** and outer sheet **3014B**.

[0277] Planar implants, such as implant **3000B**, may be particularly advantageous in cases where regurgitation results despite substantially normal valve leaflet travel. When deployed, implant **3000B** may be positioned along the floor of the atrium across the valve annulus with occlusive assembly **3010B** centrally located or approximately centrally located. In implementations in which occlusive assembly **3010B** includes occlusive body **3013B**, occlusive body **3013B** may project into the valve annulus or across the valve annulus into the ventricle, depending on its size and shape. When the valve is in the closed position and with implant **3000B** properly positioned, the valve leaflets contact and seal against occlusive assembly **3010B**. In this position, portions of occlusive assembly **3010B**, such as inner sheet **3012B**, may extend over the leaflets and, in particular, the commissures between the leaflets. By doing so, inner sheet **3012B** provides an additional and expanded sealing surface for the leaflets and may cover at least a portion of commissural gaps that may be present, thereby reducing regurgitation. In addition to inner sheet **3012B**, additional regurgitation reduction may be provided by outer sheet **3014B**, which may similarly seal against the leaflets and cover commissural gaps that may be present toward the outward edge of the valve annulus.

IX. ALTERNATIVE FRAME CONFIGURATIONS

[0278] As previously discussed, implants according to the present disclosure include a frame configured to support a distal occlusive assembly. The frame may further support or otherwise be coupled to one or more thin sheets or similar structures. In certain implementations such sheets may include a proximal or outer sheet configured to contact the atrial floor and/or a distal or inner sheet included in the occlusive assembly (e.g., as a “skirt” extending circumferentially around an occlusive body of the occlusive assembly).

[0279] In addition to providing structural integrity, frames of implants according to this disclosure are configured to be expandable about a longitudinal axis of the implant. More specifically, frames of implants according to the present disclosure are configured to transition between a collapsed state and an expanded state. The collapsed state may correspond, for example, to a state of the

implant during delivery using a delivery tool, such as tool **15** (shown in FIG. **1A**), tool **1115** (shown in FIGS. **11A-11B**), or delivery tool **300** (shown in FIG. **13**), each of which is discussed above in detail. In contrast, the expanded state may correspond to a state of the implant following delivery and deployment within a patient heart. Implant frames according to this disclosure may be biased into the expanded state such that the implant transitions into the expanded state absent resistance provided by a delivery tool. For example, and with reference to FIG. **16**, tension control members **320** of the delivery tool may be coupled to a tension control line **200** of the implant such that by applying tension to the tension control members **320**, a user may resist expansion of the implant. In certain implementations, a user may apply sufficient tension to collapse the implant (e.g., to transition the implant from the expanded state to the collapsed state).

[0280] This disclosure previously described various example frame styles. For example, FIGS. **2-8** and **12** include a first style of frame for a distally concave implant in which radially extending spokes support arcuate petal portions circumferentially distributed about a central occluder. FIGS. **25** and **26** illustrate a similar frame style albeit with the further inclusion of inner arcuate petal portions configured to support an inner sheet. FIGS. **27** and **28** introduce the concept of a proximally concave frame formed by joining an inner/distal set of circumferentially distributed arcuate petals to an outer/proximal set of circumferentially distributed arcuate petals. FIGS. **29A-30B** expand on these general frame styles by providing additional examples of overall frame shapes and configurations.

[0281] To further illustrate the scope of frames contemplated by this disclosure, FIGS. **31-33** provide additional examples of frame styles that may be used in implants according to the present disclosure. Notably, while each of FIGS. **31-33** describe the alternative frame styles as applied to a proximally concave implant (similar to implant **2700** of FIGS. **27** and **28**), the concepts and structures illustrated in FIGS. **31-33** may be applied to implants having distally concave, frustoconical, planar, or other overall shapes. Notably, FIGS. **31-33** omit certain features of the illustrated implants for purposes of clarity. For example, each of FIGS. **31-33** omit a backside of the depicted implants (relative to the illustrated perspective) to more clearly illustrate the structure and configuration of the frames of the implants.

[0282] FIG. **31** illustrates an implant **3100** having a first alternative frame configuration. Implant **3100** includes a distal end **3102** and a proximal end **3104** such that a longitudinal axis **3106** of implant **3100** extends between distal end **3102** and proximal end **3104**. Implant **3100** includes a frame **3108** that supports an occlusive assembly **3110** at distal end **3102**. As shown, occlusive assembly **3110** includes an inner sheet **3112**; however, in other implementations, occlusive assembly **3110** may include an occlusive body instead of or in addition to inner sheet **3112**. Implant **3100** further includes an outer sheet **3114** supported on a proximal portion of frame **3108** such that an annular opening **3116** is defined between inner sheet **3112** and outer sheet **3114**.

[0283] Similar to frame **2755** of implant **2700**, frame **3108** of implant **3100** includes a distal frame portion **3118** including a first set of circumferentially distributed arcuate petal portions, such as arcuate petal portion **3120A** and arcuate petal portion **3120B**, and a proximal frame portion **3138** including a second set of circumferentially distributed arcuate petal portions, such as arcuate petal portion **3140A** and arcuate petal portion **3140B**. As described in the context of FIGS. **27** and **28**, above, arcuate petals portions according to this disclosure may be ovate, diamond-shaped, or have any similar elongate shape (e.g., generally diamond shaped albeit with rounded vertices or curved edges). More generally, arcuate petal portions according to this disclosure may have any suitable shape that enables collapsing and expanding of the frame and other functionality described herein (e.g., support of fabric sheets, such as inner sheet **3112** and outer sheet **3114**).

[0284] As shown in FIG. **31**, adjacent arcuate petal portions of distal frame portion **3118** may be joined at or near their respective co-vertices. For example, arcuate petal portion **3120A** and arcuate petal portion **3120B** are joined at a junction **3126** disposed at the corresponding co-vertices of arcuate petal portion **3120A** and arcuate petal portion **3120B**. Adjacent arcuate petal portions of

proximal frame portion **3138** likewise may be joined at or near their respective co-vertices. For example, arcuate petal portion **3140A** and arcuate petal portion **3140B** are joined at a junction **3146** disposed at the corresponding co-vertices of arcuate petal portion **3140A** and arcuate petal portion **3140B**.

[0285] Arcuate petal portions of distal frame portion **3118** may be joined to respective arcuate petal portions of proximal frame portion **3138**. For example, arcuate petal portion **3120A** is coupled to arcuate petal portion **3140A** by a longitudinal member **3148** extending between a proximal vertex **3125** of arcuate petal portion **3120A** and a distal vertex **3145** of arcuate petal portion **3140A**.

[0286] As illustrated in FIG. **31**, longitudinal member **3148** extending between arcuate petal portion **3120A** and arcuate petal portion **3140A** is substantially longer than longitudinal member **2790** extending between arcuate petal portion **2780A** and arcuate petal portion **2785A** of implant **2700** (shown in FIG. **28**).

[0287] Although FIG. **31** illustrates longitudinal members (e.g., longitudinal member **3148**) as extending between the proximal vertices of the first set of arcuate petal portions and the distal vertices of the second set of arcuate petal portions, in other implementations, longitudinal members may extend between other locations of frame **3108**. For example, in certain implementations, longitudinal members may be offset from the arcuate petal portions such that the longitudinal members extend between the circumferential junctions of the arcuate petal portions. So, for example and with reference to FIG. **31**, longitudinal members may extend between the junctions of the first set of arcuate petal portions (e.g., junction **3126**) and the junctions of the second set of arcuate petal portions (e.g., junction **3146**). In other implementations, the first set of arcuate petal portions can be rotationally offset from the second set of arcuate petal portions such that the junctions of one set align with the vertices of the other set. In such implementations, longitudinal members may extend between the junctions of one set and the vertices of the other. So, for example, longitudinal members may extend between junctions of the first set of arcuate petal portions (e.g., junction **3126**) and the distal vertices of the second set of arcuate petal portions (e.g., distal vertex **3145**). Alternatively, longitudinal members may extend between the proximal vertices of the first set of arcuate petal portions (e.g., proximal vertex **3125**) and the junctions of the second set of arcuate petal portions (e.g., junction **3146**).

[0288] In implementations of the present disclosure, either of the inner sheet or the outer sheet may define one or more internal pockets. For example, in certain implementations, the sheet may include two or more layers stitched or otherwise coupled together to form internal pockets between adjacent layers. In one implementation, the adjacent layers may include a first layer disposed on a proximal or inner surface of the implant frame and a second layer disposed on a distal or outer surface of the implant frame such that the frame also extends between the layers. In other implementations, the layers forming the internal pockets may be disposed entirely on the proximal/inner surface of the frame or the distal/outer surface of the frame. Pockets formed in this way may be filled, such as with additional layers of fabric, batting, or a water-absorbing material, such as a hydrogel. In such cases, the filling generally forms a pad that may increase the distance between the occluding surface/sheet and the underlying frame of the implant, thereby preventing and padding contact between valve leaflets and the frame.

[0289] FIG. **32** illustrates an implant **3200** with another alternative frame configuration. Implant **3200** includes a distal end **3202** and a proximal end **3204** such that a longitudinal axis **3206** of implant **3200** extends between distal end **3202** and proximal end **3204**. Implant **3200** includes a frame **3208** that supports an occlusive assembly **3210** at distal end **3202**. As shown, occlusive assembly **3210** includes an inner sheet **3212**; however, in other implementations, occlusive assembly **3210** may include an occlusive body instead of or in addition to inner sheet **3212**. Implant **3200** further includes an outer sheet **3214** supported on a proximal portion of frame **3208** such that an annular opening **3216** is defined between inner sheet **3212** and outer sheet **3214**.

[0290] Frame **3208** of implant **3200** includes a distal frame portion **3218** including a first set of

circumferentially distributed arcuate petal portions, such as arcuate petal portion **3220A** and arcuate petal portion **3220B**, and a proximal frame portion **3238** including a second set of circumferentially distributed arcuate petal portions, such as arcuate petal portion **3240A** and arcuate petal portion **3240B**.

[0291] The first or inner set of arcuate petal portions of implant **3200** are shown as being substantially similar to those of implant **3100**. The second set arcuate petal portions of implant **3200**, on the other hand, have a distally open shape in contrast to the ovate shape of implant **3100**. More specifically, each arcuate petal portion of the second set of arcuate petal portions is formed by a pair of longitudinal members and an arcuate frame portion. For example, arcuate petal portion **3240A** is formed by a longitudinal member **3248A**, a longitudinal member **3248B**, and an arcuate frame portion **3249**, which extends between longitudinal member **3248A** and longitudinal member **3248B**. As illustrated, each longitudinal member extends from a respective junction of the first set of arcuate petal portions. For example, longitudinal member **3248A** extends from a junction **3226** between arcuate petal portion **3220A** and arcuate petal portion **3220B**. Like noted above with respect to implant **3100**, the first and second set of arcuate petal portions of implant **3200** may be rotationally offset from the configuration illustrated in FIG. **32** such that the longitudinal members instead extend from proximal vertices (e.g., proximal vertex **3125**) of the first set of arcuate petal portions.

[0292] FIG. **33** illustrates an implant **3300** having yet another alternative frame configuration. Implant **3300** includes a distal end **3302** and a proximal end **3304** such that a longitudinal axis **3306** of implant **3300** extends between distal end **3302** and proximal end **3304**. Implant **3300** includes a frame **3308** that supports an occlusive assembly **3310** at distal end **3302**. As shown, occlusive assembly **3310** includes an inner sheet **3312**; however, in other implementations, occlusive assembly **3310** may include an occlusive body instead of or in addition to inner sheet **3312**. Implant **3300** further includes an outer sheet **3314** supported on a proximal portion of frame **3308** such that an annular opening **3316** is defined between inner sheet **3312** and outer sheet **3314**.

[0293] Frame **3308** of implant **3300** includes a distal frame portion **3318** including a set of circumferentially distributed arcuate petal portions, such as arcuate petal portion **3320A** and arcuate petal portion **3320B**. Frame **3308** further includes a proximal frame portion **3338** including a second set of circumferentially distributed arcuate petal portions, such as arcuate petal portion **3340A** and arcuate petal portion **3340B**.

[0294] As shown in FIG. **33**, the first or inner set of arcuate petal portions of implant **3300** are shown as being substantially like those of implant **3100**. However, in contrast to implant **3100**, each arcuate petal portion of the second set of arcuate petal portions of implant **3300** is formed by arcuate frame members extending between longitudinal members. For example, arcuate petal portion **3340A** is formed by arcuate frame member **3341A** and arcuate frame member **3341B**, which extend between longitudinal member **3348A** and longitudinal member **3348B**.

[0295] As shown in FIG. **33**, longitudinal member **3348A** and longitudinal member **3348B** extend from respective junctions of the first set of arcuate petal portions. For example, longitudinal member **3348A** extends from a junction formed between arcuate petal portion **3320A** and arcuate petal portion **3320B**. Like noted above with respect to implant **3100**, the first and second set of arcuate petal portions of implant **3300** may be rotationally offset from the configuration illustrated in FIG. **33** such that the longitudinal members instead extend from proximal vertices (e.g., proximal vertex **3325**) of the first set of arcuate petal portions.

[0296] In the implementation shown, arcuate frame member **3341A** is proximal and arcuate frame member **3341B** and each of arcuate frame member **3341A** and arcuate frame member **3341B** are distally concave. In other implementations, one or both of arcuate frame member **3341A** and arcuate frame member **3341B** may be proximally concave. Also, in other implementations, the combination of arcuate frame member **3341A** and arcuate frame member **3341B** may be replaced with a single arcuate frame member or supplemented with any suitable number of additional

arcuate frame members. Moreover, the number of arcuate frame members may vary between arcuate petal portions. So, for example, certain arcuate petal portions may include no or only a single arcuate frame member while others may include two or more.

[0297] As previously discussed herein, implants according to this disclosure are capable of transitioning between an expanded state (e.g., when implanted) and a collapsed state (e.g., during delivery). The transition from collapsed state into the expanded state causes a proximal portion of the frame of the implant to travel radially outward away from the central longitudinal axis of the implant. The transition into the expanded state may also include a longitudinal shift of the proximal portion of the frame. As a result, as the implant expands, it extends radially outward but reduces in length along the longitudinal axis.

[0298] The presence, size, and quantity of arcuate petal portions contributes to the overall length of the implant when in the collapsed state. When an arcuate petal portion is collapsed (e.g., when the implant is in the collapsed state), the arcuate petal portion undergoes each of circumferential compression and longitudinal elongation. As a result, a first implant with more and/or larger arcuate petal portions than a second implant will typically have a longer collapsed length than the second implant even when the first and second implants have the same overall dimensions when in their respective expanded states.

[0299] The relationship between collapsed length and arcuate petal portion characteristics may be leveraged to design implants for specific applications. For example, if a surgeon anticipates that delivery and implantation may be challenging, a first implant having a frame with more and/or longer longitudinal members may be selected over a second implant having a frame with more and/or larger arcuate petal portions due to the first implant having a shorter and more maneuverable length when in the collapsed state (i.e., during delivery). In contrast, if additional devices (e.g., pacemaker leads) are to be subsequently implanted in the patient, the surgeon may opt for the second implant due to the size, shape, and positioning of the openings defined by the arcuate petal portions providing additional options and flexibility for delivery and support of the additional devices.

[0300] As another example, designs with a higher proportion of longitudinal members tend to exert less radial force when transitioning between from the collapsed state to the expanded state and may generally exhibit lower radial rigidity. Accordingly, an implant frame with a higher proportion of longitudinal members and a lower proportion of arcuate petal portions (or similar expanding structures) may be selected in implementations in which cardiac tissue may be damaged by higher radial forces or that may require the implant to conform to more complex geometry within the heart.

[0301] FIGS. **31-33** illustrate alternative frame configurations according to this disclosure and are limited to proximally concave designs. The frame configuration may nevertheless be readily adapted to other implant shapes including, but not limited to, implants having overall shapes that are distally concave, frustoconical, planar, or include combinations of different concavities. FIGS. **34-35B**, for example, illustrate certain frame alternatives implemented in implants having a combination of a proximally concave distally concave distal portions.

[0302] FIG. **34** illustrates an implant **3400** having a frame configuration similar to that of implant **3300** of FIG. **33**. Implant **3400** includes a distal end **3402** and a proximal end **3404** such that a longitudinal axis **3406** of implant **3400** extends between distal end **3402** and proximal end **3404**.

[0303] Implant **3400** includes a frame **3408** that may support an occlusive assembly at distal end **3302**. FIG. **34** omits the occlusive assembly to show the various features and configuration of frame **3408** more clearly. Like other implementations discussed herein, when included, the occlusive assembly may include an occlusive body and/or an inner sheet. Implant **3400** may also include an outer sheet (not shown in FIG. **34**) supported on a proximal portion of frame **3408** such that an annular opening is defined between the inner sheet/occlusive assembly and the outer sheet.

[0304] Frame **3408** of implant **3400** includes a distal frame portion **3418** including a set of

circumferentially distributed arcuate petal portions, such as arcuate petal portion **3420A** and arcuate petal portion **3420B**. Frame **3408** further includes a proximal frame portion **3438** including a second set of circumferentially distributed arcuate petal portions, such as arcuate petal portion **3440A** and arcuate petal portion **3440B**. Each arcuate petal portion of the second set of arcuate petal portions of implant **3400** is formed by arcuate frame members extending between longitudinal members. For example, arcuate petal portion **3440A** is formed by arcuate frame member **3441A** and arcuate frame member **3441B**, which extend between longitudinal member **3448A** and longitudinal member **3448B**.

[0305] Longitudinal member **3348A** and longitudinal member **3348B** extend from respective proximal tips of arcuate petal portions of the first set of arcuate petal portions, e.g., longitudinal member **3448A** extends from a proximal tip **3426** of arcuate petal portion **3420A**.

[0306] In contrast to implant **3300** of FIG. **33**, which has a proximally concave shape, implant **3400** of FIG. **34** has varying concavity, like implant **29000** of FIG. **29C**. More specifically, implant **3400** includes each of a proximal portion **3450** that is proximally concave, a distal portion **3452** that is distally concave, and a cap portion **3454** that is proximally concave.

[0307] Implant **3400** further includes circumferentially distributed anchor members, such as anchor member **3456** and anchor member **3458**. Anchor member **3456** is part of a first set of anchor members that extend radially outward from a proximal tip of a respective arcuate frame member.

[0308] Specifically, each anchor member of the first set of anchor members extends from a proximal tip of the distal frame member of each arcuate petal portion. So, for example, anchor member **3456** extends from the proximal tip of arcuate frame member **3441B**. Anchor member **3458**, on the other hand, is part of a second set of anchor members that extend radially outward from junctions between arcuate tip members and longitudinal members. Specifically, each anchor member of the second set of anchor members extends from a respective junction between the proximal frame member of each arcuate petal portion and each longitudinal member. So, for example, anchor member **3458** extends from the junction between arcuate frame member **3441A** and longitudinal member **3348A**. In other implementations, anchor members may alternatively or additionally be disposed at other locations of the frame including, but not limited, to the proximal tip of the proximal arcuate frame member (e.g., arcuate frame member **3441A**) and the junctions formed between the distal arcuate frame members and the longitudinal members.

[0309] FIGS. **35A** and **35B** illustrate another implant **3500** having an overall shape with varying concavities. Implant **3500** includes a distal end **3502** and a proximal end **3504** such that a longitudinal axis **3506** of implant **3500** extends between distal end **3502** and proximal end **3504**. Implant **3500** includes a frame **3508** that may support an occlusive assembly **3510** at distal end **3302**. FIG. **35A** omits the occlusive assembly to show the various features and configuration of frame **3508** more clearly while; however, FIG. **35B** includes occlusive assembly **3510**. Like other implementations discussed herein, occlusive assembly **3510** includes an inner sheet **3512** but may alternatively or additionally include an occlusive body. Implant **3500** may also include an outer sheet **3514** (also shown in FIG. **35B**), which is supported on a proximal portion of frame **3508** such that an annular opening **3516** is defined between inner sheet **3512** and outer sheet **3514**.

[0310] Frame **3508** of implant **3500** includes a distal frame portion **3518** including a set of circumferentially distributed arcuate petal portions, such as arcuate petal portion **3520A** and arcuate petal portion **3520B** (each labelled in FIG. **35A**). Frame **3508** further includes an intermediate frame portion **3538** including a second set of circumferentially distributed arcuate petal portions, such as arcuate petal portion **3540A** and arcuate petal portion **3540B** (each labelled in FIG. **35A**) and a proximal frame portion **3558** including a third set of circumferentially distributed arcuate petal portions, such as arcuate petal portion **3560A** and arcuate petal portion **3560B** (each labelled in FIG. **35A**). As most clearly seen in FIG. **35A**, the first and second set of arcuate petal portions are aligned to facilitate joining of each arcuate petal portion of the first set of arcuate petal portions to a respective arcuate petal portion of the second set of petal portions. For example, a proximal tip

of arcuate petal portion **3520A** is joined to a distal tip of arcuate petal portion **3540A**. In contrast, the second and third sets of arcuate petal portions are rotationally offset and longitudinally overlap each other. For example, arcuate petal portion **3540A** is rotationally offset from and longitudinally overlaps arcuate petal portion **3560A**. Adjacent arcuate petal portions of the second set and the third set may also share common frame elements. For example, arcuate petal portion **3540A** and arcuate petal portion **3560A** each include frame element **3562**.

[0311] Like implant **3400** of FIG. **34** and implant **29000** of FIG. **29C**, implant **3500** of FIGS. **35A** and **35B** has varying concavity. More specifically, implant **3500** includes each of a proximal portion **3550** that is proximally concave, a distal portion **3552** that is distally concave, and a cap portion **3554** that is proximally concave.

[0312] Also, like implant **3400**, implant **3500** includes circumferentially distributed anchor members, such as anchor member **3556**. Anchor member **3556** is part of a set of anchor members that extend radially outward from each junction between adjacent arcuate petal portions of the third set of arcuate petal portions. So, for example, anchor member **3556** extends from a junction **3564** between arcuate petal portion **3560A** and arcuate petal portion **3560B**. In other implementations, anchor members may alternatively or additionally be disposed at other locations of the frame including, but not limited to, junctions between adjacent arcuate petal portions of the second set of arcuate petal portions and the proximal tips of the arcuate petal portions of the third set of arcuate petal portions.

[0313] Implementations of this disclosure corresponding to implant **3500** are not limited to any sizes or dimensions and may be modified or customized to meet the needs of patients and specific applications. Nevertheless, in certain implementations, a proximal radially outward edge **3563** of inner sheet **3512** may be from and including about 16 mm to and including about 30 mm. For example, in one specific implementation proximal radially outward edge **3563** may be 24 mm. Similarly, a distal radially inward edge **3565** of outer sheet **3514** may be from and including about 35 mm to and including about 55 mm. For example, in one specific implementation, proximal radially outward edge **3563** may be 42 mm. A proximal radially outward edge **3566** of implant **3500** may be from and including about 42 mm to and including about 68 mm. In one specific example, proximal radially outward edge **3566** may be 56 mm. In implementations in which implant **3500** includes anchor members, such as anchor member **3556**, at least a portion of the anchor members may be distributed around a common circumference **3567** of implant **3500**. Although the diameter of common circumference **3567** may vary, in at least certain implementations, common circumference **3567** may have a diameter from and including about 42 mm to and including about 68 mm. For example, common circumference **3567** may have a diameter of 54 mm. As a final example, the overall height of implant **3500** in the expanded state may vary; however, in at least certain implementations, the overall height of implant **3500** may be from and including about 26 mm to and including about 48 mm and, in one specific implementation, may be 36 mm.

[0314] While only a select few implementations of this disclosure are shown or described as including anchor members (e.g., protruding anchor members **105** of frame **55**), such anchor members may be added to or otherwise included in any implant design discussed herein. Similarly, while this disclosure discusses control of implant expansion by a tension control line in the context of FIGS. **12-22**, such functionality may be adapted to and included in any other implant discussed herein.

X. ALTERNATIVE DELIVERY TOOL CONFIGURATION

[0315] FIGS. **36-38** illustrate a delivery device **3600** according to an alternative implementation of the present disclosure. More specifically, FIGS. **36** and **37** are schematic illustrations of a distal portion **3602** of delivery device **3600** in a collapsed and expanded state, respectively, and with a valve repair implant omitted for clarity. FIG. **38** is an illustration of delivery device **3600** and, in particular, a proximal view of distal portion **3602** including a valve repair implant **3800** coupled to

delivery device **3600**. Delivery device **3600** includes multiple variations on features previously discussed in this disclosure, each of which is described below in further detail. Notably, while delivery device **3600** incorporates multiple features that differ from previously disclosed implementations, each feature should be considered independent and, as a result, may be readily adapted for inclusion in other implementations included in this disclosure.

[0316] As shown in FIGS. **36-38**, delivery device **3600** includes a delivery catheter **3604** and an extension member **3606** extending from distal portion **3602**. In certain implementations and as discussed below in further detail, extension member **3606** may be selectively extended and retracted from delivery catheter **3604** during deployment of valve repair implant **3800**.

[0317] During deployment and implantation of valve repair implant **3800**, valve repair implant **3800** is releasably coupled to a control arm assembly **3608** of delivery device **3600**. As described below in further detail, the control arm assembly can be manipulated to expand laterally or collapse medially relative to a longitudinal axis **3603** of delivery device **3600**. Due to the coupling of the control arm assembly **3608** to valve repair implant **3800**, such expansion and collapse of the control arm assembly **3608** results in corresponding expansion and collapse of valve repair implant **3800**.

[0318] During delivery and deployment of valve repair implant **3800**, valve repair implant **3800** may be coupled to delivery device **3600** by a cinch line **3614** (shown in FIGS. **37** and **38**). As illustrated, cinch line **3614** forms a loop that extends distally from delivery catheter **3604** and routes through loops, rings, apertures, or similar features of each of the control arm assembly **3608** and valve repair implant **3800** to couple valve repair implant **3800** to the control arm assembly **3608**. In addition to coupling valve repair implant **3800** to delivery device **3600**, cinch line **3614** facilitates accurate control of expansion and collapse of valve repair implant **3800** during deployment and implantation. In particular, cinch line **3614** may be selectively tensioned during to encourage uniform expansion and collapse of valve repair implant **3800**.

[0319] FIGS. **39-44** are detailed views of distal portion **3602** of delivery device **3600** with various components of delivery device **3600** selectively removed to further illustrate the construction and functionality of delivery device **3600**. FIGS. **39-44** are intended to introduce the various internal components of delivery device **3600**, many of which will be discussed in further detail in later sections of this disclosure.

[0320] FIG. **39** shows delivery device **3600** with delivery catheter **3604** and a sheath **3616** (shown in FIG. **38**) removed. As shown, in at least certain implementations, delivery catheter **3604** may be capped with a tip or a collar **3618** through which various components of delivery device **3600** may extend. For example, each of extension member **3606** and control arm assemblies (e.g., control arm assembly **3608**) extend through collar **3618**, which supports and maintains relative positioning of components of delivery device **3600**, such as extension member **3606** and control arm assembly **3608**.

[0321] FIG. **39** further includes a cinch line tube **3620** and a cinch line tube **3622**, each of which extends through delivery catheter **3604** to guide and protect cinch line **3614**. In certain implementations, cinch line tube **3620** and cinch line tube **3622** may be coiled tubes and may be coupled to or otherwise supported by control arm assembly **3608** such that as control arm assembly **3608** expands and collapses, cinch line tube **3620** and cinch line tube **3622** extend and retract from delivery catheter **3604**. Alternatively, cinch line tube **3620** and cinch line tube **3622** may be fixed and extend from delivery catheter **3604**. In still other implementations, cinch line tube **3620** and cinch line tube **3622** may be selectively extended and retracted by a corresponding control of a control assembly disposed on a proximal end of delivery catheter **3604**.

[0322] FIG. **40** illustrates delivery device **3600** with cinch line **3614**, cinch line tube **3620**, cinch line tube **3622**, and collar **3618** removed. As shown, delivery device **3600** may include a support member **3624**, which may be coupled to or otherwise extend from collar **3618**. Support member **3624** may have a cage-like structure that supports and allows longitudinal translation of extension member **3606**. Support member **3624** may further include multiple apertures through which control

arm pairs of control arm assembly **3608** may extend.

[0323] FIG. **41** illustrates delivery device **3600** with support member **3624** removed. As shown, delivery device **3600** may include a distal tube **3626** within which a proximal portion of control arm assembly **3608** is translatable to selectively expand and collapse control arm assembly **3608**. In certain implementations, distal tube **3626** may terminate or be capped with a diverter **3628**, which directs proximal arms (such as proximal arm **3634**) of control arm assembly **3608** in an at least partially lateral/medial direction relative to longitudinal axis **3603** of delivery device **3600** to facilitate expansion and collapse of control arm assembly **3608**. In addition to or as an alternative to diverter **3628**, proximal control arms of control arm assembly **3608** may instead be outwardly curved or otherwise biased into an outwardly curved shape to facilitate expansion and collapse of control arm assembly **3608**.

[0324] FIGS. **42** and **43** illustrate delivery device **3600** with distal tube **3626** removed. In particular, FIG. **42** illustrates delivery device **3600** with control arm assembly **3608** in a collapsed state while FIG. **43** illustrates delivery device **3600** with control arm assembly **3608** in an expanded state.

[0325] As shown, control arm assembly **3608** may include a proximal portion **3630** including a proximal collar **3632** from which multiple proximal arms (e.g., proximal arm **3634**) extend. Delivery device **3600** further includes a distal cap **3638** from which multiple distal arms (e.g., distal arm **3640**) of control arm assembly **3608** extend. As described in further detail later in this disclosure, each of the distal arms forms a control arm pair with a respective one of the proximal arms and each control arm pair may be moved between an expanded and collapsed state by actuating control arm assembly **3608**. In the specific implementation shown in FIGS. **42** and **43**, actuation of control arm assembly **3608** includes proximally driving or distally retracting proximal portion **3630** using a control arm shaft **3642**, which may be coupled to a control assembly of delivery device **3600**, the control assembly including suitable controls for selectively translating control arm shaft **3642**.

[0326] FIG. **44** illustrates delivery device **3600** with control arm assembly **3608** removed. As shown, delivery device **3600** may include an extension member control rod **3644** that extends through delivery catheter **3604** and couples to extension member **3606** to facilitate extension and retraction of extension member **3606** relative to delivery catheter **3604**. In at least some implementations, a proximal end of extension member control rod **3644** may be coupled to a control assembly at a proximal end of delivery catheter **3604**, the control assembly including a control element for selectively translating extension member control rod **3644**.

[0327] With the foregoing in mind for context, the following sections of this disclosure will describe certain features of delivery device **3600** in additional detail.

XI. MULTI-DIRECTIONAL STEERING

[0328] As discussed in the context of FIGS. **11A-11C**, implementations of the present disclosure may include a steerable delivery catheter. For example, valve repair system **1100** illustrated in FIGS. **11A-11C** includes catheter **1177**, which may be inserted into a patient via sheath **1176** and subsequently steered using steering control **1180**. More specifically, catheter **1177** is illustrated and discussed as being steerable along a single plane between two extents, generally illustrated by dashed outlines **1192A** and dashed outlines **1192B**. Accordingly, the implementation illustrated in FIGS. **11A-11C** provides a single degree of freedom for steering catheter **1177**.

[0329] Other implementations of this disclosure may include an alternative delivery catheter configuration that provides multiple degrees of freedom. For example, delivery tools according to this disclosure may be divided into multiple segments, each of which may be steerable along one or more planes. Such increased maneuverability facilitates navigation of the delivery tool to an implant location and final placement of the valve repair implant, among other benefits, ultimately resulting in faster, more efficient, and more accurate implantation procedures.

[0330] FIG. **45A** is a side view of delivery device **3600** with an external sheath removed and

implant **3800** in a deployed and expanded configuration. Delivery device **3600** includes delivery catheter **3604**, which, in certain implementations, may be a steerable catheter. For example, delivery device **3600** includes each of a distal steerable section **4502** and a proximal steerable section **4504**, each of which may be steered independently from a control assembly (not shown) coupled to a proximal end of delivery catheter **3604**.

[0331] Like the distal portion of catheter **1177** of valve repair system **1100**, distal steerable section **4502** may be configured to bend along a plane **4506**. For example, the control assembly coupled to delivery catheter **3604** may include a knob, lever, arm, or similar control element attached to distal steerable section **4502** by a cable, wire, or similar control line such that manipulating the control element bends distal steerable section **4502** across a range of motion along plane **4506**. Although the amount and range of bending may vary, in at least certain implementations, distal steerable section **4502** may be configured to have a minimum bend radius along plane **4506** from and including about 10 mm to and including about 20 mm and in one specific implementation may have a minimum bending radius of about 15 mm. Also, in addition to including control elements adapted to steer distal steerable section **4502**, the control assembly may further include a mechanism (e.g., a knob, slide, button, etc.) for locking the angle of distal steerable section **4502**.

[0332] Proximal steerable section **4504** may be configured to bend along a plane **4508** that is coplanar to plane **4506** when delivery device **3600** is in a neutral/straight configuration. In at least some implementations, proximal steerable section **4504** may also be independently steerable along a second plane, such as plane **4510**. As illustrated, in at least certain implementations, plane **4510** may be orthogonal to plane **4508**. To achieve steering of proximal steerable section **4504**, the control assembly coupled to delivery catheter **3604** may include a respective knob, lever, arm, or similar control element for each degree of freedom of proximal steerable section **4504**. Each such control element may in turn be attached to proximal steerable section **4504** by a cable, wire, or similar control line such that manipulating the control element bends proximal steerable section **4504** along the corresponding plane. Although the amount and range of bending may vary, in at least certain implementations, proximal steerable section **4504** may be configured to independently bend across each of plane **4508** and plane **4510** and to have a minimum bend radius along each plane from and including about 20 mm to and including about 30 mm and in one specific implementation may have a minimum bending radius of about 25 mm. The control assembly may further include respective mechanisms (e.g., knobs, slides, buttons, etc.) for locking each of the steering controls for the proximal steerable section **4504**.

[0333] FIGS. **45B-45H** further illustrate steering of delivery device **3600**. First, FIGS. **45B** and **45C** illustrate steering of distal steerable section **4502** of delivery device **3600**. More specifically, FIG. **45B** illustrates distal steerable section **4502** in a substantial neutral position while FIG. **45C** illustrates steering of distal steerable section **4502** to a first extent along plane **4506** (shown in FIG. **45A**). As shown in FIG. **45B**, in at least certain implementations, distal steerable section **4502** may be steerable along plane **4506** by approximately 135 degrees; however, this disclosure is not limited to any specific bending angle of distal steerable section **4502**. For example, in certain implementations, distal steerable section **4502** may be configured to bend up to 180 degrees or more in a given direction. Moreover, while FIG. **45C** illustrates steering of distal steerable section **4502** in a first direction, in implementations of this disclosure, distal steerable section **4502** may be bidirectionally steerable from the neutral state shown in FIG. **45B**. In at least certain implementations, distal steerable section **4502** may be steerable through approximately 360 degrees of bending along plane **4506**.

[0334] In implementations in which delivery device **3600** is used for delivery of implants for tricuspid valve repair, for example, steering of distal steerable section **4502** as illustrated in FIGS. **45B** and **45C** may be particularly useful in achieving orthogonality between a longitudinal axis of the implant being and/or distal steerable section **4502** and the valve annulus. More specifically, during delivery of the implant to the right atrium, a clinician generally directs delivery device **3600**

into the right atrium via the inferior vena cava with delivery device **3600** in the neutral state illustrated in FIG. **45B**. Following entry into the right atrium, the clinician may steer distal steerable section **4502** to achieve and maintain substantial orthogonality of distal steerable section **4502** and the implant with the tricuspid valve annulus until delivery of the implant is complete. [0335] While the specific bending radius of distal steerable section **4502** may vary based on the size and configuration of delivery device **3600**, in at least certain implementations, distal steerable section **4502** may be configured to have a minimum bending radius of approximately 12.5 mm. Nevertheless, this disclosure contemplates that the overall size of delivery device **3600** and the bending radius of distal steerable section **4502** may be varied based on patient anatomy and other considerations.

[0336] FIGS. **45D** and **45E** illustrate steering of proximal steerable section **4504** of delivery device **3600**. More specifically, FIG. **45D** illustrates proximal steerable section **4504** in a substantial neutral position while FIG. **45E** illustrates proximal steerable section **4504** following bending along plane **4508** (shown in FIG. **45A**). As shown in FIG. **45A**, plane **4506** and plane **4508** are coplanar when delivery device **3600** is in a neutral state.

[0337] FIG. **45E** illustrates how, in at least certain implementations, proximal steerable section **4504** may be steerable along plane **4508** by approximately 45 degrees; however, this disclosure is not limited to any specific bending angle of proximal steerable section **4504** along plane **4508**. For example, in certain implementations, proximal steerable section **4504** may be configured to bend up to 60 degrees or more in a given direction along plane **4508**. Also, similar to distal steerable section **4502**, proximal steerable section **4504** may be bidirectionally steerable along plane **4508**. In certain implementations, the bending radius of proximal steerable section **4504** along plane **4508** may be from and including about 5 cm to and including about 7 cm, for example approximately 6 cm; however, this disclosure is not limited to any particular bending radius for proximal steerable section **4504** along plane **4508**.

[0338] Referring again to procedures for delivery of implants for tricuspid valve repair, steering of proximal steerable section **4504** along plane **4508** may be particularly useful in controlling the height/insertion of the implant and distal steerable section **4502** relative to the valve annulus and for maximizing use of the atrial volume to properly align the implant with the valve annulus. For example, when delivery device **3600** enters the right atrium via the inferior vena cava, distal steerable section **4502** may be oriented such that proximal steerable section **4504** and/or distal steerable section **4502** extend in a partially lateral direction toward the atrial septum. In certain cases, such an orientation can limit the range of motion of distal steerable section **4502** and, as a result, the ability of the clinician to align distal steerable section **4502** with the valve annulus by steering distal steerable section **4502** alone. To increase the range of motion of distal steerable section **4502**, proximal steerable section **4504** may be steered as shown in FIG. **45E** such that proximal steerable section **4504** is maintained near or along the medial surface of the right atrium, thereby increasing the volume of the right atrium available within which distal steerable section **4502** may be steered and manipulated.

[0339] Finally, FIGS. **45F-45H** illustrate steering of proximal steerable section **4504** of delivery device **3600**. More specifically, FIG. **45F** illustrates proximal steerable section **4504** in a substantial neutral position while FIG. **45G** illustrates proximal steerable section **4504** following bending along plane **4510** (shown in FIG. **45A**). As shown in FIG. **45A**, plane **4510** is orthogonal to each of plane **4506** and plane **4508** are coplanar when delivery device **3600** is in a neutral state.

[0340] FIG. **45G** illustrates proximal steerable section **4504** bent along plane **4510** in a first direction from the neutral state illustrated in FIG. **45F** while FIG. **45H** illustrates proximal steerable section **4504** bent along plane **4510** in a second direction from the neutral state and opposite the first direction. In the specific implementation illustrated in FIG. **45F-45H**, bending of proximal steerable section **4504** along plane **4510** is up to approximately 30 degrees in either direction; however, this disclosure is not limited to any specific bending angle of proximal steerable section

4504 along plane **4508**. More generally, in certain implementations, proximal steerable section **4504** may be configured to bend up to about 60 degrees or more in one or both directions relative to neutral along plane **4510**.

[0341] When in use for delivering implants for tricuspid valve repair, steering of proximal steerable section **4504** along plane **4510** may be particularly useful to control offset of the implant relative to the tricuspid valve annulus. After a clinician has successfully positioned an implant using delivery device **3600**, the clinician may generally align the implant to be orthogonal to the annulus of the tricuspid valve by steering each of the distal steerable section **4502** along plane **4506** and proximal steerable section **4504** along plane **4508**. Despite being orthogonally oriented, the implant may nevertheless be misaligned with the valve annulus. For example, a longitudinal axis of the implant being offset relative to the longitudinal axis of the valve annulus. In such instances, steering of proximal steerable section **4504** along plane **4510** may be used to reposition the implant to reduce the offset while maintain orthogonality of the implant relative to the valve annulus.

[0342] FIGS. **46-49** are illustrations of a portion of a steering control assembly **4600** for delivery device **3600** and, in particular, a portion of steering control assembly **4600** including steering controls. As previously noted, steering control assembly **4600** may be coupled to a proximal end of delivery catheter **3604**.

[0343] FIG. **46** is an elevation view of steering control assembly **4600**, which includes a first steering portion **4602**, a second steering portion **4604**, and a third steering portion **4606**. The functions of each steering portion are described below in further detail; however, in the specific implementation illustrated in FIGS. **46-49**, the first, second, and third steering portions generally correspond to a “primary” steering mechanism, a “depth” steering mechanism, and an “offset” steering mechanism, as labelled in the figures and as described below in further detail.

[0344] FIG. **47** is a detailed view of first steering portion **4602**, which is also referred to in this disclosure as the primary steering mechanism. When used in conjunction with delivery device **3600**, first steering portion **4602** may control steering/bending of distal steerable section **4502** along plane **4506**. In at least certain implementations, such movement corresponds to medial and lateral steering movement at the distal end of delivery catheter **3604**. As illustrated in FIG. **47**, first steering portion **4602** may include a steering lever **4608** or that can be manipulated to steer distal steerable section **4502** and a locking knob **4610** for locking the position of steering lever **4608** and, as a result, the direction of distal steerable section **4502** across plane **4506**.

[0345] FIG. **48** is a detailed view of second steering portion **4604**, which is also referred to in this disclosure as the depth steering mechanism. When used in conjunction with delivery device **3600**, second steering portion **4604** may control steering/bending of proximal steerable section **4504** along plane **4508**, which is coplanar to plane **4506** (i.e., the plane of movement for distal steerable section **4502**) when delivery catheter **3604** is in a neutral configuration. In at least certain implementations, such movement corresponds to superior and inferior steering movement at the distal end of delivery catheter **3604**. As illustrated in FIG. **48**, second steering portion **4604** may include a steering lever **4612** that can be manipulated to steer proximal steerable section **4504** and a locking knob **4614** for locking the position of steering lever **4612** and, as a result, the direction of proximal steerable section **4504** across plane **4508**.

[0346] FIG. **49** is a detailed view of third steering portion **4606**, which is also referred to in this disclosure as the offset steering mechanism. When used in conjunction with delivery device **3600**, third steering portion **4606** may control steering/bending of proximal steerable section **4504** along plane **4510**, which is orthogonal to plane **4508**. In at least certain implementations, such movement corresponds to posterior and anterior steering movement at the distal end of delivery catheter **3604**. As illustrated in FIG. **49**, first steering portion **4602** may include a steering lever **4616** that can be manipulated to steer proximal steerable section **4504** and a locking knob **4618** for locking the position of steering lever **4616** and, as a result, the direction of proximal steerable section **4504** across plane **4510**.

[0347] Steering control assembly **4600** is merely as an example implementation of a control assembly that may be used in conjunction with delivery device **3600** and other delivery devices according to this disclosure. Among other things, the number of steerable sections, the directions and degrees of freedom for each steerable section, the range and direction of each steerable section, and other aspects of steering control assembly **4600** and its functionality may vary. The construction and arrangement of steering control assembly **4600** as illustrated in FIGS. **46-49** are also non-limiting and other arrangement of control assembly components are fully considered within the scope of this disclosure.

XII. EXTENDABLE SHEATH

[0348] During delivery of valve repair implant **3800**, implant **3800** is coupled to a distal end of delivery device **3600** and, more specifically to a distal end of delivery catheter **3604** of delivery device **3600**. To maintain implant **3800** in a collapsed state and to facilitate navigation of delivery device **3600** and implant **3800** to an implantation location, delivery device **3600** may include a sheath that extends along an exterior surface of delivery catheter **3604**. FIG. **50**, for example, is an illustration of delivery device **3600** including a sheath **3616** disposed over delivery catheter **3604** and implant **3800**.

[0349] In at least certain implementations, sheath **3616** is translatable relative to delivery catheter **3604**. For example, sheath **3616** may be translatable from an extended configuration to a retracted configuration. In the extended configuration, sheath **3616** may extend sufficiently beyond a distal end of delivery catheter **3604** to cover and at least partially contain implant **3800**. Following delivery of implant **3800** to an implantation region (e.g., into the atrium), sheath **3616** may be retracted, thereby permitting deployment of implant **3800**. In at least certain implementations, sheath **3616** may also be configured to be distally re-extended following deployment and release of implant **3800**. Among other things, such re-extension of sheath **3616** enables sheathing of the distal portion of delivery device **3600** for retraction and removal from the patient.

[0350] In at least certain implementations, sheath **3616** may include one or more embedded radiopaque markers. For example, FIG. **51** is a radiographic image of a delivery tool **5100** according to this disclosure. As shown, delivery tool **5100** includes a sheath **5102**, which further includes a radiopaque marker in the form of a band **5104** (although other radiopaque markers, such as beads, strips, coils, and the like are also contemplated) that is embedded within a distal portion **5106** of sheath **5102**.

[0351] FIGS. **52** and **53** are illustrations of a portion of a sheath control assembly **5200** illustrating an example implementation of sheath controls that may be used in conjunction with delivery device **3600**. Sheath control assembly **5200** includes a knob **5202** which can be rotated to extend and retract sheath **3616**; however, knob **5202** may be substituted with a lever, slide, or similar control element in other implementations. As shown in FIG. **53**, sheath control assembly **5200** may further include a flush port **5204** in communication with an internal volume of sheath **3616** to facilitate flushing of sheath **3616**. Sheath control assembly **5200** may further include a window **5206** and indicators **5208** or similar markings to communicate the position of sheath **3616**. For example, a proximal end of sheath **3616** may be visible through window **5206** and indicators **5208** may be in the form of lines, grooves, marks, etc. disposed adjacent window **5206** with which the proximal end of sheath **3616** may align to indicate the position of sheath **3616**.

[0352] In at least certain implementations, sheath **3616** and sheath control assembly **5200** may be configured to permit from and including about 5 cm to and including about 12 cm of travel. For example, in at least one implementation, sheath **3616** may be retractable up to 8 cm from a fully extended configuration. As shown, sheath control assembly **5200** does not include a locking mechanism for locking the position of sheath **3616**; however, in other implementations, sheath control assembly **5200** may include a locking mechanism (e.g., a knob, clamp, pin, etc.) for locking the position of sheath **3616**, e.g., by positively engaging a portion of sheath **3616** within sheath control assembly **5200** or by preventing manipulation of the control element of sheath control

assembly **5200** for extending and retracting sheath **3616**.

XIII. IMPLANT EXTENSION AND RETRACTION

[0353] During delivery of implant **3800**, implant **3800** is maintained in a collapsed configuration and may also be at least partially covered by sheath **3616**. Implant **3800** may also be partially or entirely disposed within delivery catheter **3604** during delivery. Accordingly, following delivery into the patient heart and prior to final placement, implant **3800** may need to be deployed from delivery catheter **3604**. In addition to retracting sheath **3616**, deployment of implant **3800** may include distally extending implant **3800** from delivery catheter **3604**. Once clear of delivery catheter **3604** and sheath **3616**, implant **3800** may be selectively expanded, collapsed, and located for implantation.

[0354] Due to the shape and construction of implant **3800**, the total length of implant **3800** when collapsed may be substantially longer than the total length of implant **3800** when expanded. To facilitate improved location and implantation of implant **3800**, delivery devices according to this disclosure may include a mechanism for extending implant **3800** from delivery catheter **3604** to a first extent for deployment. Following deployment, the mechanism may enable at least partial de-extension/retraction of implant **3800** to reduce the overall combined length of distal portion **3602** of delivery device **3600** and implant **3800**. Given the confined space of the atria, such reduction in the combined length of delivery device **3600** and implant **3800** can provide substantially increased maneuverability and control of delivery device **3600** and implant **3800**, leading to faster and more accurate implant placement.

[0355] In certain implementations, extension and de-extension/retraction of implant **3800** relative to delivery catheter **3604** may be achieved by extending and retracting extension member **3606** relative to delivery catheter **3604**. As discussed in the context of FIGS. **36-38**, extension member **3606** extends distally from delivery catheter **3604** and supports the distal control arms of the control arm assemblies. During delivery, implant **3800** is attached to delivery device **3600** by coupling implant **3800** to the control arm assemblies. Accordingly, given that the control arm assemblies are coupled to extension member **3606**, extension and retraction of extension member **3606** relative to delivery catheter **3604** also results in extension and retraction of implant **3800** relative to delivery catheter **3604** when implant **3800** is attached to delivery device **3600**.

[0356] FIGS. **54A** and **54B** are illustrations of delivery device **3600** with implant **3800** attached. Specifically, FIG. **54A** illustrates delivery device **3600** and implant **3800** in a fully extended configuration. As previously noted, the fully extended configuration may be used to facilitate initial deployment of implant **3800**, e.g., by fully clearing implant **3800** from sheath **3616** (not shown) and delivery catheter **3604**. To achieve the fully extended configuration, following navigation of distal portion **3602** of delivery device **3600** and implant **3800** into the atrium, delivery device **3600** may be actuated to distally extend extension member **3606** relative to delivery catheter **3604**, thereby enabling deployment and expansion of implant **3800**. Following deployment and expansion, extension member **3606** may be at least partially retracted relative to delivery catheter **3604**, resulting in the retracted/de-extended configuration of FIG. **45B**. In at least certain implementations, extension member **3606** may be configured to undergo from and including about 15 mm to and including about 25 mm of travel relative to delivery catheter **3604** with possible retraction/de-extension from and including about 50% to and including about 80% of the total travel distance of extension member **3606**. For example, in one specific implementation, extension member **3606** may be configured to have approximately 20 mm of total travel with at least 12 mm of retraction/de-extension available following deployment of implant **3800**.

[0357] FIG. **55** is an illustration of a portion of a deployment control assembly **5500** illustrating an example implementation of extension/de-extension controls that may be used in conjunction with delivery device **3600**. Deployment control assembly **5500** includes an extension handle **5502** which can be rotated to extend and retract extension member **3606**; however, extension handle **5502** may be substituted with a lever, slide, knob, or similar control element in other implementations.

XIV. CONTROL ARM ASSEMBLY AND CINCH LINE ROUTING

[0358] As previously discussed, control arm assembly **3608** enables selective expansion and collapse of implant **3800** during deployment and implantation of implant **3800**. To do so, control arm assembly **3608** includes multiple control arm pairs with each control arm pair including a proximal arm and a distal arm. Each proximal arm is shaped, biased, diverted, or otherwise configured such that when the proximal arm extends distally from delivery catheter **3604** the proximal at least partially extends in a lateral/medial direction relative to longitudinal axis **3603** of delivery device **3600**. A distal portion of each proximal arm is coupled to a proximal portion of its respective distal arm such that the distal arm similarly extends in a lateral/medial direction based on the degree of extension of the proximal arm. The distal arm generally provides support and stability to the proximal arm; however, in certain implementations, the proximal portion of the distal arm may also include a ring, a loop, an aperture, or similar feature through which cinch line **3614** may pass to couple implant **3800** to delivery device **3600**.

[0359] FIGS. **56** and **57** illustrate distal portion **3602** of delivery device **3600** with control arm assembly **3608** in a collapsed and expanded state, respectively. The following discussion describes operation of control arm assembly **3608** by referring primarily to proximal arm **3634** and distal arm **3640**. Such references are intended for clarity and conciseness only. Unless otherwise specified, references to proximal arm **3634** and distal arm **3640** should be considered to apply generally to the other proximal and distal arms of control arm assembly **3608**.

[0360] As illustrated in FIG. **56**, when in the collapsed state, proximal arm **3634** and distal arm **3640** lie substantially flat and parallel to longitudinal axis **3603** of delivery device **3600**. As control arm assembly **3608** is expanded, e.g., by pushing proximal portion **3630** of control arm assembly **3608** with control arm shaft **3642** as discussed in the context of FIGS. **42** and **43**, distal portion **3636** of proximal arm **3634** travels in a partially lateral direction. In certain implementations, lateral travel of distal portion **3636** results from proximal arm **3634** having a shape or being biased in an outwardly curved direction. Alternatively, or in addition, delivery device **3600** may include a diverter or similar structural element (such as diverter **3628** illustrated in FIG. **41**) that directs proximal arm **3634** in a lateral direction as proximal arm **3634** extends from delivery catheter **3604**, as shown in FIG. **57**.

[0361] Due to the coupling of distal portion **3636** of proximal arm **3634** with a proximal portion **3641** of distal arm **3640**, extension of proximal arm **3634** from delivery catheter **3604** applies a lateral force to proximal portion **3641** of distal arm **3640**. In the implementation shown in FIGS. **56** and **57**, a distal portion **3643** of distal arm **3640** is fixed to distal cap **3638** of extension member **3606**. Accordingly, as a lateral force is applied to proximal portion **3641** of distal arm **3640**, distal portion **3643** of distal arm **3640** bends outwardly. In other implementations, distal arm **3640** may instead be coupled to distal cap **3638** by a hinge or similar movable joint that permits lateral movement of proximal portion **3641** of distal arm **3640** without substantial bending.

[0362] Collapse of control arm assembly **3608** may be achieved by retracting proximal portion **3630** of control arm assembly **3608**, which in turn causes retraction of proximal arm **3634** into delivery catheter **3604**. Due again to the coupling of distal portion **3636** of proximal arm **3634** with a proximal portion **3641** of distal arm **3640**, retraction of proximal arm **3634** into delivery catheter **3604** applies a medial force to proximal portion **3641** of distal arm **3640**, thereby causing distal arm **3640** to return to a collapsed configuration.

[0363] FIG. **58** illustrates an example coupling arrangement of proximal arm **3634** with distal arm **3640** in further detail. As illustrated, distal portion **3636** of proximal arm **3634** may include a first feature, e.g., a protrusion **3637**, shaped to be inserted into and retained by a second feature, e.g., an aperture **3639** of distal arm **3640**. For example, FIG. **58** shows protrusion **3637** as being T-, dogbone-, or barbell-shaped and aperture **3639** as an ovate slot. Accordingly, protrusion **3637** may be rotated 90 degrees, inserted through aperture **3639**, and unrotated to cause protrusion **3637** to be retained by aperture **3639** and coupling distal portion **3636** to distal arm **3640**. In other

implementations, the protrusion and aperture may be reversed such that a protrusion of distal arm **3640** extends through and is retained by an aperture of proximal arm **3634**. This disclosure contemplates other coupling arrangements of proximal arm **3634** with distal arm **3640** and notes that any coupling that permits the necessary movement of proximal arm **3634** relative to distal arm **3640** for expansion of control arm assembly **3608** may be used instead of the specific coupling arrangement illustrated in FIG. **58**.

[0364] FIG. **59** is a detailed view of coupling between control arm assembly **3608** and implant **3800**. As previously discussed, coupling of delivery device **3600** to implant **3800** is by cinch line **3614**, which forms a loop through delivery device **3600** and about an inner circumference of implant **3800**. More specifically, cinch line **3614** extends through delivery catheter **3604** (e.g., through cinch line tube **3620**). Cinch line **3614** is then routed through apertures extending around each of control arm assembly **3608** and implant **3800**. Cinch line **3614** is then rerouted back through delivery catheter **3604** (e.g., through cinch line tube **3622**) to a proximal end of delivery catheter **3604**.

[0365] In certain implementations, the apertures of implant **3800** may be in the form of hoops, loops, or rings (e.g., ring **3804**) extending around an inner surface **3802** of implant **3800**. The apertures of control arm assembly **3608** may similarly be in the form of hoops, loops, or rings (e.g., ring **3646**) coupled to control arm assembly **3608**. For example, in the implementation of FIG. **58**, ring **3646** is attached to and extends from proximal portion **3641** of distal arm **3640**. In other implementations, distal arm **3640** or distal portion **3636** may define and include an integrally formed hole, port, or similar opening that functions as the aperture through which cinch line **3614** extends.

[0366] By routing cinch line **3614** through each of the apertures of control arm assembly **3608** and each of the apertures of implant **3800**, implant **3800** can be coupled to delivery device **3600**. Additionally, such an arrangement also enables cinch line **3614** to provide additional control and uniformity when expanding and collapsing implant **3800** during deployment and implantation. For example, given that cinch line **3614** extends around the circumference of implant **3800**, applying tension to cinch line **3614** results in a distributed medial pulling force about implant **3800**. As implant **3800** is collapsed, this distributed medial force encourages implant **3800** to collapse uniformly, thereby improving control and predictability during collapse of implant **3800**. The distributed medial force may also act as a counterforce when expanding implant **3800**, which, again, encourages implant **3800** to expand uniformly and improving control and predictability of implant expansion.

[0367] In certain implementations of this disclosure, delivery device **3600** may include a control assembly including control elements for adjusting expansion and collapse of control arm assembly **3608** and operation of cinch line **3614**. Referring back to FIG. **55**, for example, deployment control assembly **5500** includes an expansion handle **5504** that can be rotated to selectively expand and collapse implant **3800** when implant **3800** is coupled to control arm assembly **3608**. For example, rotation of expansion handle **5504** may translate control arm shaft **3642** relative to delivery catheter **3604**. As previously noted, such translation may push or pull proximal portion **3630** of control arm assembly **3608**, thereby causing expansion of control arm assembly **3608**. In other implementations, expansion handle **5504** may be replaced with other control elements, such as a lever, knob, or similar component for selectively translating control arm shaft **3642** relative to delivery catheter **3604**.

[0368] Deployment control assembly **5500** further includes a tensioner **5506** for controlling tension on cinch line **3614**. When assembled, tensioner **5506** couples to a first end of cinch line **3614** while a second end of cinch line **3614** may be fixed at another point on deployment control assembly **5500**.

[0369] Tensioner **5506** may be selectively movable, e.g., along a rail **5508**, such that by proximally translating tensioner **5506**, tension on cinch line **3614** can be increased. Conversely, by distally

translating tensioner **5506**, tension can be reduced.

[0370] In at least certain implementations, implant **3800** is released from delivery device **3600** by cutting cinch line **3614** at deployment control assembly **5500** and subsequently pulling cinch line **3614** from delivery catheter **3604**.

XV. CONTROL ASSEMBLY AND MOUNTING

[0371] Previous sections of this disclosure describe alternative configurations for a control assembly of delivery device **3600**. In general, such control assemblies provide various control elements for actuating various components of delivery device **3600**. Among other things, such control elements include those for extending and retracting sheath **3616**, steering delivery catheter **3604**, extending and retracting extension member **3606**, expanding and collapsing control arm assembly **3608**, and controlling tension on cinch line **3614**.

[0372] FIG. **60** is a proximal portion of delivery device **3600** and, in particular, a control assembly **6000** of delivery device **3600**. As shown, control assembly **6000** combines various control assembly sections previously discussed in this disclosure. For example, control assembly **6000** combines (from most distal to most proximal) each of sheath control assembly **5200**, steering control assembly **4600**, and deployment control assembly **5500**. Notably, control assembly **6000** is intended only as an example control assembly for use with delivery devices according to this disclosure and that provides various functions for delivering, deploying, and implanting valve repair implants. While not specifically illustrated other implementations of control assemblies may include alternative arrangements of control assembly sections and additional structural elements (e.g., an outer housing, grips, etc.), among other things.

[0373] FIG. **61** is an example mounting arrangement for delivery device **3600**, including control assembly **6000**. In the example configuration, control assembly **6000** is received within a mount **6050** coupled to and supported by a rail **6052**. Rail **6052**, in turn, is coupled to an articulating arm **6060**, which may be fixed to a bed, table, support stand, or similar stable structure.

[0374] Although other mounting configurations are contemplated, the configuration illustrated in FIG. **61** is advantageous in that it provides two additional degrees of freedom for delivery device **3600**. First, mount **6050** includes a rotating cradle **6054** that receives delivery device **3600**. Second, mount **6050** is coupled to rail **6052** by a stepper-type mount such that insertion of delivery device **3600** is controllable by a knob **6056**. Mount **6050** may further include additional controls for locking each of rotating cradle **6054** and the position of mount **6050** on rail **6052**.

XVI. EXAMPLE IMPLANTATION PROCESS

[0375] To provide additional detail and context for the various features described in the preceding sections, FIG. **62** is a block diagram illustrating a method **6200** for implanting implant **3800** using delivery device **3600**. The following methodology is generally directed to delivery of an implant for purposes of repairing a tricuspid valve; however, the described process may be readily adapted for use in mitral valve repair and replacement. More generally, implementations of this disclosure are not strictly limited to repair of a specific cardiac valve; rather, this disclosure recognizes that the devices, systems, and methods described in this disclosure may be readily adapted for use with either cardiac valve.

[0376] At step **6202**, implant **3800** is delivered to a patient atrium, e.g., via an antegrade percutaneous route (e.g., a trans-femoral or trans-jugular route). During delivery, implant **3800** is coupled to a distal end of delivery device **3600** by cinch line **3614** with sheath **3616** extending over a distal end of delivery device **3600**, including at least a portion of implant **3800**. As previously discussed, coupling of implant **3800** to delivery device **3600** may include routing cinch line **3614** through a first set of apertures disposed around an interior circumference of implant **3800**, such as a series of loops or rings distributed about the interior circumference of implant **3800**. Cinch line **3614** is further routed through a second set of apertures of control arm assembly **3608**, thereby coupling implant **3800** to control arm assembly **3608** using cinch line **3614**. In at least some implementations, the apertures of control arm assembly **3608** may be rings coupled to proximal

portions of the distal control arms of control arm assembly **3608**. For example, FIG. 59 shows ring **3646** coupled to proximal portion **3641** of distal arm **3640**.

[0377] In at least some implementations, navigating delivery device **3600** and implant **3800** to the implantation site may include routing delivery device **3600** along a guidewire previously inserted into the patient and extending to the atrium.

[0378] Step **6204** includes retracting sheath **3616** to facilitate subsequent deployment of implant **3800**. As discussed in previous sections, retracting sheath **3616** may include manipulating a control of control assembly **6000** to proximally translate sheath **3616** relative to delivery catheter **3604**.

[0379] Step **6206** includes deploying implant **3800**. Deploying implant **3800** generally refers to the process of clearing implant **3800** from sheath **3616** and delivery catheter **3604** such that implant **3800** can be freely expanded, collapsed, and positioned for implantation. Deploying implant **3800** may include partially expanding implant **3800**, e.g., by expanding control arm assembly **3608**. For example, a user may partially expand control arm assembly **3608** by rotating a corresponding handle or knob of control assembly **6000**. Deploying implant **3800** may also include at least partially extending implant **3800** distally relative to delivery catheter **3604**. In at least some implementations, extending implant **3800** may include distally extending extension member **3606** relative to delivery catheter **3604** using a corresponding control of control assembly **6000**.

[0380] Step **6208** includes retracting/de-extending implant **3800** relative to delivery catheter **3604** following at least partial expansion of implant **3800**. As previously discussed, in certain implementations, initial deployment of implant **3800** may require that implant **3800** extend to a first distal extent beyond delivery catheter **3604**, e.g., to permit clearance of implant **3800** from sheath **3616** and delivery catheter **3604**. Once deployed, however, implant **3800** may be longitudinally retracted/de-extended to make the combination of the distal portion of delivery device **3600** and implant **3800** more compact. Among other things, the more compact configuration improves maneuverability of implant **3800** within the heart, thereby increasing the speed and accuracy with which implant **3800** can be positioned and implanted.

[0381] Step **6210** includes positioning implant **3800** for implantation. In at least certain implementations, positioning implant **3800** may include positioning implant **3800** such that an occlusive element of implant **3800** is at the level of the native leaflets or otherwise positioned to contact and interact with the native leaflets. During certain procedures, positioning implant **3800** may also include additional expanding, collapsing, and/or moving of implant **3800** to achieve proper positioning. Accordingly, step **6210** may include one or more of expanding/collapsing control arm assembly **3608**, extending/retracting extension member **3606**, steering delivery catheter **3604**, or any other articulation of delivery device **3600** necessary to properly position implant **3800** within the heart.

[0382] Step **6212** includes fully expanding implant **3800** once implant **3800** is in position for implantation. Fully expanding implant **3800** may include expanding control arm assembly **3608** to or near its fullest extent. Notably, in most applications and when implant **3800** is properly positioned relative to the cardiac valve, such expansion will cause implant **3800** to interfere with and engage cardiac tissue. For example, implant **3800** may include outwardly protruding prongs shaped and positioned to engage tissue adjacent the valve.

[0383] Step **6214** includes releasing implant **3800** from delivery device **3600**. Releasing implant **3800** from delivery device **3600** includes decoupling implant **3800** from delivery device **3600** by removing cinch line **3614**. For example, cinch line **3614** may be cut at control assembly **6000** and subsequently pulled from delivery device **3600**. During pulling, the cut end of cinch line **3614** passes through the apertures of control arm assembly **3608** and implant **3800**, resulting in implant **3800** being decoupled from control arm assembly **3608**.

[0384] Step **6216** includes preparing delivery device **3600** for retraction and removal from the patient. In general, preparation of delivery device **3600** includes collapsing delivery device **3600** to its fullest extent and sheathing distal portion **3602** of delivery device **3600**. For example, preparing

delivery device **3600** for retraction may include fully collapsing control arm assembly **3608**, retracting/de-extending extension member **3606**, and re-extending cinch line **3614** over the distal end of delivery device **3600**.

[0385] Step **6218** includes retracting delivery catheter **3604** from the patient, substantially completing the implantation process.

XVII. ADDITIONAL ALTERNATIVE IMPLANT AND OCCLUDER DESIGNS

[0386] FIGS. **63A-64N** illustrate an implant **6300** according to another implementation of the present disclosure. Specifically, FIG. **63A** is a perspective proximal-side (atrial-side when implanted) view of implant **6300** while FIGS. **63B** and **63C** are perspective and plan views of a distal side of implant **6300**, respectively. FIG. **63D** is the same as FIG. **63C** albeit with various dimensions indicated. FIGS. **64A-64N** illustrate a frame **6355** of implant **6300** and various details of frame **6355**. FIGS. **63A-63C** illustrate implant **6300** in an expanded state, such as when implant **6300** is implanted in a cardiac valve to be repaired.

[0387] As illustrated in FIGS. **63A-63D**, implant **6300** generally includes a distal end **6340** and a proximal end **6345**. Distal end **6340** serves as the leading end of implant **6300** during implantation and is directed toward the ventricle following implantation within the valve annulus. Implant **6300** further includes an occluder **6302** disposed at distal end **6340**. Occluder **6302** is coupled to and supported on frame **6355**. In contrast to previous occluders disclosed herein, which included bulb-type occluders (including those with sheet-style skirts) and sheet-type occluders, occluder **6302** is a cap-style occluder formed by laminating multiple sheets of material about a distal portion of frame **6355**. Implant **6300** further includes an outer sheet **6360** supported by frame **6355**. When in the expanded state, frame **6355** radiates laterally outward relative to a central longitudinal axis **6370** (indicated in FIGS. **63A** and **63B**) of implant **6300** with occluder **6302** forming a distal surface **6361** and outer sheet **6360** forming an annular surface **6364**. Further details regarding occluder **6302** and outer sheet **6360** are illustrated and discussed below in the context of FIGS. **65A-65F** for occluder **6302** and FIGS. **66A-67**, respectively.

[0388] Distal surface **6361** formed by occluder **6302** includes a proximal radially outward edge **6363** while annular surface **6364** of outer sheet **6360** forms each of a distal radially inward edge **6365** and a proximal radially outward edge **6366**. Proximal radially outward edge **6363** of distal surface **6361** and distal radially inward edge **6365** of annular surface **6364** define an opening **6367** between occluder **6302** and outer sheet **6360**.

[0389] As with previous implants of this disclosure, implant **6300** may be transitioned into a collapsed state for delivery to the target implantation site. When collapsed, frame **6355**, occluder **6302**, and outer sheet **6360** may collapse symmetrically about central longitudinal axis **6370**. Also, like previous implants of this disclosure, frame **6355** may be biased into expansion such that implant **6300** self-expands into the expanded state, e.g., to anchor itself within the target cardiac valve annulus.

[0390] Each of occluder **6302** and outer sheet **6360** are supported on frame **6355**. In the specific example shown, occluder **6302** is coupled to and supported on frame **6355** by a bonding and lamination process. More specifically, at least one first layer of occluder **6302** is disposed on a distal surface of frame **6355** while at least one second layer of occluder **6302** is disposed on a proximal surface of frame **6355**. Subsequent bonding of the layers (e.g., by application of an epoxy or other adhesive, heating, etc.) simultaneously forms occluder **6302** and couples occluder **6302** to frame **6355**. In contrast, outer sheet **6360** is illustrated as being coupled to frame **6355** by sutures extending along distal radially inward edge **6365**, proximal radially outward edge **6366**, and frame **6355**. Each of the lamination of occluder **6302** and the suturing of outer sheet **6360** to frame **6355** is described below in further details.

[0391] Implementations of this disclosure are not strictly limited to particular sizes or dimensions and may be modified or customized to meet the needs of patients and specific applications. Nevertheless, and without limitation to the scope of this disclosure, certain specific examples of

dimensions are provided and indicated in FIG. 63D.

[0392] In certain implementations, occluder **6302** may have a diameter (D1) from and including about 16 mm to and including about 28 mm, with the maximum diameter generally corresponding to the diameter of occluder **6302**. For example, occluder **6302** may have a maximum diameter of about 22 mm.

[0393] In other implementations, outer sheet **6360** may have an inner diameter (D2) (e.g., the diameter of distal radially inward edge **6365**) from and including about 36 mm to and including about 46 mm. For example, distal radially inward edge **6365** may have a diameter of about 41 mm.

[0394] As shown in FIG. 63D, each of outer sheet **6360** and frame **6355** may have a sinusoidal or otherwise varying proximal edge. In such implementations, proximal radially outward edge **6363** may be defined by each of a minimum diameter (D3) and a maximum diameter (D4). Among other things, a varying proximal edge balances robust anchoring of the implant within the valve annulus with reduced interference of the implant with native cardiac structures. More specifically, a sinusoidal proximal edge of frame **6355** and outer sheet **6360** provides robust anchoring and support by allowing frame **6355** to extend onto and to be distributed over a wider area about the valve annulus. In contrast, the sinusoidal edge of frame **6355** reduces the proximal portion of outer sheet **6360** as compared to similar configurations with the same maximum diameter but a circular proximal edge, thereby reducing the potential for interference between implant **6300** and other cardiac structures.

[0395] With the foregoing in mind, in at least certain implementations, the minimum diameter of proximal radially outward edge **6363** (D3) may be from and including about 48 mm to and including about 68 mm. For example, the minimum diameter of proximal radially outward edge **6363** may be approximately 58 mm. Similarly, the maximum diameter of proximal radially outward edge **6363** (D4) may be from and including about 58 mm to and including about 78 mm, but at least as large as the minimum diameter of proximal radially outward edge **6363**. For example, in one specific example, the maximum diameter of proximal radially outward edge **6363** may be about 68 mm.

[0396] While this disclosure notes that a sinusoidal or varying configuration for proximal radially outward edge **6363** provides certain advantages, such a configuration is not necessary and implementations of this disclosure are not limited to configurations in which proximal radially outward edge **6363** varies. Accordingly, while not specifically illustrated in the context of implant **6300**, this disclosure also contemplates that proximal radially outward edge **6363** of implant **6300** may be of constant diameter/circular.

[0397] While the height of implant **6300** is generally defined as the distance between distal extent **6375** and the proximal extent of proximal radially outward edge **6363**. Like other aspects of implant **6300**, the height of implant **6300** may vary, e.g., to accommodate variations in patient anatomy. In at least certain implementations, however, the overall height of implant **6300** may be from and including about 15 mm to and including about 25 mm. For example, the overall height of implant **6300** may be approximately 20 mm.

[0398] Further details regarding the construction of implant **6300** are provided with reference to FIGS. 64A-M, which illustrate frame **6355** in detail. More specifically, FIG. 64A is a distal isometric view of frame **6355**, FIG. 64B is a distal elevation view of frame **6355**, and FIG. 64C is an elevation view of frame **6355**. FIGS. 64D and 64E are views of frame **6355** indicating specific features and elements of interest. FIGS. 64F-64K are detailed views of those features. FIG. 64L and FIG. 64M are side/elevation views of frame **6355** while FIG. 64N is a detailed view of a single spoke of frame **6355**.

[0399] Referring first to FIGS. 64A-C, frame **6355** includes distal frame portion **6358**, which supports occluder **6302** when fully assembled, and a proximal frame portion **6359**, which supports outer sheet **6360**. In general, each of distal frame portion **6358** and proximal frame portion **6359** include a set of circumferentially distributed petal portions configured to collapse and expand as

implant **6300** is similarly collapsed and expanded during delivery and implantation.

[0400] While this disclosure contemplates that frame **6355** may be manufactured and assembled in various ways, in at least certain implementations, frame **6355** is formed as a unitary component by precision cutting a tubular substrate of material suitable for use in medical implants. For example, in at least certain implementations, frame **6355** is cut from high-cycle fatigue (HCF) nitinol tubing. The frame, as cut from the tubing, may be subsequently heated and bent into the final shape illustrated in the figures and described in the following section using a shape setting process consistent with the substrate material. Subsequent processing of the frame, such as electropolishing, passivation, deburring, cleaning, and the like, may also be applied to achieve the finished frame product.

[0401] As most clearly shown in FIG. **64B**, distal frame portion **6358** may include radially extending and circumferentially distributed inner petal portions, such as inner petal portion **6380A** and inner petal portion **6380B**. The inner arcuate petal portions may be ovate, diamond-shaped, or otherwise have a similar elongate shape (e.g., generally diamond shaped albeit with rounded vertices and/or curved edges). Each inner petal portion may be defined by respective major and minor axes. For example, as shown in FIG. **64J**, inner petal portion **6380A** has a major axis **6381A** that extends in a radial/longitudinal direction and a minor axis **6382A** that extends in a substantially circumferential direction. In certain implementations, adjacent inner petal portions may be joined at or near the vertices along the minor axis. For example, and as indicated in FIG. **64J**, inner petal portion **6380A** and inner petal portion **6380B** are joined at a junction **6384** disposed distal minor axis vertices of inner petal portion **6380A** and inner petal portion **6380B**.

[0402] Referring to FIG. **64B**, proximal frame portion **6359** may similarly include outer petal portions that may be ovate, diamond-shaped, or have another elongate shape. Each such outer petal portion may be defined by respective major and minor axes. For example, and as shown in FIG. **64K**, outer petal portion **6385A** may have a major axis **6386A** that extends in a substantially longitudinal direction and a minor axis **6387A** that extends in a circumferential direction. In certain implementations, adjacent outer petal portions of proximal frame portion **6359** may be joined at or near the vertices along the minor axis (i.e., the co-vertices of the outer petal portions). For example, outer petal portion **6385A** and outer petal portion **6385B** are joined at a junction **6389** disposed at the corresponding co-vertices of outer petal portion **6385A** and outer petal portion **6385B**.

[0403] Referring back to FIG. **64B**, frame **6355** generally includes members, struts, spokes, or similar elongate members. When frame **6355** is in a collapsed state, the spokes extend in a substantially longitudinal direction; however, as frame **6355** expands, the spokes/struts extend radially outward as well as proximally. As shown in FIG. **64B**, a spoke/strut extends from each of the arcuate petal portions of the distal frame portion **6358** and, more specifically, from the proximal vertex of each of arcuate petal portion. For example, FIGS. **64B** and **64J** illustrate each of a spoke **6395A** extending from a vertex **6396A** of inner petal portion **6380A** and a spoke **6395B** extending from vertex **6396B** of inner petal portion **6380B**.

[0404] Referring again to FIG. **64B**, each spoke extends from its corresponding inner petal portion of distal frame portion **6358** to a respective junction between outer arcuate petal portions of the proximal frame portion **6359**. For example, FIG. **64M** illustrates spoke **6395C** terminating at junction **6389** between outer petal portion **6385A** and outer petal portion **6385B**.

[0405] Each spoke may further extend to form an anchor member (e.g., a spike, tine, or hook) disposed between adjacent outer petal portions. For example, each of FIGS. **64B** and **64M** include anchor member **6399** disposed between outer petal portion **6385A** and outer petal portion **6385B** and extending from junction **6389**. As illustrated, anchor members are included between each pair of adjacent outer petal portions; however, this disclosure contemplates that more or fewer anchor members may be included and the distribution of anchor members about frame **6355** may vary. For example, in addition to anchor members disposed between adjacent outer petal portions, additional anchor members may extend from the distal vertex of one of more of the outer petal portions. As

another non-limiting alternative, anchor members may extend from every other or every third junction between adjacent outer petal portions.

[0406] FIGS. **64D** and **64E** are views of frame **6355** indicating specific features and elements of interest, which are shown in detail in subsequent FIGS. **64F-64I**. More specifically, FIG. **64D** is a side elevation view of frame **6355** with frame **6355** oriented with a spoke/anchor member directed outward from the figure. In contrast, FIG. **64E** is an angled side view of frame **6355** with frame **6355** oriented with an outer petal portion directed outward from the figure (i.e., at a 90-degree rotation relative to the view shown in FIG. **64D**). As shown in FIG. **64D**, FIG. **64F** is a side elevation view of a portion of frame **6355** and, in particular, a detailed view of a spoke section **6400** extending that generally extends between an inner petal portion of frame **6355** and a junction between adjacent outer petal portions. For example, spoke section **6400** may correspond to sections of spoke **6395A** and spoke **6395B** extending between the inner petal portions of frame **6355** and their corresponding junctions of outer petal portions. The specific curvature of spoke section **6400** is discussed below in further detail in the context of FIGS. **64N-P**. However, as shown in FIG. **64F**, spoke section **6400** has a generally distally convex curvature. While the specific dimensions of spoke section **6400** may vary, in at least some implementations, spoke section **6400** may have a thickness **6402** from and including about 0.2 mm to and including about 0.4 mm. For example, in one specific implementation, thickness **6402** may be about 0.32 mm with a tolerance of ± 0.04 mm. In implementations in which frame **6355** is formed by cutting frame **6355** from a tubular substrate, thickness **6402** may correspond to the thickness of the tubular substrate.

[0407] As further shown in FIG. **64D**, FIG. **64G** is a side elevation view of an anchor member **6404** of frame **6355**. For example, anchor member **6404** may correspond to anchor member **6399** of frame **6355** or any other anchor member distributed about frame **6355**. As previously discussed, anchor members of implants according to this disclosure are generally configured to engage tissue surrounding the valve annulus to facilitate anchoring of the implant relative to the valve annulus during implantation. The specific size, shape, angle, and similar characteristics of anchor member **6404** may vary based on the application; however, FIG. **64G** illustrates one non-limiting example configuration of anchor member **6404** that has demonstrated positive results in testing. As illustrated, anchor member **6404** extends from a junction **6406**, which, as previously discussed, is generally located between adjacent outer petal portions. For example, junction **6389** of frame **6355** is shown in FIG. **64B** as being located between outer petal portion **6385A** and outer petal portion **6385B**. As shown, anchor member **6404** may be integral with junction **6406** and may be formed by distally bending or curving anchor member **6404**.

[0408] The performance characteristics of anchor member **6404** can be varied and controlled by modifying the geometry of anchor member **6404** and its geometric relationship (e.g., angle) relative to the other portions of **6355**. For example, FIG. **64G** indicates a depth **6408** or linear distance of anchor member **6404**, which generally corresponds to a maximum linear distance between a tip **6410** of anchor member **6404** and the outer surface of a junction **6406** between adjacent outer petal portions (e.g., junction **6389** between outer petal portion **6385A** and outer petal portion **6385B**). While depth **6408** may vary, in at least some implementations, depth **6408** may be from about 1.0 mm to 3.5 mm. For example, in one specific implementation, depth **6408** may be about 2.2 mm with a tolerance of ± 0.4 mm.

[0409] Performance characteristics of anchor member **6404** can also be varied and controlled by modifying a thickness **6412** of anchor member **6404**. While thickness **6412** may vary, in at least some implementation, thickness **6412** may be from and including about 0.2 mm to and including about 0.4 mm. For example, thickness **6412** may be about 0.32 mm with a tolerance of ± 0.04 mm.

[0410] In implementations in which frame **6355** is formed by cutting frame **6355** from a tubular substrate, thickness **6412** may correspond to the thickness of the tubular substrate.

[0411] SAs indicated in FIG. **64E**, FIGS. **64H** and **64I** are detailed views of respective outer petal

portions and, specifically, proximal extents of the outer petal portions. More specifically, FIG. 64H illustrates an outer petal portion **6414** and, specifically, a detailed front view of a proximal chevron **6416** of outer petal portion **6414**. FIG. 64I, in contrast, illustrates an outer petal portion **6424** and, in particular, a detailed side view of a proximal chevron **6426** of outer petal portion **6424**.

[0412] Referring first to FIG. 64H, proximal chevron **6416** is formed at the junction of two petal sections, namely, petal section **6420A** and petal section **6420B**. As previously noted, in certain implementations of this disclosure, frame **6355** is laser cut from a tubular substrate such that certain dimensions may be controlled or otherwise dictated by the wall thickness of the tubular substrate. In contrast, when frame **6355** is cut from a tubular substrate, the width of petal section **6420A** and petal section **6420B** generally correspond to circumferential lengths of the tubular substrate and, as a result, are controlled and dictated by cuts made to the tubular substrate. Stated differently, the width of petal section **6420A** and petal section **6420B** can be varied and controlled and are not necessarily limited to any specific dimensions of the tubular substrate from which frame **6355** is cut. For example, FIG. 64H illustrates a width **6422** of each of petal section **6420A** and petal section **6420B**. While width **6422** may vary, in at least certain implementations, width **6422** may be from and including about 0.2 mm to and including about 0.4 mm. For example, in one specific implementation, width **6422** may be 0.32 mm with a tolerance of ± 0.04 mm.

[0413] Referring next to FIG. 64I, proximal chevron **6426** of outer petal portion **6424** is formed at the junction of two petal sections, namely, petal section **6428A** and petal section **6428B**, each of which generally has a thickness **6430**. In certain implementations thickness **6430** may be controlled by or otherwise correspond to a wall thickness of a tubular substrate from which frame **6355** is cut.

[0414] Thickness **6430** may vary; however, in at least certain implementations, thickness **6430** may be from and including about 0.2 mm to and including about 0.4 mm. For example, thickness **6412** may be about 0.32 mm with a tolerance of ± 0.04 mm.

[0415] Like previous frames discussed herein, frame **6355** may be formed from a variety of super-elastic and/or shape memory materials, including, for example, nickel-titanium alloys (e.g., Nitinol), which may be laser cut from a tube or in the form of drawn wire. The features defined in the shape memory materials may be defined therein via various cutting methods known in the art, include laser, water jet, electrical discharge machining (EDM), stamping, etching, milling, etc.

[0416] While illustrated as including 12 each of outer arcuate petal portions and inner arcuate petal portions, in other implementations, frame **6355** may include different numbers of inner and/or outer arcuate petal portions. For example, in certain example embodiments, frame **6355** may include between 10 and 14, between 8 and 16, or between 6 and 18 inner and outer arcuate petal portions. In other implementations, the number of inner arcuate petal portions may differ from the number of outer arcuate petal portions. Moreover, not every inner arcuate petal portion may be coupled to a corresponding spoke of frame **6355**. For example, spokes may extend from only every other of inner arcuate petal portions.

[0417] As shown in the preceding figures, each inner arcuate petal portion is uniform as is each outer arcuate petal portion. In other implementations, the inner and outer arcuate petal portions may vary in any direction. For example, the inner arcuate petal portions may alternate between arcuate petal portions having a first major axis dimension and arcuate petal portions have a second major axis dimension different than the first major axis dimension.

[0418] Additional examples dimensions and features of frame **6355** are indicated in FIGS. 64L-64N. Specifically, FIGS. 64L and 64M are additional side views of frame **6355** with FIG. 64M being the view of FIG. 64L rotated approximately 90 degrees about the longitudinal axis **6370** of frame **6355**. FIG. 64N is a detailed view of an example member **6432**. The following discussion describes various dimensions and shapes of frame **6355** and its elements. As with other aspects of this disclosure, any specific dimensions and values should be considered non-limiting and are merely included as example values found to be suitable for use in certain valve repair procedures. Among other things, the dimensions described below may be modified and adjusted to account for

differences in patient physiology.

[0419] Referring first to FIG. **64L**, frame **6355** is shown with three dimensions indicated and generally related to the spokes and inner petal portions of frame **6355**. First, overall height of frame **6355** is indicated as **H1**. In general, **H1** corresponds to the distance between a distal and proximal extent of frame **6355** along central longitudinal axis **6370**. In certain implementations and without limitation, **H1** may be from and including about 15 mm to and including about 20 mm and, in one specific example may be approximately 17.5 mm with a tolerance of ± 0.5 mm.

[0420] FIG. **64L** further includes dimension **H2**, which corresponds to longitudinal height of the outer petal portions as measured from the proximal extend of frame **6355**. In certain implementations and without limitation, **H2** may be from and including about 11 mm to and including about 16 mm and, in one specific example may be approximately 14 mm with a tolerance of ± 0.5 mm.

[0421] Finally, FIG. **64L** includes dimension **R1**, which corresponds to a radius of curvature of the outer petal portions. In certain implementations and without limitation, **R1** may be from and including about 15 mm to and including about 35 mm and, in one specific example may be approximately 25 mm.

[0422] Turning to FIG. **64M**, frame **6355** is shown with two dimensions indicated. First, the height of the anchor members of frame **6355** relative to the distal extent of frame **6355** is indicated as **H3**. In certain implementations and without limitation, **H3** may be from and including about 9 mm to and including about 15 mm and, in one specific example may be approximately 12 mm.

[0423] FIG. **64M** further includes the height of the inner petal portions relative to the distal extent of frame **6355**, which is indicated as **H4**. In certain implementations and without limitation, **H4** may be from and including about 1.5 mm to and including about 3.5 mm and, in one specific example may be approximately 2.4 mm.

[0424] FIG. **64N** is a cross-sectional view of frame **6355** focusing on a member **6432** of frame **6355** and with the remaining elements of frame **6355** removed for clarify. As indicated, member **6432** includes an anchor member **6434**, a junction section **6436** (which corresponds to junctions between outer petal portions of frame **6355**), a spoke **6438**, and an inner petal portion **6440**. FIG. **64N** includes indicators for two curvatures and five height dimensions. As with the previous figures, the various dimensions are intended to be merely illustrative and can be readily adapted and modified, e.g., to accommodate differences in patient physiology.

[0425] Dimension **H5** corresponds to a height of anchor member **6434** and junction section **6436**. In certain implementations and without limitation, **H5** may be from and including about 1 mm to and including about 4 mm and, in one specific example may be approximately 2 mm. Other example dimensions and characteristics of anchor member **6434** are provided above in the context of FIG. **64G**.

[0426] Dimension **H6** corresponds to a height of a proximally concave section **6439** of spoke **6438**. Proximally concave section **6439** generally extends between junction section **6436** and a distally concave section **6441** of spoke **6438**. As shown, proximally concave section **6439** is generally defined in FIG. **64N** by a height **H6** and a radius of curvature **R2** with **H6** corresponding to a distance between junction section **6436** and a distal extent of proximally concave section **6439**. In certain implementations and without limitation, **H6** may be from and including about 2 mm to and including about 4 mm and, in one specific example may be approximately 3 mm. Similarly, in certain implementations and without limitation, **R2** may be from and including about 4 mm to and including about 10 mm and, in one specific example may be approximately 7 mm.

[0427] Dimension **H7** corresponds to a difference between a distal extent of proximally concave section **6439** and a proximal extent of distally concave section **6441**. In certain implementations and without limitation, **H7** may be from and including about 0.25 mm to and including about 3 mm and, in one specific example may be approximately 1.25 mm.

[0428] Dimension **H8** corresponds to a height of distally concave section **6441**. Distally concave

section **6441** generally extends between proximally concave section **6439** and inner petal portion **6440**. As shown, distally concave section **6441** is generally defined in FIG. **64N** by a height **H8** and a radius of curvature **R3** with **H8** corresponding to a distance between a proximal extent of distally concave section **6441** and the beginning of inner petal portion **6440**. In certain implementations and without limitation, **H8** may be from and including about 2.5 mm to and including about 8.5 mm and, in one specific example may be approximately 5.5 mm. Similarly, in certain implementations and without limitation, **R3** may be from and including about 4 mm to and including about 10 mm and, in one specific example may be approximately 7 mm.

[0429] Finally, dimension **H9** corresponds to a height of inner petal portion **6440** and is generally defined as the distance between the end of proximally concave section **6439** and the distal extent of frame **6355**. In certain implementations and without limitation, **H9** may be from and including about 1.5 mm to and including about 4 mm and, in one specific example may be approximately 2.5 mm.

[0430] Similarly, in certain implementations and without limitation, **R4** may be from and including about 30 mm to and including about 50 mm and, in one specific example may be approximately 40 mm.

XVIII. LAMINATED OCCLUDERS FOR VALVE REPAIR IMPLANTS

[0431] As previously discussed in the context of FIGS. **64A** and **63B**, implant **6300** includes occluder **6302**. In contrast to bulb- and sheet-style occluders of other implementations provided in this disclosure, occluder **6302** has a multi-layered laminated structure and a general cap-like shape. Among other things, such occluders result in a generally lower profile and smaller overall height of implant **6300** while forming a relatively large distal surface of implant **6300** against which the native valve leaflets can seal, providing substantial reduction in regurgitation and other valve-related issues.

[0432] FIGS. **65A** and **65B** are detailed views of occluder **6302** of implant **6300**. More specifically, FIG. **65A** is a distal view of occluder **6302** while FIG. **65B** is an isometric view of occluder **6302**. FIG. **65C** is a distal isometric view of frame **6355** and occluder **6302** of implant **6300** and is provided to illustrate occluder **6302** in the broader context of implant **6300** and frame **6355**.

[0433] Referring to FIGS. **65A** and **65B**, occluder **6302** is generally formed directly onto distal frame portion **6358** of frame **6355**. More specifically, occluder **6302** is formed onto the inner petal portions of distal frame portion **6358**. While this disclosure contemplates that occluder **6302** may be formed onto distal frame portion **6358** in various ways, in at least one implementation, occluder **6302** is formed onto distal frame portion **6358** by applying a first sheet **6502** of substantially impervious material onto a distal surface **6504** (shown most clearly in FIG. **65D**) of distal frame portion **6358**. A second sheet **6506** of porous or semi-porous material is then disposed on a proximal surface **6508** of distal frame portion **6358** such that second sheet **6506** substantially overlaps first sheet **6502** with the inner petal portions of distal frame portion **6358** disposed between first sheet **6502** and second sheet **6506**. An epoxy, adhesive, or similar bonding material is then applied to proximal surface **6508** of distal frame portion **6358** such that it penetrates second sheet **6506** and, once cured, bonds second sheet **6506** to first sheet **6502** and the inner petal portions of distal frame portion **6358**.

[0434] FIG. **65D** is an exploded view of occluder **6302** and frame **6355**. As shown, each of first sheet **6502** and second sheet **6506** are cut and shaped to be received onto and bonded to distal frame portion **6358** of frame **6355**. The specific materials and process for forming occluder **6302** may vary in implementations of this disclosure; however, in at least one example implementation, first sheet **6502** is formed from an engineering polymer that is biocompatible and has low porosity. In certain implementations, for example, first sheet **6502** may be formed from expanded polytetrafluoroethylene (ePTFE) or a similar polymer. Second sheet **6506**, in contrast, may be formed from a substantially more porous and flexible material. By way of non-limiting example, in certain implementations second sheet **6506** is formed from a porous and biocompatible fabric, such

as a woven polyethylene terephthalate (PET) material. For example, in some implementations, the material of second sheet **6506** may be the same as or similar to that used for outer sheet **6360** of implant **6300** (shown in FIG. **63A**).

[0435] While this disclosure contemplates that different materials may be used to bond first sheet **6502** and second sheet **6506** to each other and to distal frame portion **6358**, in one example implementation, bonding is achieved using a combination of a siloxane segmented polyurethane and a polymer precursor, such as tetrahydrofuran (THF). During assembly, the polyurethane is solved in the THF and the resulting mixture is applied to second sheet **6506** and proximal surface **6508** of distal frame portion **6358** following layering of first sheet **6502** and second sheet **6506** onto distal frame portion **6358**. The relatively high viscosity of the polyurethane/THF mixture allows for relatively easy penetration of second sheet **6506**, encapsulation of the fibers of second sheet **6506**, and flow into the volume between first sheet **6502** and second sheet **6506** containing distal frame portion **6358**. Following subsequent curing, the polyurethane/THF mixture provides a robust, consistent, and substantially impermeable bond between first sheet **6502** and second sheet **6506**. Notably, polyurethane and certain polyurethane-based compounds are capable of curing/setting without application of additional heat which may cause frame **6355** to deform or lose shape.

[0436] In certain implementations, first sheet **6502** may be directly bonded or coupled to second sheet **6506** without the use of a bonding agent (e.g., the THF noted in the previous example). For example, in certain implementations, one or both of first sheet **6502** and second sheet **6506** may be formed from a material amenable to a sintering, reflow, or similar process such that by heating and/or applying pressure, first sheet **6502** and second sheet **6506** may be bonded. By way of non-limiting example, in one implementation first sheet **6502** and second sheet **6506** may each be formed from ePTFE and may be bonded together by a sintering process. In implementations in which heat and/or pressure are applied to first sheet **6502** and second sheet **6506**, the applied heat is generally insufficient to cause deformation, resetting, etc. of the portion of distal frame portion **6358** disposed between the two sheets.

[0437] FIGS. **65E** and **65F** are distal and side elevation views of frame **6355** including occluder **6302** following bonding of occluder **6302** to frame **6355**. As shown in FIG. **65** and as previously discussed in the context of FIG. **64D**, occluder **6302** may generally have a diameter **D1**. While **D1** may vary in applications of the present disclosure, in certain implementations, **D1** may be from and including about 16 mm to and including about 28 mm. In other implementations, **D1** may be from and including about 20 mm to and including about 22 mm. In one specific implementation, **D1** is about 21.4 mm with a tolerance of ± 0.5 mm.

[0438] Referring to FIG. **65F**, occluder **6302** may also be constructed to have a defined height, as indicated by dimension **H10**. As shown, **H10** generally corresponds to the distance between a distal tip of occluder **6302** (which generally corresponds to the distal extent of implant **6300**) and a proximal edge of occluder **6302** (e.g., proximal radially outward edge **6363** shown in FIGS. **63A** and **64B**). **H10** may vary; however, in certain implementations, **H10** may be from and including about 3.0 mm to and including about 5 mm. For example, in one implementation **H10** is approximately 4 mm with a tolerance of ± 0.5 mm.

[0439] FIGS. **66A** and **66B** illustrate an occluder **6602** that may be used for implant **6300** and other implants according to this disclosure as an alternative or variation of occluder **6302**. Specifically, FIG. **66A** is a distal view of alternative occluder **6602** as coupled to frame **6355** of implant **6300** while FIG. **66B** is a proximal view of occluder **6602** similar assembled as implant **6300**.

[0440] As discussed above and illustrated in FIGS. **65A-65F**, occluder **6302** has a concave proximal surface. In contrast and as most clearly illustrated in FIG. **66B**, occluder **6602** is configured to have a proximal surface **6604** that is convex. Among other things, convex proximal surface **6604** can provide benefits to hemodynamic flow across implant **6300** by more effectively directing flow around occluder **6602**.

[0441] As shown in FIGS. **66A** and **66B**, occluder **6602** may have a multi-part construction including a distal section **6606** coupled to a proximal section **6608**. Distal section **6606** is distally concave and may be substantially similar to occluder **6302**. Proximal section **6608**, in contrast, is distally concave and is coupled to distal section **6606** such that occluder **6602** has an overall pillow shape. As shown in FIGS. **66A** and **66B**, proximal section **6608** is coupled to distal section **6606** by suturing distal section **6606** to proximal section **6608**; however, this disclosure contemplates that proximal section **6608** may be coupled to distal section **6606** using other methods, such as adhesives, epoxies, welding/bonding, and the like.

[0442] Proximal section **6608** may be constructed in various ways; however, in the implementation shown in FIG. **68B**, proximal section **6608** includes a sheet **6610** and an internal frame **6612**. Internal frame **6612** is shown as having a star-shaped construction including radially extending arms, such as arm **6614**. Each arm is coupled to sheet **6610**, e.g., by a suture, thereby attaching sheet **6610** to internal frame **6612** such that internal frame **6612** imparts a curved shape to sheet **6610**. In at least certain implementations, internal frame **6612** may be formed using techniques similar to those used in forming frame **6355**. For example, internal frame **6612** may be cut (e.g., laser cut) from tube-shaped substrate (e.g., a nitinol tube), treated, and formed into the star-like shape shown in FIG. **68B**.

[0443] Sheet **6610** may similarly be formed from various materials; however, in certain implementations, sheet **6610** may be formed from a porous material, such as the woven PET used for second sheet **6506** of occluder **6302** and outer sheet **6360** of implant **6300**. Among other things, using a porous material allows an internal volume **6616** of occluder **6602** to be flushed of air in preparation for delivery and implantation. Following implantation, the porosity of sheet **6610** may permit some blood to flow into internal volume **6616**; however, sheet **6610** substantially limits blood flow out of internal volume **6616**, such that blood entering into internal volume **6616** eventually fills and clots within internal volume **6616**, forming a thrombus that effectively results in occluder **6602** having a substantially solid body that directs blood flow around occluder **6602**.

[0444] In certain alternative implementations, internal volume **6616** may be filled with an epoxy, solidifying gel, solid insert, or similar material or object that substantially fills internal volume **6616** prior to delivery and implantation. In other implementation, internal volume **6616** may contain a hydromorphic polymer, hydrogel, or similar substance that expands when exposed to a fluid, e.g., blood, such that the material expands to fill internal volume **6616** following implantation. In still other alternative implementations, occluder **6602** may have a substantially solid construction. For example, occluder **6602** may be in the form of a substantially solid biocompatible body having an overall shape similar to that of occluder **6602** shown in FIGS. **66A** and **66B** and that can be readily coupled to distal frame portion **6358** to form occluder **6602**.

XIX. OUTER SHEET CONSTRUCTION AND ASSEMBLY

[0445] As previously discussed in the context of FIG. **63A**, implant **6300** includes outer sheet **6360**, which extends circumferentially about a proximal portion of frame **6355**. Outer sheet **6360** provides various functions including, but not limited to, protecting tissue around the valve annulus from frame **6355**, facilitating alignment of implant **6300** within the valve annulus, and anchoring implant **6300** at its implantation location (e.g., through tissue ingrowth into outer sheet **6360**). Further details regarding construction and assembly of outer sheet **6360** are now provided with reference to FIGS. **67A-67D**.

[0446] FIG. **67A** is a side view of the distal face of implant **6300**. As shown, implant **6300** includes occluder **6302** at distal end **6340** and coupled to frame **6355**. Implant **6300** further includes outer sheet **6360**, which extends circumferentially about a proximal portion of frame **6355** and is also coupled to and supported by frame **6355**. Although the shape of outer sheet **6360** may vary, in the implementation shown in FIG. **67A**, distal radially inward edge **6365** of outer sheet **6360** is circular and while proximal radially outward edge **6366** has a sinusoidal/repeating shape.

[0447] FIG. **67B** is a proximal side view of a section of frame **6355** and outer sheet **6360** of

implant **6300** and further illustrates assembly of outer sheet **6360** to frame **6355**. The specific view shown in FIG. **67B** illustrates coupling of outer sheet **6360** to each of a first outer petal portion **6702A** and a second outer petal portion **6702B** of frame **6355**.

[0448] Outer sheet **6360** is shown as being coupled to frame **6355** using both suture loops and hemming. For example, first outer petal portion **6702A** includes a frame section **6704A** and a frame section **6704B**, with frame section **6704B** extending between a distal vertex **6706** of first outer petal portion **6702A** and a junction **6708** formed between first outer petal portion **6702A** and second outer petal portion **6702B**. Along frame section **6704B**, three suture loops **6709A-6709C** are placed to couple outer sheet **6360** to frame **6355**. Additional suture loops are distributed about junction **6708** to further reinforce the coupling of junction **6708** to frame **6355**. An additional suture **6709D** is positioned proximal junction **6708** for further reinforcing the coupling between outer sheet **6360** and frame **6355** around junction **6708**.

[0449] Outer sheet **6360** is also coupled to frame **6355** by hems extending along each of the proximal and distal edges of frame **6355**. For example, a first hem **6710** extends along radially inward edge **6365**, enveloping the distal vertices of the outer petal portions (e.g., distal vertex **6706** of first outer petal portion **6702A**). A second hem **6712** extends along proximal radially outward edge **6366**, conforming to the variable shape of proximal radially outward edge **6366**.

[0450] As shown, second hem **6712** is discontinuous and made up of discrete hem sections corresponding to the proximal halves of each outer petal portion. For example, first outer petal portion **6702A** includes a first petal segment **6714A** and a second petal segment **6714B** that extend proximally and meet at a proximal vertex **6716**. Outer sheet **6360** includes a first hem segment **6718A** and a second hem segment **6718B** that correspond to and contain first petal segment **6714A** and second petal segment **6714B**, respectively, with first hem segment **6718A** folded over second hem segment **6718B**.

[0451] Second hem **6712** is shown as being discontinuous between petal portions, e.g., at junction **6708**. Despite this discontinuity, the suture used to form the discrete sections of second hem **6712** may be continuous and may be routed across the junctions between petal portions. For example, FIG. **67B** shows a suture segment **6722** that crosses junction **6708** and is continuous between first hem segment **6718A** and second hem segment **6718B**.

[0452] FIGS. **67C** and **67D** illustrate proximal vertex **6716** and distal vertex **6706**, respectively, in further detail. As shown in each figure, a suture wrap may be formed at one or both of proximal vertex **6716** and distal vertex **6706**. For example, a proximal suture wrap **6724** is shown in FIG. **67C** extending around proximal vertex **6716** while a distal suture wrap **6726** is shown in each of FIGS. **67C** and **67D** extending around distal vertex **6706**. Including suture wraps as shown provides several notable advantages. As a first example, each of the suture wraps provides robust and reinforced coupling of outer sheet **6360** to frame **6355**. The suture wraps also provide additional padding around the vertices of the outer petal portions of frame **6355**. Finally, the suture wraps may fill gaps between hem segments. For example, proximal suture wrap **6724** is disposed between first hem segment **6718A** and second hem segment **6718B** and may fill/cover any gap that may be present between the two segments despite the folding of first hem segment **6718A** over second hem segment **6718B**.

[0453] FIG. **68** shows an example of outer sheet **6360** prior to coupling onto frame **6355**. As shown, outer sheet **6360** is a single piece of woven PET material that is cut (e.g., laser cut) to conform to frame **6355** and to include various tabs, etc., to form any hems required to couple outer sheet **6360** to frame **6355**. FIG. **68** further indicates a first fold line **6728** corresponding to first hem **6710** and a series of second fold lines **6730** corresponding to second hem **6712**.

[0454] In one example assembly process and following cutting of outer sheet **6360**, outer sheet **6360** is wrapped around frame **6355** as shown in the preceding figures and sutured/stitched onto frame **6355**. Such suturing/stitching generally includes forming each of first hem **6710** and second hem **6712** and forming any additional suture loops (e.g., suture loops **6709A-6709D**). To facilitate

wrapping of outer sheet **6360** about frame **6355**, outer sheet **6360** includes an open side **6732** that is closed as outer sheet **6360** is wrapped about frame **6355**. To facilitate this process, outer sheet **6360** may include an additional tab, such as tab **6734**, to keep outer sheet **6360** in a closed configuration while being coupled to frame **6355**. Following initial wrapping of outer sheet **6360** about frame **6355**, tab **6734** may be folded inward (e.g., along fold line **6736**) and held in place by a suture/stitch. Doing so maintains an approximate shape of outer sheet **6360** and facilitates folding and forming of the various hems and suture loops necessary to securely couple outer sheet **6360** to frame **6355**.

[0455] The foregoing discussion provides one example of construction and assembly of outer sheet **6360**. In particular, the example included cutting outer sheet **6360** from a sheet of suitable material (e.g., woven PET) and attaching outer sheet **6360** to frame **6355** using a combination of hems and suture loops. In suture-reliant implementations, coupling of outer sheet **6360** to frame **6355** may be achieved using a monofilament suture, a multifilament suture, or a combination of mono- and multifilament sutures. Also, this disclosure contemplates that outer sheet **6360** may be coupled to frame **6355** using sutures, adhesives, welding, or any combination thereof. For example, in certain implementations, one of heat welding or ultrasonic welding may be used to close the various hems illustrated in the preceding figures. As another example, polyurethane, silicone, or a similarly suitable and biocompatible adhesive, epoxy, bonding agent, etc., may be employed. This disclosure also contemplates that multiple fixation techniques may be used to couple outer sheet **6360** to frame **6355**. For example, adhesive may be initially used to perform an initial or partial coupling of outer sheet **6360** to outer sheet **6360** but may be supplemented or reinforced by suturing, welding, etc.

XX. IMPLANTS INCLUDING EYELETS FOR CINCH LINE ROUTING

[0456] Implant delivery systems of the present disclosure generally rely on two mechanisms for controlling expansion and collapse of implants during delivery. First, during delivery, implants according to this disclosure may be disposed on a control arm assembly of the delivery tool. The control arm assembly includes control arms configured to radially expand and contract in response to manipulation of a corresponding control of a handle assembly of the delivery tool. The control arm is coupled to the frame of the implant such that as a clinician expands the control arms radially outward, the implant expands. Similarly, as the clinician retracts the control arms radially inward, the implant is pulled inward and collapsed.

[0457] In addition to the control arms, delivery systems according to the present disclosure may include one or more cinch lines. The one or more cinch lines are routed through the delivery tool and made to extend circumferentially about the frame of the implant. In implementations including a single cinch line, the cinch line may be routed from a handle assembly, through the catheter assembly of the delivery system (e.g., through a cinch line tube extending through the catheter assembly), about the full circumference of the implant, and back through the catheter assembly to the handle assembly.

[0458] In contrast, in implementations including multiple cinch lines, each cinch line may be similarly routed through delivery catheter assembly, but only partially about the circumference of the implant.

[0459] For example, in an implementation including two cinch lines, each cinch line may extend about approximately half of the circumference of the implant and meet at a retention location. Each cinch line may terminate in a loop or similar feature through which a retention pin or cable may be passed to retain the cinch lines during delivery and implantation.

[0460] During delivery and implantation, the one or more cinch lines provide various functions and benefits. In general, the one or more cinch lines retain the implant on the control arms; however, by maintaining tension of the one or more cinch lines during expansion and collapse of the implant, the uniformity of expansion and collapse can be substantially improved due to the cinch lines distributing expansion/collapse forces evenly about the implant. Relatedly, maintain tension on the

one or more cinch lines also provides improve responsiveness of the implant expansion and collapse controls by reducing or eliminating slack that may need to be overcome before manipulation of a control by the clinician results in corresponding movement of the implant. [0461] Regardless of whether one or more cinch lines are included, following delivery and implantation of the implant, the cinch lines must be decoupled from the implant to permit release of the implant and subsequent removal of the delivery system. In implementations including a single cinch line that forms a large loop through the delivery system, the cinch line may be cut at a proximal location and subsequently pulled through the catheter assembly. In implementations including multiple cinch lines retained by a retention cable at the implant, the retention cable may be retracted to release the cinch lines, which may then be retracted through the delivery catheter. This process and an example handle assembly for sequencing of retention cable and cinch line retraction is described below in further detail in the context of FIGS. **83A-86D**.

[0462] Smooth and reliable retraction of the cinch lines is a critical part of the implantation process. For example, if the cinch lines bind, snag, or become otherwise restricted as they are retracted, the resulting pulling on the implant may result in the implant to shift within the valve annulus or, in certain extreme cases, to become partially or fully dislodged from its implantation location.

[0463] To avoid or reduce the likelihood of such situations, implementations of this disclosure include various features for more reliable and consistent routing of cinch lines and, in particular, consistent retraction of cinch lines during release of the implant from the delivery system. For example, in the implementation shown in FIG. **59**, routing rings (e.g., ring **3646**) are coupled to the control arms of delivery device **3600** and cinch line **3614** is routed through each of the routing rings and corresponding rings (e.g., ring **3804**) coupled to the frame of implant **3800**.

[0464] As another alternative, which is discussed in further detail in this section, improved cinch line routing is provided by a series of eyelets coupled to the implant frame. More specifically, specially designed eyelets are coupled to the frame of the implant such that the eyelets are distributed circumferentially about the radially inward surface of the implant. In one specific implementation, the junctions between adjacent outer petal portions of the implant frame include a slot through which the separately manufactured eyelets are inserted. In contrast to the rings included in the implementation shown in FIG. **59**, the eyelets are rigidly retained using one or more coupling techniques and form a consistent and reliable path for the one or more cinch lines about the circumference of the implant. Additional features, such as a smooth, radius inner bore, reduce the likelihood of cinch lines binding or snagging as they are retracted through the eyelets, thereby improving the overall reliability and consistency with which the cinch lines can be retracted during release of the implant from the delivery device.

[0465] FIGS. **69A** and **69B** are a partial proximal view and a detailed proximal view, respectively, of implant **6300**. Implant **6300** is discussed in detail in previous sections; however, implant **6300** generally includes frame **6355**, which includes a series of circumferentially distributed spokes that extend from a distal frame portion **6358** to a proximal frame portion **6359**. Proximal frame portion **6359** includes a series of circumferentially distributed outer petal portions, such as outer petal portion **6385A** and outer petal portion **6385B**. Each pair of outer petal portions meet at a junction, such as junction **6384**. Each junction further connects with one of the spokes extending from distal frame portion **6358**. For example, junction **6384** connects outer petal portion **6385A**, outer petal portion **6385B**, and spoke **6395A**. In at least certain implementations, an anchor member, such as anchor member **6399** may also extend from junction **6384**.

[0466] In certain implementations of this disclosure, each junction of frame **6355** may further include an eyelet for use in routing one or more cinch line about the inner surface of implant **6300**. For example, FIG. **69B** illustrates an eyelet **6802** located at and coupled to junction **6384**. Additional eyelets are also shown coupled to adjacent junctions. In certain implementations, each junction of frame **6355** may include a respective eyelet such that the eyelets extend about the full

circumference of implant **6300** and enable corresponding and complete routing of one or more cinch lines about implant **6300**.

[0467] FIG. **70** is an isometric view of eyelet **6802**, while FIGS. **71A-C** are plan, bottom, and cross-sectional views of eyelet **6802**, respectively. As shown in the figures, eyelet **6802** generally includes a shank **6804** extending in a first direction and a body **6808** extending perpendicularly from shank **6804**. In certain implementations, shank **6804** defines a retention hole **6806** that may be used to couple eyelet **6802** to frame **6355** using a suture loop or similar coupling element. Body **6808** similarly defines a cinch line hole **6810** that extends through body **6808** and that is generally sized and shaped to permit threading of the cinch line through cinch line hole **6810**.

[0468] As shown in FIG. **70**, an undercut may be made on either side of body **6808** where body **6808** meets shank **6804**. For example, FIG. **70** indicates undercut **6812A** on a first side of body **6808** and undercut **6812B** on an opposite side of body **6808**. As discussed below in further detail, undercut **6812A** and undercut **6812B** facilitate flush contact between shank **6804** and the proximal side of junction **6384** when eyelet **6802** is assembled with frame **6355**.

[0469] FIGS. **71A-71C** illustrate additional views of eyelet **6802** including various dimensions. As in other aspects of this disclosure, the specific dimensions of eyelet **6802** may vary and any ranges or dimensions specifically mentioned in this disclosure in this and other sections are intended merely as examples that reflect certain positive outcomes during development and testing.

[0470] Referring first to FIG. **71A**, dimension **W1** corresponds to a width of body **6808**, dimension **D5** corresponds to a diameter of the through hole of cinch line hole **6810**, **H11** corresponds to an offset between the top extent of shank **6804** and the beginning of the radius of cinch line hole **6810**, and **D6** corresponds to a diameter of retention hole **6806**. In certain implementations, **W1** may be from and including about 0.9 mm to and including about 1.0 mm and, in one specific example is approximately 0.927 mm with a tolerance of ± 0.02 mm. In certain implementations, **D5** may be from and including about 0.55 mm to and including about 0.6 mm and, in one specific example is approximately 0.527 mm with a tolerance. In certain implementations, **H11** may be from and including about 0.55 mm to and including about 0.65 mm and, in one specific example is approximately 0.596 mm with a tolerance of ± 0.02 mm. In certain implementations, **D6** may be from and including about 0.35 mm to and including about 0.4 mm and, in one specific example is approximately 0.38 mm.

[0471] FIG. **71B** is a bottom view of eyelet **6802** and includes dimensions **W2**, which corresponds to the width of shank **6804**, and **T1**, which corresponds to the thickness of eyelet **6802**. In certain implementations, **W2** may be from and including about 1.8 mm to and including about 2.0 mm and, in one specific example is approximately 1.875 mm with a tolerance of ± 0.02 mm. In certain implementations, **T1** may be from and including about 0.3 mm to and including about 0.4 mm and, in one specific example is approximately 0.36 mm with a tolerance of ± 0.02 mm.

[0472] Finally, FIG. **71C** is a cross-sectional view of body **6808** across cinch line hole **6810** as indicated in FIG. **71A**. As shown, in at least certain implementations, cinch line hole **6810** may have radiused or otherwise machined sides to eliminate any sharp edges that may catch or otherwise impede cinch line retraction. The radius of cinch line hole **6810** is indicated as **R5** in FIG. **71C**. In certain implementations, **R5** may be from and including about 0.15 mm to and including about 0.20 mm and, in one specific example is approximately 0.18 mm.

[0473] FIG. **72** is a detailed view of junction **6384** with eyelet **6802** removed. More specifically, FIG. **72** is a detailed view from a perspective orthogonal to a slot **7202** on a distal side of frame **6355**. As previously discussed, junction **6384** provides a connection location between spoke **6395A**, outer petal portion **6385A**, and outer petal portion **6385B**, and anchor member **6399** may extend outward from junction **6384**.

[0474] Slot **7202** is defined by and extends through junction **6384** and is shaped to receive eyelet **6802**. For example, in certain implementations, slot **7202** may be laser cut or otherwise formed in the same process as the rest of frame **6355** (e.g., a process by which frame **6355** is laser cut from a

tubular substrate, such as a nitinol tube). Slot **7202** may vary in size and shape depending on the scale of frame **6355** and, more specifically, the size and shape of eyelet **6802**. Nevertheless, in certain implementations, slot **7202** may generally have a width **W2** and a length **L1**, with **W2** corresponding to a dimension extending perpendicular to spoke **6395A** and **L** extending parallel to spoke **6395A**. Although dimensions of **W** and **L** may vary, in certain implementations, **W** may be from and including about 0.3 mm to and including about 0.5 mm. For example, **W2** may be approximately 0.405 mm with a tolerance of ± 0.03 mm. Similarly, **L1** may vary in different implementations of this disclosure; however, in certain implementations, **L1** may be from and including about 0.75 mm to and including about 1.5 mm. In one specific example, **L1** is approximately 1.075 mm with a tolerance of ± 0.03 mm.

[0475] FIG. **73A** is a cross-sectional view of junction **6384** with eyelet **6802** installed. As shown, eyelet **6802** is inserted through slot **7202** such that shank **6804** of eyelet **6802** abuts a distal surface **7302** of junction **6384** and cinch line hole **6810** extends to a proximal side **7304** of junction **6384**, with the contact between shank **6804** and distal surface **7302** precluding further proximal movement by eyelet **6802**. Eyelet **6802** is shown as being coupled to junction **6384** by a suture loop **7306** that extends about junction **6384** and is threaded through retention hole **6806** of eyelet **6802**. In other implementations, eyelet **6802** may be retained within slot **7202** using alternative or additional means.

[0476] For example, eyelet **6802** may be bonded to junction **6384** using an adhesive or by a welding process. As another alternative slot **7202** and body **6808** of eyelet **6802** may be sized such that an interference fit is formed between slot **7202** and body **6808** that positively retains eyelet **6802** within slot **7202**. As further illustrated in FIG. **73A**, outer sheet **6360** is generally disposed distal shank **6804** when implant **6300** is fully assembled. Accordingly, outer sheet **6360** may also be fitted to abut and apply proximal force to shank **6804** to facilitate retention of eyelet **6802** within slot **7202**.

[0477] FIG. **73B** is similarly a cross-sectional view of junction **6384** with eyelet **6802** installed albeit with implant **6300** coupled to a control arm **7308** of a delivery tool and with a cinch line **7310** routed through cinch line hole **6810** of eyelet **6802**. As shown, control arm **7308** includes a hole or slot **7312** shaped to receive body **6808** of eyelet **6802**. Following insertion of eyelet body **6808** through slot **7312**, cinch line **7310** can be routed through cinch line hole **6810**, thereby retaining implant **6300** onto control arm **7308**. This general assembly process is then repeated for each eyelet of implant **6300** and each corresponding control arm of the delivery device.

[0478] Following placement of implant **6300**, cinch line **7310** is released (e.g., by cutting and pulling or retraction of a retention pin/cable) and retracted. During retraction, cinch line **7310** passes through cinch line hole **6810**. Once cinch line **7310** is clear of cinch line hole **6810**, control arm **7308** is separable from eyelet **6802**, thereby enabling release of implant **6300** from the delivery tool.

[0479] This disclosure contemplates that eyelet **6802** may be formed and manufactured using various materials and processed. Nevertheless, in one specific implementation, eyelet **6802** is formed from titanium that is precision machined, cleaned, and electropolished prior to assembly with frame **6355**. In other implementations, eyelet **6802** may be formed using other suitable techniques including, but not limited to, stamping, coining, metal injection molding, laser cutting, and photo etching.

XXI. DELIVERY TOOLS INCLUDING INTERNAL TUBES WITH MODIFIED FLEXIBILITY

[0480] FIGS. **36-44** illustrated various features and components of delivery device **3600**, which is a non-limiting example of an implant delivery device according to this disclosure. As described in the context of FIGS. **36-44**, delivery device **3600** includes delivery catheter **3604**, which is the primary steerable element of delivery device **3600**. Delivery device **3600** further includes various tubes and shafts within delivery catheter **3604** for performing various functions of delivery device **3600**. For example, tube **3626** provides a conduit through which control arm shaft **3642** and control

arm assembly **3608** extend.

[0481] In addition to providing protection and support for control arm shaft **3642** and control arm assembly **3608**, in at least some implementations, tube **3626** is also extendible and retractable relative to delivery catheter **3604** to facilitate positioning of the implant during the implantation process. An implementation of this disclosure capable of such extension and retraction and corresponding control mechanisms is illustrated in FIGS. **79A-79D** and discussed further below.

[0482] In general, extension and retraction of distal tube **3626** requires that distal tube **3626** have sufficient axial strength and rigidity to transfer longitudinal forces imparted at a handle assembly of the delivery system efficiently and responsively. However, given that delivery catheter **3604** is steerable, distal tube **3626** must also be sufficiently flexible to permit steering of delivery catheter **3604** without imparting substantial resistance.

[0483] To address these challenges, among others, this disclosure provides for an internal tube for an implant delivery system that is both stiff enough to transfer forces necessary for extension and retraction of an implant supported on the distal end of the tube and flexible enough so as not to substantially impact steering and control of the delivery catheter within which the tube is contained. As described below in further detail, these goals are achieved by forming a substantial length of the tube with a uniform and relatively stiff construction. Certain distal sections of the tube that generally correspond to the steerable sections of the delivery catheter further include slits, cutouts, helical cuts, or similar features that locally reduce bending stiffness of the tube without substantially altering axial strength and force transfer characteristics. In some implementations, such stiffness reduction features may be configured to reduce stiffness of the tube to bending along a specific plane or in a specific direction, e.g., along a plane corresponding to a steering plane of the delivery catheter, while maintaining rigidity with respect to bending in other directions.

[0484] FIG. **74** illustrates an example delivery system **7400** for an implant **7402**. Delivery system **7400** generally corresponds to delivery device **3600**, discussed above. As noted in the context of delivery device **3600**, delivery system **7400** includes a steerable catheter **7404** including multiple steerable sections. While other configurations and steering arrangements of steerable catheter **7404** are contemplated by and within the scope of this disclosure, steerable catheter **7404** generally includes a distal steerable section **7406** steerable along a first plane (e.g., plane **4506**, shown in FIG. **45A** with bending along plane **4506** further illustrated in FIGS. **45B** and **45C**) and a proximal steerable section **7408** steerable along two planes (e.g., plane **4508** and plane **4510** shown in FIG. **45A** with steering along the planes shown in FIGS. **45D** and **45E** and FIGS. **45F-45H**, respectively). In certain implementations, the first steering plane of proximal steerable section **7408** may be coplanar with the steering plane of distal steerable section **7406** when steerable catheter **7404** is in a neutral/straight configuration while the second steering plane of proximal steerable section **7408** may be orthogonal to the first steering plane of proximal steerable section **7408**. Steerable catheter **7404** may also include one or more non-steerable catheter sections, such as non-steerable catheter section **7409**. For example, non-steerable catheter section **7409** may extend from proximal steerable section **7408** to a handle assembly of delivery system **7400**.

[0485] Delivery system **7400** includes an internal tube **7410**. The specific functions of internal tube **7410** may vary; however, in at least certain implementations internal tube **7410** enables routing of elongate elements through steerable catheter **7404**. In delivery system **7400**, internal tube **7410** is also translatable relative to steerable catheter **7404** to facilitate positioning and placement of implant **7402** during delivery and implantation. An example of such extension and retraction is provided below in the context of FIGS. **79A-80B**, which illustrate and describe extension and retraction of an inner tube and a corresponding handle mechanism for performing extension/retraction.

[0486] While this disclosure contemplates that internal tube **7410** may have a substantially uniform structure, in at least certain implementations internal tube **7410** is divided into sections with varying stiffnesses and properties related to bending of the particular section. Certain sections may

also have non-uniform stiffness, such as by having a first stiffness when bent along a first plane and/or in a first direction and a second, different stiffness when bent along a second plane and/or in a second direction.

[0487] FIG. 75 illustrates internal tube **7410** removed from delivery system **7400**. As shown, internal tube **7410** is generally divided into four sections, each of which has a different structure. While implementations of this disclosure may vary, internal tube **7410** specifically includes a distal tube section **7412**, a first medial section **7414**, a second medial tube section **7416**, and a proximal tube section **7418**. Each section of internal tube **7410** may correspond to a particular section of steerable catheter **7404**. For example, in the implementation shown, distal tube section **7412** may correspond to distal steerable section **7406**, first medial section **7414** may correspond to proximal steerable section **7408**, second medial tube section **7416** may correspond to a distal segment of non-steerable catheter section **7409**, and proximal tube section **7418** may correspond to a proximal segment of non-steerable catheter section **7409**.

[0488] Although the specific construction of internal tube **7410** may vary, in at least certain implementations, internal tube **7410** is formed as a unitary tubular structure. Material of internal tube **7410** may similarly vary; however, in one specific implementation, internal tube **7410** is formed from stainless steel or a similar biocompatible material. In at least one implementation, internal tube **7410** is formed from a tube having an outer diameter from and including about 2.5 mm to and including about 3.5 mm with a wall thickness from and including about 0.1 mm to and including about 0.5 mm.

[0489] For example, in one specific implementation, internal tube **7410** has an outer diameter of approximately 3 mm and a wall thickness of 0.25 mm.

[0490] FIGS. 76A-76D illustrate each section of internal tube **7410** in further detail. FIG. 76A is a side view of distal tube section **7412** of internal tube **7410**. When assembled with steerable catheter **7404**, distal tube section **7412** generally corresponds to distal steerable section **7406**.

[0491] As noted above, in the specific implementation illustrated in FIG. 74, distal steerable section **7406** of steerable catheter **7404** is bidirectionally steerable along a single plane. To accommodate such bending of distal steerable section **7406**, distal tube section **7412** may be configured to have reduced stiffness to bending along the steering plane of distal steerable section **7406**.

[0492] In one specific implementation, stiffness of distal tube section **7412** is modified by a series of cuts distributed longitudinally along distal tube section **7412**. More specifically, distal tube section **7412** includes first cuts **7420A** extending along a first side of distal tube section **7412** and second cuts **7420B** extending along a second side of distal tube section **7412**. First cuts **7420A** and second cuts **7420B** reduce the stiffness of distal tube section **7412** relative to bending in the directions of the sides along which the cuts extend. In contrast, relatively higher stiffness is maintained for bending in directions orthogonal to the cut sides due to “spines” (e.g., spine **7421**) that extend along distal tube section **7412** between the sets of cuts. When internal tube **7410** is disposed within steerable catheter **7404**, first cuts **7420A** and second cuts **7420B** are generally oriented perpendicular to the steering plane of distal steerable section **7406** such that resistance to bending by distal tube section **7412** along the steering plane is reduced.

[0493] As illustrated in FIG. 76A, each of first cuts **7420A** and second cuts **7420B** terminate in a bulbous cutout, resulting in an overall dog-bone shape to each of the cuts. The dog-bone shape generally reduces interference of the internal cut surfaces during bending. Among other things, doing so promotes more uniform bending of distal tube section **7412** and avoids binding of distal tube section **7412** during bending.

[0494] To maintain proper orientation between internal tube **7410** and steerable catheter **7404** a keyway **7422** or similar alignment feature of distal tube section **7412** may mate with a corresponding feature of steerable catheter **7404**.

[0495] While FIG. 76A illustrates lateral cuts for reducing bending stiffness along one plane, this disclosure contemplates that lateral cuts may also be used to reduce stiffness of a given section of

internal tube **7410** to bending along multiple planes. For example, internal tube **7410** may be modified by including additional cuts orthogonally offset from first cuts **7420A** and second cuts **7420B** and disposed between adjacent cuts of first cuts **7420A** and second cuts **7420B**. By doing so, stiffness of internal tube **7410** may also be reduced to bending along a second plan orthogonal to the first plane corresponding to first cuts **7420A** and second cuts **7420B**. More generally, by angularly offsetting the lateral cuts along internal tube **7410**, internal tube **7410** can be made to have reduced stiffness along any number and direction of bending planes. Stiffness along a given bending plane may be controlled by modifying the density, kerf, depth, or other similar characteristics of the cuts corresponding to the bending plane. Accordingly, in implementations in which internal tube **7410** has controlled stiffness in multiple directions or along multiple planes, the cut characteristics for each plane may be modified and controlled to impart specific bending characteristics for the direction/plane.

[0496] FIG. **76B** is a side view of first medial section **7414** of internal tube **7410**. As noted above, in the specific implementation illustrated in FIG. **74**, proximal steerable section **7408** of steerable catheter **7404** is steerable along two orthogonal planes. To accommodate such bending, first medial section **7414** may be configured to have omnidirectionally reduced stiffness to bending.

[0497] In one specific implementation, stiffness of first medial section **7414** is modified by one or more helical cuts, such as helical cut **7424**, extending along the length of first medial section **7414**.

[0498] Given that helical cut **7424** extends around the entirety of first medial section **7414**, it reduces stiffness of first medial section **7414** omnidirectionally relative to stiffness of first medial section **7414** absent any such cuts.

[0499] FIG. **76C** is a side view of second medial tube section **7416** of internal tube **7410**. As noted above, in the specific implementation illustrated in FIG. **74**, second medial tube section **7416** may correspond to a distal segment of non-steerable catheter section **7409** of steerable catheter **7404**.

[0500] While not requiring the flexibility to accommodate steering, reduced stiffness of second medial tube section **7416** may nevertheless be desirable in certain applications and procedures. For example, during delivery of an implant to the valve annulus using delivery system **7400**, the distal segment of non-steerable catheter section **7409** corresponding to second medial tube section **7416** is near and may even extend into the heart. As such, the distal segment of non-steerable catheter section **7409** may contact and exert forces on tissue and structures of and surrounding the heart, particularly during changes in insertion and/or rotation of steerable catheter **7404**. In general, internal tube **7410** structurally reinforces steerable catheter **7404** and contributes to the contact forces between steerable catheter **7404** and surrounding tissue. So, by reducing the stiffness of second medial tube section **7416**, the degree of structural reinforcement provided to the distal segment of non-steerable catheter section **7409** and corresponding contact forces exerted by non-steerable catheter section **7409** can be reduced.

[0501] In one specific implementation, stiffness of second medial tube section **7416** is modified by one or more helical cuts, such as helical cut **7426**, extending along the length of second medial tube section **7416**. Given that helical cut **7426** extends around the entirety of second medial tube section **7416**, it reduces stiffness of second medial tube section **7416** omnidirectionally. Compared to helical cut **7424** of first medial section **7414**, helical cut **7426** of second medial tube section **7416** is illustrated as having a greater pitch, resulting in a smaller reduction in the stiffness of second medial tube section **7416**.

[0502] FIG. **76D** is a side view of proximal tube section **7418** of internal tube **7410**. As shown, proximal tube section **7418** does not include any specific modifications to change the general stiffness of proximal tube section **7418**. However, as shown, proximal tube section **7418** may include a coupling feature **7428**, such as an elongate through hole, for coupling to a handle of delivery system **7400** and maintaining rotational alignment of internal tube **7410** with respect to steerable catheter **7404** while permitting longitudinal translation of internal tube **7410** relative to steerable catheter **7404**.

[0503] This disclosure contemplates various aspects of the cuts illustrated in FIGS. 76A-76C may be modified to impart different stiffness reductions to internal tube **7410** and to tune the stiffness of internal tube **7410** for a given application. For example, with reference to the lateral cuts shown in FIG. 76A, cut density (i.e., cuts per unit length of internal tube **7410**), kerf width, cut depth, and similar characteristics may be modified to modify the stiffness. Similarly, with respect to the helical cuts shown in FIGS. 76B and 76C, pitch, kerf, helix angle, and similar characteristics may be modified to alter the stiffness of internal tube **7410**.

[0504] While FIGS. 76A-76C illustrate cuts through a wall of internal tube **7410**, this disclosure also contemplates that any cuts may extend only partially through the wall of internal tube **7410**, with the depth of the cut being generally proportional to the stiffness reduction provided by the cut. This disclosure also contemplates that the stiffness of sections of internal tube **7410** may be modified in other ways including, but not limited to, varying wall thickness, varying tube material, varying tube shape, and the like.

[0505] The specific dimensions of internal tube **7410** may vary. However, in certain implementations, internal tube **7410** may be from and including about 1400 mm to and including about 1800 mm. For example, in one implementation, internal tube **7410** may be approximately 1540 mm in length. Each section of internal tube **7410** may similarly vary in length. For example, in one implementation, distal tube section **7412** may be from and including about terminate in a distal end including a keyway or similar non-rotational feature that is from and including about 40 mm to and including about 80 mm in length. For example, distal tube section **7412** may be approximately 60 mm in length. In certain implementations, first medial section **7414** may be from and including about 90 mm to and including about 130 mm. For example, first medial section **7414** may be approximately 110 mm in length. In certain implementations, the spiral cut of first medial section **7414** may have a pitch from and including about 0.4 mm to and including about 0.6 mm, e.g., 0.5 mm. In some implementations, the spiral cut of first medial section **7414** is continuous; however, in others, it may be an interrupted cut with cut lengths of approximately 2 mm to 4 mm interspersed with uncut sections of approximately 0.5 mm to approximately 0.8 mm. More generally, however, each of distal tube section **7412** and first medial section **7414** may be approximately the same length as the corresponding steerable sections of the delivery catheter with which they are paired and within which they are disposed.

[0506] Second medial tube section **7416** may similarly vary in length. For example, in certain implementations, second medial tube section **7416** may be from and including about 500 mm to and including about 700 mm in length. In one specific example, second medial tube section **7416** is approximately 630 mm in length. In certain implementations in which second medial tube section **7416** is spiral cut, the spiral cut of second medial tube section **7416** may have a pitch from and including about 1 mm to and including about 2 mm, e.g., 1.5 mm. The spiral cut of second medial tube section **7416** may similarly be uninterrupted or interrupted. When the spiral cut is interrupted, it may include cut segments from and including about 3 mm to and including about 4 mm, e.g., 3.5 mm, and uncut segments of 0.5 mm to 1.2 mm, e.g., 0.9 mm. Finally, in certain implementations, proximal tube section **7418** may be from and including about 600 mm to and including about 800 mm and, in one specific example, is approximately 740 mm.

XXII. DELIVERY TOOL HANDLES FOR DELIVERY OF EXPANDABLE IMPLANTS

[0507] Delivery tools according to this disclosure generally include a handle assembly with various control elements and a catheter assembly extending from the handle assembly. During delivery of an implant, the implant is retained within at least partially within a distal end of the catheter assembly. Following insertion of the catheter assembly and location of the distal end of the catheter assembly by a clinician, the clinician deploys the implant from the distal end of the catheter assembly. Deployment generally includes fully exposing the implant, such as by retracting a protective sheath and/or distally extending the implant from the distal end of the catheter assembly, and once exposed, expanding the implant into an expanded configuration for implantation.

Following final positioning and implantation of the now-expanded implant, the clinician detaches the implant from the distal end of the catheter assembly and retracts the delivery tool from the patient.

[0508] The foregoing process requires substantial control and manipulation of the delivery tool and the implant including, but not limited to, steering of the catheter assembly, extension and retraction of the implant relative to the catheter assembly, expansion and contraction of the implant, and release of the implant. An example steering mechanism and corresponding handle features and functions are discussed above in the context of FIGS. **45A-49**. As noted in the context of those figures, the handle assembly may include levers or similar steering control elements configured to steer sections of the catheter assembly independently and in multiple directions. For example, FIGS. **45A-45H** illustrate one example implementation in which a distal portion of the catheter assembly is separated into a proximal steering section and a distal steering section, each of which is independently articulable.

[0509] In addition to steering of the catheter, certain implementations of this disclosure include elements for controlling each of rotation and insertion of the catheter assembly. For example, FIG. **61** illustrates an example delivery device mount that includes a rail and cradle supporting the delivery device. The cradle is movable/translatable along the rail (e.g., by turning a corresponding knob) to control insertion. The cradle also includes a rotatable mount for the delivery device such that the delivery device may be rotated within the cradle while maintaining longitudinal alignment.

[0510] FIGS. **77A-78C** illustrate a similar mounting arrangement for enabling both insertion and rotation of a delivery device. FIG. **77A** is an illustration of an implant delivery system **7700** including a delivery device **7702** supported by a mounting assembly **7704** including a cradle **7706**. Cradle **7706** is supported by a rail **7708** supported by an articulating arm **7710**. While not shown in the figures, articulating arm **7710** may be coupled to a patient bed or similar fixture within an operating environment. Similar to the mounting arrangement shown in FIG. **61**, cradle **7706** includes a stepper-type articulation system that is manually driven by a knob **7712**. More specifically, as a clinician rotates knob **7712** (as shown in FIG. **77B**), cradle **7706** translates along rail **7708** in a corresponding direction, thereby controlling insertion of delivery device **7702**.

[0511] FIGS. **78A-78C** illustrate rotation of delivery device **7702** within cradle **7706** of mounting assembly **7704**. FIG. **78A** illustrates delivery device **7702** in a neutral position. To modify rotational position of delivery device **7702**, a clinician may manually rotate delivery device **7702** within cradle **7706**. FIG. **78B** illustrates delivery system **7700** during manual rotation of by a clinician in a first direction from the neutral position of FIG. **78A** while FIG. **78C** illustrates delivery device **7702** following rotation by a clinician in an opposite direction from neutral. Notably, during rotation in either direction, the longitudinal axis of delivery device **7702** is maintained in a fixed location. While the amount of rotation provided by mounting assembly **7704** may vary, in at least certain implementations, mounting assembly **7704** may be configured to provide up to and including about 180 degrees of total rotation for delivery device **7702**, e.g., 90 degrees in either a clockwise or counterclockwise direction relative to neutral.

[0512] In addition to rotation and insertion, delivery systems according to the present disclosure can be actuated and controlled in other ways with corresponding control elements included in their handle assemblies. By way of non-limiting example, such additional degrees of freedom and articulation may include extension of an implant relative to a distal end of a delivery catheter, controlled expansion and contraction of the implant prior to release, and controlled release of the implant from the distal end of the delivery catheter, each of which is discussed below in further detail.

[0513] First, FIGS. **79A-80B** illustrate an example implementation of a delivery device **7900** having a handle assembly **7902**. Like other delivery devices and systems of this disclosure, delivery device **7900** generally includes a steerable catheter assembly **7904**. An implant **7950** may be disposed on a distal end **7906** of the catheter assembly **7904** for delivery and implantation. The

catheter assembly **7904** includes a steerable catheter body **7908** and an extension tube **7910**. During operation and as discussed in the context of FIGS. **54A** and **54B** and FIGS. **74-76E**, extension tube **7910** may be extended and retracted relative to distal end **7906** to facilitate positioning, orientation, and placement of implant **7950** relative to the valve annulus.

[0514] In one example tricuspid valve repair procedure, implant **7950** is maintained in a retracted and sheathed configuration during delivery of distal end **7906** of delivery device **7900** into the right atrium and with implant **7950** coupled to distal end **7906**. With distal end **7906** in the right atrium, the clinician unsheathes and expands implant **7950** and aligns implant **7950** to be normal to the tricuspid valve annulus, e.g., by steering catheter assembly **7904**. Once aligned, extension tube **7910** is extended to translate implant **7950** into the valve annulus for subsequent release.

[0515] FIGS. **79A-79D** illustrate general operation of handle assembly **7902** of delivery device **7900** to perform extension and retraction of implant **7950**. More specifically, FIGS. **79A** and **79C** are illustrations of handle assembly **7902** with extension tube **7910** and implant **7950** in a fully extended configuration and during retraction, respectively. Similarly, FIGS. **79B** and **79D** are illustrations of distal end **7906** of delivery device **7900** with extension tube **7910** and implant **7950** in a fully extended configuration and during retraction, respectively.

[0516] Extension and retraction of extension tube **7910** and implant **7950** is achieved by an extension control element **7912** of handle assembly **7902**. In the specific implementation shown, extension control element **7912** is in the form of an extension knob **7914** that is rotatable by a clinician to selectively extend and retract extension tube **7910**. More specifically, rotation of extension control element **7912** in a first direction (e.g., clockwise) results in extension of extension tube **7910** while rotation in a second, opposite direction (e.g., counterclockwise) results in retraction of extension tube **7910**.

[0517] FIGS. **79A** and **79C** generally illustrate handle assembly **7902** having a housing **7916**. Housing **7916** includes an aperture **7918** to visually communicate the state of delivery device **7900** and, in particular, extension of extension tube **7910** and implant **7950**. This disclosure contemplates that various techniques may be used to visually indicate extension of extension tube **7910** and implant **7950**; however, as shown in FIGS. **79A** and **79C**, extension/retraction of extension tube **7910** is generally communicated by the relative position of a shuttle indicator **7922** disposed on an extension shuttle **7924**. Extension tube **7910** is coupled to and extends distally from extension shuttle **7924** such that translation of extension shuttle **7924** corresponds to translation of extension tube **7910**. So, as the clinician extends and retracts extension tube **7910** and implant **7950**, extension shuttle **7924** translates within aperture **7918**, moving the location of shuttle indicator **7922** and communicating translation of extension tube **7910**. A scale **7926** is coupled to housing **7916** adjacent shuttle indicator **7922** and includes markers corresponding to various degrees of extension and retraction of extension tube **7910** to communicate the current extension/retraction state to the clinician.

[0518] FIGS. **80A** and **80B** illustrate delivery device handle assembly **7902** with housing **7916** removed and are intended to explain operation of handle assembly **7902** to extend and retract extension tube **7910**. More specifically, FIG. **80A** illustrates handle assembly **7902** in a first state corresponding to extension tube **7910** being in a fully extended configuration (e.g., similar to that illustrated in FIGS. **79A** and **79B**) while FIG. **80B** illustrates handle assembly **7902** in a second state corresponding to extension tube **7910** being in a fully retracted configuration (e.g., similar to that illustrated in FIGS. **79C** and **79D**). Shuttle indicator **7922** is also included in FIGS. **80A** and **80B** in position but decoupled from housing **7916** for purposes of more clearly illustrating shuttle indicator **7922** and its relationship with extension shuttle **7924**.

[0519] Handle assembly **7902** is operable to selectively extend and retract extension tube **7910** between the fully extended configuration shown in FIG. **80A** and the fully retracted configuration shown in FIG. **80B** by rotation of extension knob **7914**. Extension knob **7914** can be rotated in either direction to selectively extend and retract extension tube **7910** and can be used to translate

extension tube **7910** into a fully extended configuration, a fully retracted configuration, or any intermediate (e.g., partially extended/retracted) configuration.

[0520] Extension knob **7914** is coupled to an extension shaft **7928** that extends distally from extension knob **7914** into housing **7916** and is coupled to a distal member **7930** of housing **7916**, thereby longitudinally fixing extension shaft **7928**. Extension shaft **7928** is at least partially threaded and extends through a threaded hole **7932** of extension shuttle **7924**. As shown, extension shuttle **7924** further may include one or more guide bores (e.g., guide bore **7925**) through which corresponding guide members (e.g., guide member **7927**) extend to maintain alignment of and to support extension shuttle **7924** and along which extension shuttle **7924** translates. As extension knob **7914** is rotated, extension shaft **7928** longitudinally drives extension shuttle **7924** along the guide members and, as a result, extends or retracts extension tube **7910** based on the direction of rotation of extension knob **7914**.

[0521] FIGS. **81A-81D** illustrate operation of a second control mechanism of handle assembly **7902** and, specifically, a control mechanism configured to selectively expand and collapse implant **7950**. FIGS. **81A** and **81B** illustrate delivery device **7900** in a first configuration in which implant **7950** is in a collapsed state. As shown in FIG. **81A**, handle assembly **7902** includes an expansion control element **7934** in the form of an expansion knob **7936**. During operation and following unsheathing and extension of implant **7950** from the distal end of catheter assembly **7904**, expansion knob **7936** is rotatable to selectively expand and collapse implant **7950**. FIGS. **81C** and **81D**, for example, illustrate delivery device **7900** in a second configuration in which implant **7950** has been fully expanded by rotation of expansion knob **7936** in a first direction. In the illustrated implementation, expansion knob **7936** is bidirectionally rotatable such that implant **7950** can be selectively expanded and collapsed between the fully expanded state in FIG. **81D**, the fully collapsed state in FIG. **81B**, or any intermediate state of expansion/collapse.

[0522] While the specific mechanical configuration of delivery devices and implants according to this disclosure may vary, expansion and collapse of the implant by the delivery device during delivery generally requires two actions. Expansion is generally achieved by applying radially outward and circumferentially distributed force to the implant. For example, as previously discussed in the context of delivery device **3600** in FIGS. **38-44**, delivery device **3600** includes circumferentially distributed control arms (such as the control arms of control arm assembly **3608** shown in FIGS. **42** and **43**) that can be made to extend radially and apply radially outward force by longitudinal translation of control arm shaft **3642**.

[0523] To facilitate uniform and controlled expansion of the implant, delivery devices according to this disclosure also include one or more cinch lines configured to be run circumferentially about the implant during deployment. For example, delivery device **3600** is a single cinch line implementation with cinch line **3614** indicated in FIG. **38**. As discussed below in the context of release mechanisms for delivery device **7900**, the specific implementation of delivery device **7900** generally includes two, simultaneously controllable cinch lines. In other implementations, delivery devices of this disclosure may include one or more than two cinch lines as described below in further detail in the context of implant release controls. During expansion of the implant and as radially outward force is applied by the control arms, the one or more cinch lines of the delivery device are paid out while maintaining the cinch lines under tension. Among other things, maintaining tension on the cinch lines distributes the radial forces applied by the control arms around the circumference of the implant and improves general responsiveness of expansion/collapse of the implant to manipulation of a corresponding control element (e.g., expansion knob **7936** of handle assembly **7902**).

[0524] Collapsing the implant similarly involves coordinated movement of the control arms and while maintaining tension on one or more cinch lines. In contrast to expansion of the implant during which the control arms are made to extend radially outward by distal translation of the control arm shaft, collapse is achieved by radially collapsing the control arms by proximally

translating the control arm shaft. During collapse, tension is maintained on the one or more cinch lines extending about the implant to facilitate uniform collapse of the implant with good responsiveness to manipulation of the corresponding control element (e.g., expansion knob **7936** of handle assembly **7902**).

[0525] In summary, expansion of the implant involves radial extension of the control arms by distal translation of the control arm shaft and a corresponding payout of the one or more cinch lines under tension as the implant expands. Similarly, collapse of the implant involves radially retraction of the control arms by proximal translation of the control arm shaft and a corresponding retraction of the one or more cinch lines that maintains tension on the one or more cinch lines as the implant collapses.

[0526] In certain implementations, translation of the control arm shaft and cinch line tension may be independently controllable by a clinician using corresponding control elements of the delivery device handle. In other implementations, such as delivery device **7900**, control arm shaft translation and cinch line control are synchronized to operation of a single control element, i.e., expansion knob **7936**. Stated differently, rotation of expansion knob **7936** in a first direction results in both distal translation of a control arm shaft (and, as a result, radial expansion of the control arms) and a synchronized and proportional paying out of the one or more cinch lines to maintain tension on the one or more cinch lines. Rotation of expansion knob **7936** in a second direction results in both proximal translation of the control arm shaft (and, as a result, radial retraction of the control arms) and a synchronized and proportional retraction of the one or more cinch lines to maintain tension on the one or more cinch lines.

[0527] An example mechanism for achieving synchronized control arm shaft and cinch line manipulation is illustrated in FIGS. **82A-82C**, which illustrate handle assembly **7902** with housing **7916** removed. More specifically, FIG. **82A** illustrates handle assembly **7902** in a state corresponding to full collapse of the implant **7950** (e.g., as shown in FIGS. **81A** and **81B**), FIG. **82B** shows a partially transparent detailed view of extension shuttle **7924**, and FIG. **82C** illustrates handle assembly **7902** in a state corresponding to full expansion of implant **7950** (e.g., as shown in FIGS. **81C** and **81D**).

[0528] Referring first to FIG. **82A**, expansion knob **7936** is coupled to an expansion shaft **7938** that extends from expansion knob **7936** into housing **7916**. Expansion shaft **7938** terminates proximally at extension shuttle **7924** and is coupled to extension shuttle **7924** such that expansion shaft **7938** remains longitudinally fixed relative to extension shuttle **7924**. As described below in further detail, rotation of expansion shaft **7938** generally drives rotation of a spool **7944** supported on extension shuttle **7924**. Notably, while rotation of expansion knob **7936** causes rotation of spool **7944**, rotation of expansion knob **7936** does not cause translation of extension shuttle **7924** and corresponding extension/retraction of extension tube **7910** and implant **7950**. Stated differently, expansion and collapse of the implant is controllable independent of longitudinal translation of implant **7950** by extension tube **7910**.

[0529] Housing **7916** further contains an expansion shuttle **7940** coupled to a control arm shaft **7942**. Expansion shuttle **7940** includes a threaded coupling **7943** or similar threaded structure through which expansion shaft **7938** extends. Expansion shuttle **7940** may further include one or more guide bores (e.g., guide bore **7946**) through which corresponding guide members (e.g., guide member **7948**) may extend to maintain alignment of expansion shuttle **7940** and guide translation of expansion shuttle **7940** within housing **7916**. As expansion shaft **7938** is rotated, expansion shaft **7938** longitudinally drives expansion shuttle **7940** along the guide members and, as a result, extends or retracts control arm shaft **7942** based on the direction of rotation of expansion knob **7936**.

[0530] As previously noted, operation of expansion knob **7936** effects both translation of control arm shaft **7942** and corresponding payout or retraction of the one or more cinch lines of delivery device **7900**. FIG. **82B** illustrates extension shuttle **7924** in partial transparency for purposes of

illustrating cinch line control by rotation of expansion knob **7936**. As shown, extension shuttle **7924** includes spool **7944**, which is supported on a body **7952** by a gear **7956** that is threadedly engaged to a worm gear **7958** coupled to expansion shaft **7938**. As a clinician rotates expansion shaft **7938** using expansion knob **7936**, worm gear **7958** drives gear **7956**, causing rotation of spool **7944**. As illustrated, a tether **7960** extends around spool **7944** and is coupled to each of a first cinch line **7962** and a second cinch line **7964**. As spool **7944** rotates in response to rotation of expansion knob **7936**, tether **7960** spools onto or is paid out from spool **7944**, thereby retracting or paying out each of first cinch line **7962** and second cinch line **7964**.

[0531] Referring back to FIG. **82A**, spool **7944** may include a faceplate **7945** that may further include markings for indicating the relative rotation of spool **7944**. Given that spool **7944** rotates in response to expansion and contraction of implant **7950**, markings on faceplate **7945** or similar markings on spool **7944** or extension shuttle **7924** indicating the relative rotation of spool **7944** may be used to communicate the degree to which implant **7950** is expanded/collapsed.

[0532] As noted above, rotating expansion knob **7936** results in simultaneous translation of expansion shuttle **7940** (translating control arm shaft **7942**) and corresponding retraction/payout of the one or more cinch lines of handle assembly **7902**. Synchronization between these two functions is primarily dictated by the interaction between worm gear **7958** and gear **7956**, which collectively form a gearbox or similar transmission system. More specifically, the gear ratio between worm gear **7958** of control arm shaft **7942** and gear **7956** coupled to spool **7944** dictates the relationship between rotation of expansion shaft **7938** and the rotation of spool **7944**. Given that expansion shaft **7938** is coupled to and directly drives expansion shuttle **7940** and that spool **7944** drives retraction and payout of the one or more cinch lines, the gear ratio between worm gear **7958** and gear **7956** also dictates the relationship between translation of control arm shaft **7942** and payout/retraction of the one or more cinch lines.

[0533] Synchronizing the one or more cinch lines with translation of the control arms involves modifying the circumference formed by the one or more cinch lines about the implant with changes in the radius of the implant resulting from extension and retraction of the control arms. In general, one unit of radial change in the implant results in approximately 2π units of circumferential change. Accordingly, worm gear **7958**, gear **7956**, and spool **7944** are sized and configured such that rotation of expansion shaft **7938** resulting in one unit of radial expansion (or contraction) by the control arms results in approximately 2π units of total cinch line payout (or retraction). Notably, in implementations in which two or more cinch lines are included, the 2π units of total cinch line payout or retraction may be distributed among multiple cinch lines. So, for example, in an implementation including two cinch lines, worm gear **7958**, gear **7956**, and spool **7944** would be configured to impart approximately π units of payout/retraction of each cinch line for each unit of radial expansion/contraction of the control arms.

XXIII. DELIVERY TOOL HANDLES FOR SEQUENCED IMPLANT RELEASE

[0534] Following delivery and placement of an implant using delivery devices of this disclosure, a clinician releases the implant from the distal end of the delivery device within the valve annulus.

[0535] FIGS. **83A-83H** are illustrations and corresponding schematic diagrams illustrating an example implant release sequence according to this disclosure. The sequence illustrated in FIGS. **83A-83H** occurs subsequent to placement and implantation of implant **7950**. Accordingly, while the figures illustrate implant **7950** and delivery device **7900** in space, in practice, implant **7950** would be implanted in the valve annulus and retained in position by its frame and retention features, such as barbs or hooks, of the frame.

[0536] FIG. **83A** is an illustration of implant **7950** coupled to catheter assembly **7904** and FIG. **83B** is a proximal schematic view of implant **7950** at an initial stage of releasing implant **7950** from catheter assembly **7904**. As shown in FIG. **83B**, implant **7950** is supported on control arms (e.g., control arm **7966**) of delivery device **7900** and maintained on the control arms by first cinch line **7962** and second cinch line **7964**. Friction and/or interference between mating portions of the

control arms and the frame of the implant may further facilitate retention of implant **7950** on the control arms.

[0537] Each cinch line is routed from a distal end of catheter assembly **7904** about a portion of implant **7950** to a retention location. For example, first cinch line **7962** extends from a first cinch line tube **7968** extending from catheter assembly **7904** and is routed about a first half of implant **7950** to a retention location **7970**. Similarly, second cinch line **7964** extends from a second cinch line tube **7972** about a second half of implant **7950** to retention location **7970**. As previously discussed in this disclosure, routing of each of the cinch lines may include passing each cinch line through a series of retention features distributed about the frame of implant **7950** and/or the control arms. For example, as described previously in this disclosure, such retention features may include a series of circumferentially distributed eyelets or loops configured to facilitate coupling of implant **7950** to the control arms of delivery device **7900** using one or more cinch lines.

[0538] In the state illustrated in FIG. **83B**, first cinch line **7962** and second cinch line **7964** meet at retention location **7970** and are held in place by a controllable retention element. In the implementation shown, the controllable retention element is a retention cable **7974** extending from catheter assembly **7904** to retention location **7970**. At retention location **7970**, retention cable **7974** is threaded through loops or similar features at the terminal ends of first cinch line **7962** and second cinch line **7964** to retain first cinch line **7962** and second cinch line **7964**.

[0539] To initiate decoupling of implant **7950** from delivery device **7900**, a clinician releases retention cable **7974** to free each of first cinch line **7962** and second cinch line **7964** from retention location **7970**. As shown in FIG. **82B**, for example, releasing retention cable **7974** may include proximally retracting or pulling retention cable **7974** into catheter assembly **7904**.

[0540] This disclosure contemplates that a single cinch line may be used to couple implant **7950** to delivery device **7900**. In such implementations, the single cinch line extends around the full circumference of implant **7950** and is retained, e.g., by retention cable **7974** or similar retention member, adjacent the same location where the cinch line first begins its circumferential route around implant **7950**.

[0541] This disclosure further contemplates that more than two cinch lines may be included and routed in various ways about the implant and retained by one or more retention members/retention cables. For example, in the implementation shown in FIG. **83A**, first cinch line tube **7968** and second cinch line tube **7972** open at approximately the same location such that first cinch line **7962** and second cinch line **7964** are routed in opposite directions about implant **7950**. In an alternative implementation, first cinch line tube **7968** and second cinch line tube **7972** may open at locations offset by approximately 180 degrees (e.g., on opposite sides of implant **7950**) such that first cinch line **7962** and second cinch line **7964** may be routed in the same direction (e.g., both clockwise or both counterclockwise) about implant **7950**. Notably, in such cases, delivery device **7900** may include two retention members/retention cables with each retention member retaining and retractable to release a respective one of the cinch lines. In yet other example implementations, delivery device **7900** may include four cinch lines and four cinch line tubes. In one such implementation, the cinch lines tubes may be offset by 90 degrees and cinch lines extending from each cinch line tube may be routed in a common direction about a quarter of the implant. In such implementations, each cinch line may have a corresponding retention member retractable to release the cinch line.

[0542] In another four-tube/four-cinch line implementation, pairs of cinch line tubes may be disposed on opposite sides of implant **7950** with cinch lines extending from each tube about a quarter of implant **7950**. So, for example, distal outlets of two cinch line tubes may be located at a 12 o'clock position of implant **7950** with a first cinch line routed clockwise from a first tube to a 3 o'clock position and a second cinch line routed from the 12 o'clock position to a 9 o'clock position. Distal outlets of two additional cinch line tube may be disposed at a 6 o'clock position of implant **7950** with one cinch line routed clockwise from the 6 o'clock position to the 9 o'clock position and

a second cinch line routed counterclockwise from the 6 o'clock position to the 3 o'clock position. The two cinch lines routed to the 9 o'clock position may then be retained by a first retention member while the two cinch lines routed to the 3 o'clock position may be retained by a second retention member.

[0543] The foregoing arrangement and routing principles may be expanded to support any suitable number of cinch lines and cinch line tubes with the cinch lines routed in either direction about implant **7950**.

[0544] FIG. **83C** is an illustration of implant **7950** coupled to catheter assembly **7904** and FIG. **83D** is a proximal schematic view of implant **7950** at a subsequent stage of release. Following initial retraction of retention cable **7974** to release each of first cinch line **7962** and second cinch line **7964**, each of the cinch lines may be similarly retracted into catheter assembly **7904**. As shown in FIGS. **83C** and **83D**, retracting each of first cinch line **7962** and second cinch line **7964** may include retracting or pulling each of the cinch lines into their respective cinch line tubes (e.g., first cinch line **7962** into first cinch line tube **7968** and second cinch line **7964** into second cinch line tube **7972**).

[0545] In the specific implementation shown, retraction of retention cable **7974**, first cinch line **7962**, and second cinch line **7964** is coordinated such that first cinch line **7962** and second cinch line **7964** begin retraction prior to full retraction of retention cable **7974**. In other implementations, retraction of first cinch line **7962** and second cinch line **7964** may be delayed until full retraction of retention cable **7974** into catheter assembly **7904** or, more generally, any time subsequent to initial retraction of retention cable **7974** and release of the cinch lines from retention location **7970**.

[0546] FIG. **83E** is an illustration of implant **7950** coupled to catheter assembly **7904** and FIG. **83F** is a proximal schematic view of implant **7950** at a further stage of release. FIGS. **83E** and **83F** illustrate a stage in the release operation prior to full retraction of first cinch line **7962** into first cinch line tube **7968** and second cinch line **7964** into second cinch line tube **7972**. As shown, retention cable **7974** has been fully retracted into catheter assembly **7904**. Each of first cinch line **7962** and second cinch line **7964** have also been substantially retracted into its respective tube. Accordingly, with the exception of the final frame spoke and control arm pair adjacent the outlets of the cinch line tubes, implant **7950** is decoupled from delivery device **7900**.

[0547] FIG. **83G** is an illustration of implant **7950** and catheter assembly **7904** and FIG. **83H** is a proximal schematic view of implant **7950** at a final stage of release. More specifically, each of first cinch line **7962** and second cinch line **7964** are fully retracted and, as a result, implant **7950** is no longer coupled to the control arms of delivery device **7900**, as illustrated by the rotational offset between the control arms and frame spokes shown in FIG. **83H**.

[0548] In certain implementations, implant **7950** may be positively retained on the control arms of delivery device **7900** following full retraction of the cinch lines. In such cases, the control arms of delivery device **7900** may be decoupled from implant **7950** by a slight retraction of the control arms, a rotation of the control arms, or another similar movement of the control arms relative to implant **7950** which, as noted above, would be implanted into and retained by tissue around the valve annulus during the release procedure. More generally, the fit between implant **7950** and control arms is such that no or relatively minimal force is required to disengage implant **7950** from delivery device **7900** following removal of the cinch lines. To the extent that implant **7950** and delivery device **7900** are designed to have positive retention without the cinch lines in place, the corresponding fit between implant **7950** and elements of delivery device **7900** should be designed such that decoupling force is substantially less than forces that would result in dislodging of implant **7950** from the valve annulus.

[0549] Following release, the control arms and any other components extending from a distal end of catheter assembly **7904** may be retracted into catheter assembly **7904** and/or sheathed in preparation for removal of delivery device **7900** from the patient.

[0550] In general, the foregoing process involves sequential steps of retracting retention cable **7974**

sufficiently to release first cinch line **7962** and second cinch line **7964** then retracting each of first cinch line **7962** and second cinch line **7964** to fully release implant **7950** from delivery device **7900**.

[0551] To ensure this sequence occurs in the proper order and with proper timing, handle assemblies of delivery devices according to this disclosure may include a single control mechanism for retracting the retention cables and cinch lines for release.

[0552] FIG. **84** is a proximal view of handle assembly **7902** of delivery device **7900**. As shown, handle assembly **7902** includes each of extension knob **7914** and expansion knob **7936** for controlling extension and expansion of implant **7950** when implant **7950** is coupled to the distal end of delivery device **7900** during delivery and implantation.

[0553] FIG. **84** further illustrates a release mechanism in the form of a control ring **7976**. As described below in further detail, control ring **7976** is rotatable to release implant **7950** from delivery device **7900**. More specifically, rotation of control ring **7976** results in retraction of retention cable **7974**, first cinch line **7962**, and second cinch line **7964** (shown in the previous figures) in the correct sequence and with proper timing for release of implant **7950** from delivery device **7900**. As shown in FIG. **84**, control ring **7976** may be locked in position by a lock **7978** (e.g., a locking screw or similar locking mechanism that prevents rotation of control ring **7976**) during delivery and placement of implant **7950**. Once implant **7950** is positioned within the valve annulus, lock **7978** may be unlocked to permit rotation of control ring **7976** and release of implant **7950** from delivery device **7900**.

[0554] Given mechanical conventions of counterclockwise rotation corresponding to retraction (e.g., for screws or similar threaded fasteners), examples discussed in this disclosure generally rely on counterclockwise rotation of control ring **7976** to retract cinch lines and retention cables to release of implant **7950** from delivery device **7900**. Nevertheless, it should be understood that the concepts taught in this disclosure can be readily adapted into a configuration in which release results from clockwise rotation of control ring **7976** instead.

[0555] Further details of the operation of control ring **7976** are now provided with reference to FIGS. **85A-85C**, which illustrate handle assembly **7902** with housing **7916** removed. Referring first to FIG. **85A**, handle assembly **7902** includes a proximal member **7980** or frame element on which control ring **7976** is rotationally supported. Proximal member **7980** defines aperture **7982** through which release lines extend and that is generally aligned with a ring orifice **7977** extending through control ring **7976**. In the specific implementation shown, the release lines include a retention tether **7984** and a cinch line tether **7986**.

[0556] Retention tether **7984** is coupled to a proximal end of retention cable **7974** (shown, e.g. in FIGS. **83B** and **83D**) such that proximally pulling retention tether **7984** results in retraction of retention cable **7974**. As described above in the context of FIGS. **83A** and **83B**, retention cable **7974** generally retains first cinch line **7962** and second cinch line **7964** during implant delivery and deployment and retraction of retention cable **7974** releases first cinch line **7962** and second cinch line **7964** for subsequent detachment of implant **7950** from delivery device **7900**.

[0557] Cinch line tether **7986** forms a loop about each of first cinch line **7962** and second cinch line **7964** such that proximal pulling of cinch line tether **7986** results in retraction of each of first cinch line **7962** and second cinch line **7964**. As noted above in the context of FIGS. **83C-83H**, following release of first cinch line **7962** and second cinch line **7964** by retraction of retention cable **7974**, retraction of first cinch line **7962** and second cinch line **7964** generally causes the cinch lines to retract through coupling features (e.g., eyelets) configured to facilitate retention of implant **7950** on delivery device **7900**, thereby allowing detachment of implant **7950** from delivery device **7900**.

[0558] The looping of cinch line tether **7986** about each of first cinch line **7962** and second cinch line **7964** is more clearly illustrated in FIG. **85B**, which is a detailed view of handle assembly **7902** in the area of extension shuttle **7924**. As shown, tether **7986** loops about and is used to pull/retract each of first cinch line **7962** and second cinch line **7964** simultaneously. However, in other

implementations, separate tethers may be included for each of first cinch line **7962** and second cinch line **7964**.

[0559] As previously noted, implementations of this disclosure may include more than two cinch lines and/or more than a single retention element. In implementations including more than two cinch lines, cinch line tether **7986** may be looped around or otherwise coupled to each of the cinch lines to perform simultaneously retraction of the cinch lines. Alternatively, the handle assembly may include multiple cinch line tethers coupled to approximately the same location on control ring **7976** such that each of the cinch line tethers is pulled simultaneously. As another alternative, retraction of one or more cinch lines may be staggered by coupling the cinch lines or corresponding cinch line tethers for each group to different locations about control ring **7976**.

[0560] Similarly, in implementations with multiple retention elements, each retention element may be coupled to a common retention element tether that, in turn, is coupled to and pullable by control ring **7976**. By doing so, each of the retention elements may be simultaneously pulled by rotating control ring **7976**. Alternatively, the retention elements or tethers coupled to subgroups of the retention elements may be coupled to locations around control ring **7976** such that rotation of control ring **7976** results in sequenced pulling of the retention elements. In general, however, the retention elements are sequenced to be retracted prior to pulling of the cinch lines such that the cinch lines are released by the retention elements and able to be retracted.

[0561] FIG. **85C** is a proximal view of handle assembly **7902** with housing **7916** removed and further illustrating routing of retention tether **7984** and cinch line tether **7986**. As shown, retention tether **7984** generally extends along the longitudinal axis of handle assembly **7902** through aperture **7982** and is coupled to a first attachment location **7988** on control ring **7976**. Cinch line tether **7986** similarly extends through aperture **7982** and is coupled to a second attachment location **7990** on control ring **7976**, second attachment location **7990** being angularly offset from first attachment location **7988**. Due to the coupling of retention tether **7984** and cinch line tether **7986** to control ring **7976**, rotation of control ring **7976** about and relative to proximal member **7980** results in angular movement of retention tether **7984** and cinch line tether **7986** about aperture **7982**. FIG. **85C** further indicates a protrusion **7992** (e.g., a spindle, hub, capstan, or similar structure) is coupled to and extends proximally from proximal member **7980** between control ring **7976** and aperture **7982** in the path of retention tether **7984** and cinch line tether **7986** during rotation of control ring **7976**.

[0562] FIGS. **86A-86D** are schematic illustrations of the view shown in FIG. **85C** illustrating an example release sequence of implant **7950** from delivery device **7900** from the perspective of the release control. FIG. **86A** illustrates essentially the same configuration as FIG. **85C** and corresponds to a state prior to beginning a release process. As noted above in the context of FIG. **85C**, in this state, retention tether **7984** and cinch line tether **7986** extend through aperture of proximal member **7980** and couple to control ring **7976** at first attachment location **7988** and second attachment location **7990**, respectively. Protrusion **7992** is positioned between aperture **7982** and control ring **7976** and along the rotational path of the tethers.

[0563] FIG. **86B**, illustrates handle assembly **7902** following a first counterclockwise rotation of control ring **7976**. The state shown in FIG. **86B** corresponds to a stage in the implant release process following initial retraction of retention cable **7974** and which generally corresponds to a state immediately after that shown in FIG. **83B**. More specifically, the state shown in FIG. **86B** occurs after initial retraction of retention cable **7974** but prior to retraction of first cinch line **7962** and second cinch line **7964**.

[0564] As shown in the transition between FIGS. **86A** and **86B**, rotation of control ring **7976** results in a corresponding rotation of first attachment location **7988** for retention tether **7984** about aperture **7982**. Rotation of first attachment location **7988** causes contact and interference between retention tether **7984** and protrusion **7992** and corresponding wrapping of retention tether **7984** around protrusion **7992**. Protrusion **7992** functions like a pulley or post and increases the length of

retention tether **7984** necessary to extend between aperture **7982** and first attachment location **7988**. As a result, retention tether **7984** is pulled through aperture **7982** proximally pulling and retracting retention cable **7974**.

[0565] Rotation of control ring **7976** similarly results in a corresponding rotation of second attachment location **7990** for cinch line tether **7986** about aperture **7982**. However, in contrast to retention tether **7984**, cinch line tether **7986** is not made to contact protrusion **7992** and the length of cinch line tether **7986** extending between aperture **7982** and second attachment location **7990** remains constant. So, rotation of control ring **7976** as shown in the transition between FIGS. **86A** and **86B** does not result in pulling of cinch line tether **7986** and first cinch line **7962** and second cinch line **7964** remain unretracted.

[0566] FIG. **86C** illustrates handle assembly **7902** following further rotation of control ring **7976**. In the illustrated state, cinch line tether **7986** is about to but has not yet contacted protrusion **7992**. As a result, the length of cinch line tether **7986** extending from aperture **7982** to second attachment location **7990** is the same as in FIGS. **86A** and **86B** and pulling/retraction of the cinch lines has not yet started. In contrast, the additional rotation of control ring **7976** has resulted in further pulling of retention tether **7984** to accommodate the increased distance between aperture **7982** and first attachment location **7988**. As a result, the transition from the state shown in FIG. **86B** to that shown in FIG. **86C** results in further pulling of retention tether **7984** and further retraction of retention cable **7974**.

[0567] FIG. **86D** illustrates handle assembly **7902** following even further rotation of control ring **7976**. Again, this rotation results in further rotation of first attachment location **7988** and second attachment location **7990** about aperture **7982**. As in the previous figures, further rotation of first attachment location **7988** results in additional pulling of retention tether **7984** and further retraction of retention cable **7974** due to the contact between retention tether **7984** and protrusion **7992**. Rotation of control ring **7976** from the state shown in FIG. **86C** to that of FIG. **86D** also results in contact between cinch line tether **7986** and protrusion **7992** and initiating pulling of cinch line tether **7986** through aperture **7982**. Given the looping of cinch line tether **7986** about first cinch line **7962** and second cinch line **7964**, the pulling of cinch line tether **7986** results in retraction of first cinch line **7962** and second cinch line **7964**.

[0568] With retention tether **7984** and cinch line tether **7986** now in contact with protrusion **7992**, further rotation of control ring **7976** results in further retraction of retention cable **7974**, first cinch line **7962**, and second cinch line **7964**. In certain implementations, handle assembly control ring **7976** may include a stop, indicators, or similar features to indicate when control ring **7976** has been sufficiently rotated to sufficiently retract each of retention cable **7974**, first cinch line **7962**, and second cinch line **7964** to release implant **7950** from delivery device **7900**.

[0569] As shown in FIGS. **86A-86D**, sequential retraction of retention cable **7974** followed by the cinch lines is achieved by rotation of control ring **7976** triggering pulling of retention tether **7984** followed by cinch line tether **7986**. More specifically, rotation of control ring **7976** in a release direction first causes retention tether **7984** to contact protrusion **7992**, initiating pulling of retention tether **7984** and retention cable **7974**. Subsequent rotation of control ring **7976** eventually causes contact between cinch line tether **7986** and protrusion **7992**, initiating pulling of cinch line tether **7986** and the cinch lines.

[0570] This disclosure contemplates that the timing and sequencing for pulling of the retention components and the cinch line components can be modified in various ways. For example, by changing the angular offset between the attachment locations on control ring **7976** for retention tether **7984** and cinch line tether **7986**, sequencing of cinch line pulling relative to retention cable pulling can be modified. In general, increasing the angular offset between the attachment locations results in pulling of the cinch lines initiated later in the process of retracting the retention cable. Conversely, decreasing the angular offset between the attachment locations results in retraction of the cinch lines beginning earlier in the process of retracting the retention cable. Protrusion **7992**

may also be modified to change timing and sequencing of the release operation. For example, the rate at which the tethers are pulled per unit of rotation of control ring **7976** is generally a function of the size of protrusion **7992**. As a result, increasing or decreasing the circumference/perimeter of protrusion **7992** can be used to increase or decrease the rate at which the tethers are pulled (all other things being equal).

XXIV. STRUCTURAL MOUNTING OF DELIVERY SYSTEM

[0571] FIGS. **77A-78C** illustrate implant delivery system **7700**, which includes delivery device **7702** and mounting assembly **7704**. As described in the context of those figures, mounting assembly **7704** is generally configured to support delivery device **7702** and may include various features for controlled operation of delivery device **7702**. For example, FIGS. **77A** and **77B** illustrate longitudinal translation of delivery device **7702** relative to mounting assembly **7704** by rotation of knob **7712** to perform insertion/retraction of delivery device **7702**. FIGS. **78A-78C** similarly illustrate manual rotation of delivery device **7702** within mounting assembly **7704**. Additional details regarding mounting assemblies are provided below with specific reference to FIGS. **87A-87L**, which illustrate mounting assembly **8700** and various components of mounting assembly **8700**. Mounting assembly **8700** is substantially like mounting assembly **7704** of FIGS. **78A-78C**, so unless otherwise stated, the description of mounting assembly **7704** provided earlier in this disclosure is generally applicable to mounting assembly **8700**.

[0572] FIG. **87A** is an isometric view of a mounting assembly **8700** according to the present disclosure. Mounting assembly **8700** includes a structural coupling **8702**, an arm assembly **8710**, and a handle mount assembly **8730**. FIG. **87A** further includes a handle assembly element **8701** and a structural element **8703**.

[0573] As shown, mounting assembly **8700** is coupled to and supported by structural element **8703**.

[0574] More specifically, structural coupling **8702** couples to structural element **8703** with arm assembly **8710** coupled to and extending from structural coupling **8702**. Arm assembly **8710** may be any suitable structure for supporting and adjusting the position and orientation of handle mount assembly **8730**. As shown, arm assembly **8710** is a universal articulating arm structure including multiple manipulable and lockable joints. This disclosure contemplates that other support structures may be used to support and maintain position of handle mount assembly **8730** during use, arm assembly **8710** is included as a specific example that includes degrees of freedom and flexibility that are conducive to use with delivery devices of this disclosure.

[0575] Handle mount assembly **8730** is coupled to and extends from arm assembly **8710**. During use, handle mount assembly **8730** receives and provides direct support of a delivery device, as reflected by handle assembly element **8701**. As noted in the context of **77A-78C** and as further discussed below, handle mount assembly **8730** may further include elements for facilitating insertion and rotation of a delivery device while maintaining a longitudinal axis of the delivery device in a fixed location.

[0576] In general, handle assembly element **8701** corresponds to a portion of a delivery device according to this disclosure. More specifically, handle assembly element **8701** corresponds to a handle assembly of a delivery device and is provided in the figures to illustrate how delivery devices of this disclosure are received and supported by mounting assembly **8700**. This disclosure contemplates that each of handle assembly element **8701** may vary and, as such, handle assembly element **8701** is intended only as a non-limiting example of a delivery device structure that may be received and supported by mounting assembly **8700**.

[0577] Structural element **8703** is intended to reflect an environmental structure, such as a bed rail, to which mounting assembly **8700** may be coupled and that supports mounting assembly **8700**. Like handle assembly element **8701**, structural element **8703** is provided as a non-limiting example of a structure to which mounting assembly **8700** may be coupled. Accordingly, any specific aspects of structural element **8703** shown in the figures should be considered non-limiting. For example, this disclosure contemplates that structural element **8703** may vary in size and shape from that

shown in the figures or that mounting assembly **8700** may be coupled to structures other than bed rails, including standalone mounting systems that do not rely on other capital equipment within the operating theater.

[0578] FIG. **87B** is an isometric view of handle mount assembly **8730** and a terminal portion of arm assembly **8710** including an interface block **8774**. Handle mount assembly **8730** includes a carriage assembly **8732** coupled to and movable along a rail assembly **8750**. Rail assembly **8750** includes a rail **8752** and a frame **8754**. Carriage assembly **8732** and rail assembly **8750** are selectively coupled to arm assembly **8710** by an interface **8770**. Interface **8770** includes a rail-side interface element in the form of a plate **8772** that is receivable by interface block **8774**. As shown, interface block **8774** further includes a locking control **8776** in the form of a lever that can be selectively engaged and disengaged to fix and release plate **8772** from interface block **8774**, thereby permitting selective attachment and removal of handle mount assembly **8730** from arm assembly **8710**. FIG. **87B** further includes an extension member **8778** coupled to and extending from interface block **8774** and that couples interface block **8774** to the remainder of arm assembly **8710**. In general, extension member **8778** is configured to mate with and to be coupled with a terminal end of arm assembly **8710**.

[0579] In the implementation shown, carriage assembly **8732** includes a manually driven stepper-type drive system. More specifically, carriage assembly **8732** is retained on rail assembly **8750** by a dove-tail type mating arrangement. Carriage assembly **8732** includes knobs (such as knob **8740**) that are rotatable to provide controlled translation of carriage assembly **8732** along rail assembly **8750**. For example, knob **8740** may be coupled to an internal gear or cog of carriage assembly **8732** that mates with rail **8752** of rail assembly **8750** such that rotation of knob **8740** rotates the internal gear or cog and drives carriage assembly **8732** along rail **8752**.

[0580] FIG. **87C** is a detailed isometric view of rail assembly **8750**. More specifically, FIG. **87C** illustrates a distal portion of rail **8752** and frame **8754**. As shown, rail assembly **8750** may have an open end **8751** to facilitate attachment and removal of carriage assembly **8732** from rail assembly **8750**. In certain implementations, rail assembly **8750** may include a retention feature, such as stop **8753** that generally retains carriage assembly **8732** on rail **8752**, but that can be selectively disengaged to permit sliding of carriage assembly **8732** off rail **8752** at open end **8751**. For example, stop **8753** is generally biased into the configuration shown in FIG. **87C** to retain carriage assembly **8732** on rail **8752**; however, stop **8753** may be depressed, removed, or otherwise disengaged to permit sliding of carriage assembly **8732** off open end **8751**. Referring to FIG. **87B**, frame **8754** is shown as further including an optional stop **8756** protruding from a proximal portion of frame **8754** and that limits proximal travel of carriage assembly **8732** along rail **8752**.

[0581] FIGS. **87D** and **87E** isometric views of rail assembly **8750**, carriage assembly **8732** and interface **8770** in a decoupled state. As shown in FIG. **87D**, plate **8772** is coupled to an underside of frame **8754** and includes a retention structure **8773**. Interface block **8774** includes a face **8779** shaped to receive retention structure **8773** (e.g., having a groove or channel shaped to correspond to the exterior surface of the U-shaped retention structure) and further includes a locking pillar **8775** shaped to be received within an internal channel **8777** defined on an inner surface of retention structure **8773**. As specifically shown in FIG. **87D**, retention structure **8773** is in the form of a U-shaped channel with a groove or channel extending along the inner surface of the U-shaped structure. During operation, locking pillar **8775** is manipulable to selectively engage internal channel **8777** to lock interface block **8774** to plate **8772**.

[0582] FIGS. **87G** and **87H** illustrate interface block **8774** in an open/unlocked state and a closed/locked state, respectively. In the illustrated implementations, interface block **8774** transitions between the open/unlocked state of FIG. **87G** to the closed/locked state of FIG. **87H** in response to actuation of locking control **8776**. As shown, locking control **8776** is in the form of a cam-style lever that drives locking pillar **8775** between a raised position (shown in FIG. **87G**) and a retracted position (shown in FIG. **87H**). In operation, plate **8772** is slid onto interface block **8774**

while locking pillar **8775** is in the open configuration shown in FIG. **87G**. More specifically, plate **8772** is slid onto interface block **8774** such that a lip **8771** of locking pillar **8775** is received within internal channel **8777** of retention structure **8773**. Locking control **8776** is then actuated to retract locking pillar **8775** into interface block **8774**, thereby locking interface block **8774** to plate **8772**. [0583] Among other advantages, the specific coupling arrangement illustrated in FIGS. **87D** and **87E** can facilitate maintaining a sterile operating environment. FIGS. **87H** and **87I**, for example, are perspective views of mounting assembly **8700** with and without carriage assembly **8732** coupled to interface block **8774**. As shown in the figures, interface block **8774** and arm assembly **8710** may be covered in a sterile drape **8781** such that between surgeries carriage assembly **8732** and rail assembly **8750** may be readily detached from arm assembly **8710** for disposal or sterilizing. With carriage assembly **8732** and arm assembly **8710** removed, a used drape can be readily slid off arm assembly **8710** and replaced with a new, sterile drape, thereby eliminating or reducing the need to re-sterilize the underlying arm assembly **8710**.

[0584] FIGS. **87J** and **87K** are isometric views of carriage assembly **8732**. More specifically, FIG. **87J** illustrates carriage assembly **8732** including a yoke **8712** and retaining handle assembly element **8701**. FIG. **87K** illustrates carriage assembly **8732** with yoke **8712** removed to better show a rotating collar **8738**.

[0585] As previously discussed, carriage assembly **8732** includes a knob **8740** rotatable to drive carriage assembly **8732** along rail **8752** of rail assembly **8750**. Such translation of carriage assembly **8732** can be used to control insertion of a delivery device coupled to mounting assembly **8700**.

[0586] Implementations of this disclosure may also enable rotation of the delivery device relative to carriage assembly **8732**. For example, as most clearly shown in FIG. **87K**, carriage assembly **8732** may include a rotating collar **8738**. Rotating collar **8738** is coupled to and supported by a body **8742** of carriage assembly **8732** and is rotatable relative to body **8742** about a longitudinal axis **8744**, which corresponds to a longitudinal axis of the delivery device when retained by carriage assembly **8732**. In at least some implementations, rotation of rotating collar **8738** may be guided by a slot **8746** or similar guide element of rotating collar **8738** that mates with a corresponding structure of body **8742** (not shown). An example of such rotation is shown in FIGS. **78A-78C**, which illustrate rotation of delivery device **7702** within cradle **7706**. As further shown in FIGS. **87J** and **87K**, carriage assembly **8732** may include a rotational lock (e.g., locking knob **8739**) configured to selectively lock and unlock rotating collar **8738** in position.

[0587] In at least certain implementations, carriage assembly **8732** may be configured to facilitate discrete rotation of rotating collar **8738**. For example, FIG. **87L** is a detailed view of carriage assembly **8732** as presented in FIG. **87L**. As shown, rotating collar **8738** includes a proximal face **8741** that further includes a series of detents (e.g., detent **8743**). Carriage assembly **8732** may include one or more corresponding protrusions (not shown) such that as a clinician or operator rotates rotating collar **8738**, rotating collar **8738** transitions between discrete rotational positions due to engagement of the protrusion with the detents.

[0588] FIG. **87M** is an isometric view of yoke **8712**, which, as illustrated in FIG. **87I**, is coupled to and retained by rotating collar **8738** when carriage assembly **8732** is fully assembled. As shown in FIG. **87M**, yoke **8712** includes a lower member **8714** and an upper member **8716** coupled to lower member **8714** by a hinge **8718** or similar joint. Each of lower member **8714** and upper member **8716** are generally shaped to conform to and receive a portion of a delivery tool, e.g., as shown in the previous figures by retention of assembly element **8701** by yoke **8712**. Although this disclosure contemplates other styles of closure mechanisms, yoke **8712** includes a cam-style latching mechanism **8720** configured to clamp upper member **8716** relative to lower member **8714** and about the delivery device.

[0589] FIG. **87N** is an isometric view of structural coupling **8702** and structural element **8703**. As previously noted, structural coupling **8702** is coupleable to structural element **8703** or other capital

equipment within an operating environment to support mounting assembly **8700**. As illustrated, structural coupling **8702** includes a body **8704** shaped to receive or otherwise mate with structural element **8703**. Structural coupling **8702** further includes a locking or retention mechanism (e.g., locking knob **8706**) adapted to affix structural coupling **8702** to structural element **8703** once positioned on structural element **8703**.

[0590] Mounting assembly **8700** is intended to illustrate one example mounting structure suitable for use with delivery devices of this disclosure. This disclosure contemplates that the various components and features of mounting assembly **8700** illustrated in the figures and discussed above can be replaced or modified with one or more other alternative components. For example, arm assembly **8710** may be substituted with any other suitable articulating or non-articulating assembly capable of supporting delivery devices of this disclosure in position relative to a patient. Similarly, while mounting assembly **8700** is illustrated as including structural elements for providing controlled insertion and rotation of delivery devices, either functionality may be omitted. As another example, mounting assembly **8700** includes cam-style locking mechanisms for several components. Such locking mechanisms are generally easy and intuitive to articulate in a surgical context; however, other locking mechanisms may be used in their place. For example, yoke **8712** is illustrated in FIG. **87K** as including a cam-style latching mechanism **8720**; however, cam-style latching mechanism **8720** may be readily substituted with a screw-type lock, a magnetic latch, a tie down, or other suitable mechanism.

XXV. CONTROL ARM ASSEMBLY INCLUDING CANTILEVERED CONTROL ARMS

[0591] FIGS. **56-58** illustrate an example implementation of a delivery device **3600** according to the present disclosure and described in further detail, above. As shown in those figures, delivery device **3600** generally includes a control arm assembly **3608** at distal portion **3636** of delivery device **3600**.

[0592] Control arm assembly **3608** includes multiple control arm pairs distributed around an extension member **3606**. Extension member **3606** is selectively extendable and retractable relative to delivery catheter **3604** to facilitate deployment of implant **3800**.

[0593] Each control arm pair of control arm assembly **3608** includes a proximal arm **3634** coupled to a respective distal arm **3640**. During operation, a control shaft disposed within delivery catheter **3604** and coupled to a proximal end of each of the proximal control arms of control arm assembly **3608** is translatable to selectively extend and retract the proximal control arms. As the proximal control arms are extended, diverter **3628** directs the proximal arms in a lateral and outward direction. Due to the coupling of the distal control arms to their respective proximal control arms, this lateral extension of the proximal control arms results in similar lateral and outward movement of the distal control arms, thereby expanding control arm assembly **3608**. Such expansion of control arm assembly **3608** causes similar expansion of implant **3800**, which is generally coupled to and supported by control arm assembly **3608** during delivery and implantation. Collapse of the implant can be similarly achieved by retracting the control shaft, which retracts the proximal control arms, laterally contracts the coupling of the distal and proximal control arms, and collapses control arm assembly **3608**, thereby collapsing implant **3800**.

[0594] As shown in FIGS. **57** and **58**, each of the control arm pairs of delivery device **3600** generally include a proximal control arm, e.g., proximal arm **3634**, and a respective distal control arm, e.g., distal arm **3640**. More specifically, and with reference to FIG. **58**, proximal portion **3641** of distal arm **3640** is coupled to distal portion **3636** of proximal arm **3634** by a T-and-slot style joint in which a T-shaped protrusion **3637** of proximal arm **3634** is inserted through and subsequently rotated to be retained by aperture **3639** of distal arm **3640**. Notably, the coupling of distal arm **3640** and proximal arm **3634** in delivery device **3600** is at or near the end of the control arms.

[0595] Among other advantages, the control arm coupling and arrangement of delivery device **3600** and control arm assembly **3608** results in a substantially maximum moment arm for distal arm

3640 and efficient transfer of forces applied to proximal arm **3634** (e.g., by translating the control shaft) to distal arm **3640**. As illustrated in FIG. **56**, however, coupling the distal end of the proximal control arms at or near the proximal ends of the distal control arms generally limits the degree to which control arm assembly **3608** may be retracted during delivery and implantation. For example, FIG. **56** illustrates delivery device **3600** in a fully collapsed and fully or near fully retracted state. Further retraction of control arm assembly **3608** into delivery catheter **3604** from the state shown in FIG. **56** generally results in interference between control arm assembly **3608** and the distal end of delivery catheter **3604**, precluding further retraction.

[0596] Since the control arm assembly is a generally rigid body and protrudes from the distal end of the delivery catheter, the degree to which the control arm assembly can retract relative to the delivery catheter contributes to the general maneuverability of the implant during delivery and implantation. More specifically and all other things being relatively equal, a control arm assembly that is further retractable into the delivery catheter will reduce the non-steerable length at the distal end of the delivery device, improving the maneuverability of the distal end and, by extension, an implant coupled to the distal end.

[0597] With the foregoing in mind, FIGS. **88A-89** illustrate an alternative configuration of a delivery device **8800** including a control arm assembly **8802** for selectively expanding and collapsing an implant **8850** and that is extendible from a delivery catheter **8804**. In contrast to control arm assembly **3608** of delivery device **3600**, in which coupling of the control arm pairs is positioned near the ends of the proximal and distal control arms, control arm assembly **8802** includes control arm pairs in which coupling of the proximal control arm and the distal control arm is positioned away from the end of the distal control arm such that a portion of the distal control arm is cantilevered. This configuration enables further retraction of control arm assembly **8802** into delivery catheter **8804** during delivery as compared to control arm assembly **3608**, improving maneuverability of the distal end of delivery catheter **8804** and facilitating improved positioning and orientation of implant **8850**.

[0598] FIG. **88A** is a proximal perspective view of a distal end **8801** of delivery device **8800** with implant **8850** coupled to control arm assembly **8802**. For clarity, delivery catheter **8804** is shown in FIG. **88A** in dashed lines and occluder and outer skirt of implant **8850** are omitted. Control arm assembly **8802** is coupled to and distributed about an extension member **8806**, which is selectively extendible from and retractable into delivery catheter **8804**. So, for example, delivery catheter **8804** will generally be kept in a fully or near fully retracted state during delivery of the implant to minimize the unsteerable distal length of delivery device **8800**. Following approximate placement of implant **8850**, extension member **8806** is extended (in conjunction with retraction of a sheath (not shown) extending about the distal end of delivery device **8800**) from delivery catheter **8804**, deploying implant **8850** and permitting expansion of implant **8850** prior to final positioning/orientation and placement within the valve annulus.

[0599] As illustrated and as previously discussed in other sections of this disclosure, implant **8850** is coupled to control arm assembly **8802** by a first cinch line **8852** and a second cinch line **8854** that extend from a first cinch line tube **8856** and a second cinch line tube **8858**, respectively, about a circumference of implant **8850**. Implant **8850** includes eyelets (e.g., eyelet **8859**) that extend proximally through slots (e.g., slot **8817**, indicated in FIGS. **88D** and **88E**) formed in the distal control arms of control arm assembly **8802** with each of the cinch lines routed through the eyelets on a proximal side of the control arms, e.g., as illustrated in FIG. **73B**. Each of first cinch line **8852** and second cinch line **8854** are held in position by a retention member **8860** that is retractable into delivery catheter **8804** through extension member **8806** to allow for retraction of first cinch line **8852** and second cinch line **8854** and release of implant **8850** from control arm assembly **8802**.

[0600] FIG. **88B** is the same perspective of FIG. **88A**, albeit with implant **8850** and the cinch line-related elements of delivery device **8800** removed for clarity while FIG. **88C** is a side elevation view of control arm assembly **8802**. With reference to FIGS. **88B** and **88C**, control arm assembly

8802 generally includes a series of control arm pairs distributed about extension member **8806**. In the specific example of delivery device **8800**, control arm assembly **8802** includes six control arms pairs distributed at 60-degree offsets; however, other implementations of this disclosure may include more or fewer control arm pairs with different distributions.

[0601] Each control arm pair includes a proximal control arm, e.g., proximal control arm **8808**, coupled to a respective distal control arm, e.g., distal control arm **8810**. As shown in FIGS. **88D** and **88E**, coupling of proximal control arm **8808** to distal control arm **8810** may be based on a T-and-slot type coupling like the coupling arrangement discussed above in the context of FIG. **58**. More specifically, proximal control arm **8808** includes a T- or I-shaped protrusion **8812** that is inserted through a corresponding aperture **8814** of distal control arm **8810** and rotated such that distal control arm **8810** is retained by protrusion **8812** and resulting in a coupling **8816** connecting proximal control arm **8808** and distal control arm **8810** in a hinge-like manner. Notably, coupling **8816** is disposed at a location distal a proximal end **8818** of distal control arm **8810** such that proximal end **8818** extends beyond coupling **8816** and forms a cantilevered section **8820** of distal control arm **8810**.

[0602] Referring to FIG. **88B**, the proximal control arm of each control arm pair of control arm assembly **8802** may be coupled to or drivable by a control shaft **8824** disposed within delivery catheter **8804**. More specifically, as delivery catheter **8804** is translated distally, the proximal control arms are made to extend distally and radially outward (e.g., due to being directed outwardly by a diverter **8826**). As the proximal control arms extend radially outward, they push the distal control arms outward as well, thereby expanding control arm assembly **8802**. Conversely, if control arm assembly **8802** is in an expanded state and control shaft **8824** is proximally translated, the proximal control arms of control arm assembly **8802** are retracted and radially collapsed, resulting in corresponding radially collapse of the distal control arms to which the proximal control arms are coupled.

[0603] FIG. **88F** illustrates proximal control arm **8808** and distal control arm **8810** in further detail with certain dimensions indicated. As shown in FIG. **88E**, when fully expanded, distal control arm **8810** extends a length **L2** relative to a longitudinal axis **8822** of delivery device **8800**. In certain implementations, **L2** may be from and including about 20 mm to and including about 40 mm. For example, **L2** may be about 27 mm. In contrast, coupling **8816** is located at a length **L3** relative to longitudinal axis **8822**. In certain implementations, **L3** may be from and including about 15 mm to and including about 20 mm, but not greater than **L2**. For example, **L3** may be about 20 mm. More generally, **L3** may be based on a relationship to **L2**. For example, in certain implementations **L3** may be positioned at a location that is approximately within a central two-thirds of **L2**. As another example, **L3** may be from and including about 40% to and including about 90% of **L2**. For example, **L3** may be about 75% of **L2**.

[0604] As shown in FIG. **88F**, each of the distal control arms may include various curved sections such that the distal control arms generally conform to other elements of delivery device **8800** when the distal control arms are in a collapsed state. For example, distal control arm **8810** includes each of a distal bend **8828**, a medial bend **8830**, and a proximal bend **8832** adapted to conform distal control arm **8810** to extension member **8806** and delivery catheter **8804**.

[0605] FIG. **89** is a perspective view of delivery device **8800** with control arm assembly **8802** in a collapsed state, as shown, distal control arm **8810** is coupled to proximal control arm **8808** and is shaped to generally conform to extension member **8806** and delivery catheter **8804**. More specifically, distal bend **8828** of distal control arm **8810** directs a first portion of distal control arm **8810** toward and along extension member **8806**. Medial bend **8830** then directs a medial section of distal control arm **8810** radially outward and around a tip **8834** of delivery catheter **8804**. Finally, proximal bend **8832** redirects distal control arm **8810** radially inward toward or parallel to delivery catheter **8804**. Stated differently, the various curves of distal control arm **8810** result in a shape of distal control arm **8810** that generally conforms to the distal end of the various components of

delivery device **8800**. Notably, the shape of distal control arm **8810** enables retraction of control arm assembly **8802** such that a proximal extend of control arm assembly **8802** is positioned proximally beyond a distal end of delivery catheter **8804**, reducing the non-steerable length of delivery catheter **8804**. In at least certain implementations, the curved shape of distal control arm **8810** also results in a bulbous shape, particularly when sheathed, that is readily navigable through physiological lumens of the patient.

XXVI. ALTERNATIVE EXAMPLE IMPLANTATION PROCESS

[0606] To provide additional detail and context for the various features described in the preceding sections, FIG. **90** is a block diagram illustrating a method **9000** for implanting an implant using delivery device, each of the implant and delivery device according to various aspects of this disclosure.

[0607] At step **9002**, the implant and the delivery device are prepared for the implantation process. In general, preparation of the implant on the delivery device includes coupling the implant to a distal end of the delivery device, inserting the implant into a sheath/delivery catheter of the delivery device, and mounting the delivery device within the operating theater.

[0608] As described throughout this disclosure, coupling of the implant to the delivery device generally includes routing one or more cinch about the implant in a manner that couples the implant to a control arm assembly of the delivery device. For example, as illustrated in FIG. **73B**, the implant may include circumferentially distributed eyelets (e.g., eyelet **6802**) that extend proximally through both a frame (e.g., frame **6355**) of the implant and control arms (e.g., control arm **7308**) of the control arm assembly such that an aperture (e.g., cinch line hole **6810**) of the eyelet is positioned proximal both the frame and control arm. A cinch line is then routed through the aperture and fixed (e.g., using a retractable retention member), thereby coupling the implant to the control arm assembly. FIG. **59** illustrates an alternative implementation in which cinch lines are routed through rings coupled to each of control arms of the control arm assembly and the implant frame such that cinch lines run through the rings similarly couples the implant to the control arm assembly.

[0609] In at least some implementations, coupling of the implant to the delivery device may also be facilitated through mating of corresponding elements of the implant and the control arm assembly. For example, referring back to FIG. **73B**, eyelet **6802** may be sized and shaped to be press fit through slot **7312** of control arm **7308**, thereby providing additional positive retention of the implant on the control arm assembly.

[0610] Coupling of the implant to the delivery device is generally performed with the delivery device in an extended position. For example, as previously discussed, the delivery device generally includes an internal tubular member coupled to the control arm assembly and that is longitudinally translatable relative to the delivery catheter of the delivery device. During delivery and implantation, such extension and retraction facilitates positioning and orientation of the implant without requiring substantial steering or insertion of the delivery catheter. Accordingly, during preparation of the delivery device and implant, the delivery device may be placed in a fully or partially extended state. following coupling of the implant to the control arm assembly of the delivery device, the implant may be radially compressed and the control arm assembly retracted such that the implant is partially retracted into the delivery catheter and/or is coverable by an extendible sheath of the delivery device.

[0611] With the implant coupled to the delivery device and sheathed, the delivery device may be coupled to a mount assembly, such as the mount assembly described above in the context of FIGS. **87A-87N**.

[0612] As noted in the context of FIGS. **87H** and **87I**, preparation of the implant and delivery device may also include preparation of the mounting assembly on which the delivery device is supported, such as by sterilizing and/or applying a sterile drape to the mounting assembly prior to coupling the delivery device to the mounting assembly.

[0613] At step **9004**, the implant is delivered to a patient atrium, e.g., via an antegrade percutaneous route (e.g., a trans-femoral or trans-jugular route). Navigating the delivery device and implant to the implantation site may include routing the delivery device along a guidewire previously inserted into the patient and extending to the atrium.

[0614] Navigating the delivery device and implant may include one or more of a combination of steering the delivery catheter of the delivery device, modifying insertion of the delivery device, modifying rotation of the delivery device, or any similar movement and manipulation of the delivery device. In certain implementations, at least some of the maneuverability of the delivery catheter and the delivery device may be provided by insertion and rotation control elements of the mounting assembly to which the delivery device is attached. For example, the mounting assembly of FIGS. **87A-87N** includes a stepper-type control knob that may be rotated to control insertion of the delivery device and a manually rotatable collar that can be rotationally indexed to modify a rotation of the delivery device.

[0615] As noted, navigating the implant may also include steering the delivery catheter of the delivery device. In certain implementations, the delivery catheter may include multiple steerable sections. For example, in the specific example illustrated in FIGS. **45A-45H**, delivery catheter **3604** includes a distal steerable section **4502** and a proximal section proximal steerable section **4504** with distal steerable section **4502** steerable along a first plane and proximal steerable section **4504** steerable along each of the first plane and a second plane orthogonal to the first plane (both relative to delivery catheter **3604** being in a neutral steering configuration). As described and illustrated in the context of FIG. **46**, steering may be achieved in certain implementation, by a collection of levers disposed at the handle assembly of the delivery device with each handle manipulable to control steering of a corresponding section of the delivery catheter along a specific plane.

[0616] Step **9006** includes retracting the sheath extending around the distal end of the delivery device, including the implant, to facilitate subsequent deployment of the implant. As discussed in previous sections, retracting of the sheath may include manipulating a corresponding control of the delivery device handle assembly to proximally translate the sheath relative to the delivery catheter, thereby exposing the distal end of the delivery device and the implant.

[0617] Step **9008** includes deploying the implant. Deploying the implant generally refers to the process of clearing the implant from the sheath and the distal end of the delivery catheter such that the implant can be freely expanded, collapsed, and positioned for implantation.

[0618] In at least certain implementations, clearing the implant from the sheath and the distal end of the delivery catheter may include distally extending the implant relative to the delivery catheter. For example, FIGS. **79A-80B** illustrate an example handle assembly mechanism configured to longitudinally translate the implant relative to the delivery catheter. More specifically, the handle assembly shown includes a rotatable knob that drives an internal shuttle of the handle assembly. The shuttle, in turn, is coupled to an extension shaft that extends through the delivery catheter and terminates in the control arm assembly to which the implant is coupled. Operating the rotatable knob translates the shuttle within the handle assembly, thereby driving the extension shaft and, as a result, the control arm assembly and implant. As noted in FIGS. **74-76D**, in at least certain implementations, the extension member may include sections of selectively modified flexibility such that the extension shaft does not substantially impact the steerability of the delivery catheter within which the extension shaft extends.

[0619] Deploying the implant may further include expanding the implant following clearance of the sheath and the delivery catheter. As described in the context of FIGS. **81A-82C**, expansion of the implant may be performed by rotation of an expansion control, e.g., a rotatable knob, of the handle assembly. In one specific implementation, expansion is achieved by actuation (e.g., rotation) of the expansion control, which results in simultaneous proximal translation of a control arm shaft and corresponding payout of the cinch lines coupling the control arm assembly to the implant. Proximal translation of the control arm shaft causes the control arm pairs of the control arm

assembly to expand laterally. Given the coupling of the implant to the control arm assembly and the biasing of the implant into expansion, expansion of the control arm assembly drives and/or permits natural expansion of the implant into an expanded state. Notably, payout of the cinch lines is generally coordinated by the handle assembly such that the cinch lines are maintained in tension as the implant expands. Doing so improves the uniformity with which the implant expands while improving the responsiveness of the implant to actuation of the expansion controls.

[0620] Step **9010** includes retracting/de-extending the implant relative to the delivery catheter following at least partial expansion of the implant in step **9008**. Among other things, such retraction of the implant relative to the delivery catheter reduces the non-steerable length at the distal end of the delivery device. With less non-steerable length, the implant can be more readily and accurately manipulated within the atrium to facilitate proper alignment of the implant with the valve annulus. In certain implementations, the retraction of step **9010** may be performed by reversing the extension mechanism discussed above in the context of step **9008**. So, for example, the extension control (e.g., the rotatable knob corresponding to extension) of the handle assembly may be actuated in an opposite direction to proximally retract the shuttle of the handle assembly. Doing so also retracts the extension shaft, thereby retracting the now-expanded implant relative to the delivery catheter.

[0621] Step **9012** includes positioning the implant for final implantation. Among other things, such positioning may include aligning or approximately aligning a longitudinal axis of the implant with a valve axis normal to the valve annulus. Positioning the implant may further include adjusting the height of the implant relative to the valve annulus such that an occluder of the implant is positioned to interact with or otherwise contact the native leaflets of the patient valve. Positioning the implant may include additional expanding, collapsing, and/or moving of the implant to achieve proper positioning of the implant relative to the valve annulus. Moving of the implant may include, without limitation, one or more of changing rotation and insertion of the delivery device, steering of the delivery catheter, and extending/retracting the implant relative to the delivery catheter, as described in previous steps.

[0622] Step **9014** includes fully expanding the implant once in position for implantation. As noted above in the context of step **9008**, expanding the implant generally includes operating an expansion control of the handle assembly that simultaneously expands the control arm assembly to which the implant is coupled and pays out the cinch line extending around the implant. By fully expanding the implant, within the valve annulus, the implant is made to interfere with and engage cardiac tissue.

[0623] For example, the implant may include outwardly protruding prongs or tines shaped and positioned to engage tissue adjacent the valve during the expansion process.

[0624] Step **9016** includes releasing the implant from the delivery device by decoupling the implant from the control arm assembly of the delivery device. A full description of an example release process and corresponding handle mechanisms for achieving release of the implant are described above in the context of FIGS. **83A-86D**. In general, however, certain release processes include coordinate release and retraction of the cinch lines coupling the implant to the control arm assembly. For example, in certain implementations, the handle assembly includes a control element (e.g., a rotating ring) that, when actuated first pulls one or more retention members that pin the cinch lines extending around the implant in position. Further rotation of the control element then initiates pulling of the cinch lines into the delivery catheter, thereby decoupling the control arm assembly and the implant. In implementations in which the control arm assembly and implant are further coupled by a press fit or similar loose-fitting joint, full release of the implant from the control arm assembly/delivery device may further include retracting the control arm assembly (e.g., by operating the extension mechanism to retract the control arm assembly) or by applying a similar proximal force on the control arm assembly (e.g., by retracting or rotating the delivery device, steering the delivery catheter, or performing a similar actuation of the delivery device).

[0625] Step **9018** includes preparing the delivery device for retraction and removal from the patient. In general, preparation of the delivery device includes fully collapsing and retracting the control arm assembly and re-sheathing the distal portion of the delivery device. Finally, at step **9020**, the delivery device may be removed from the patient. In certain cases, removal of the delivery device from the patient includes both retraction of the delivery device and steering of the catheter into a substantially neutral position as the distal end of the delivery device exits the atrium. Following removal of the delivery device from the atrium, the delivery catheter may be fully extracted from the patient back along the surgical route used during insertion.

XXVII. ALTERNATIVE CONTROL ARM ASSEMBLY EMBODIMENTS

[0626] Previous sections of this disclosure introduced various example embodiments of control arm assemblies with different configurations and features. In general, control arm assemblies according to this disclosure are configured to be coupled to an implant during delivery, to facilitate deployment of the implant prior to implantation, and to enable release of the implant once properly positioned.

[0627] With respect to facilitating deployment, control arm assemblies according to this disclosure are configured to selectively expand and contract (e.g., by translating a corresponding shaft coupled to the control arms of the control arm assembly) and, by extension, to selectively expand and contract an implant coupled to the control arm assembly.

[0628] Prior implementations presented in this disclosure provide variations on control arm assembly designs and structures and are intended to be illustrative of a non-limiting range of control arm assemblies within the scope of this disclosure. For example, control arm assembly **3608** of delivery device **3600** (shown in FIGS. **36-44** and **56-59**) provides one example implementation including six control arm pairs, with each pair including a proximal arm coupled to a distal arm coupled by a t-shaped protrusion (e.g., protrusion **3637** as received by aperture **3639**, which is illustrated in FIG. **58**). Control arm assembly **8802** of FIGS. **88A-89** similarly includes six control arm pairs with each pair including a shaped/curved distal arm coupled to a proximal arm (e.g., distal control arm **8810** and proximal control arm **8808**, respectively).

[0629] As previously noted in this disclosure, other implementations may include control arm assemblies having more or fewer control arm pairs than the previously discussed embodiments. For example, FIGS. **91A** and **91B** illustrate an alternative configuration of a delivery device **9100** including a control arm assembly **9102** for selectively expanding and collapsing an implant (not shown). As with previous implementations, control arm assembly **9102** is controllable to expand and contract laterally/radially relative to a delivery catheter **9104**.

[0630] Control arm assembly **9102** of delivery device **9100** is generally consistent with and operates similarly to control arm assembly **8802** of delivery device **8800** with the exception that control arm assembly **9102** includes only three control arm pairs as compared to the six pairs of control arm assembly **8802**. More specifically, FIG. **91A** provides a proximal perspective view of a distal end **9101** of delivery device **9100**. Control arm assembly **9102** generally includes a series of three control arm pairs distributed about an extension member **9106**. As previously discussed, in at least certain implementations, extension member **9106** extends beyond a distal end of delivery catheter **9104** and may be longitudinally translatable to translate an implant coupled to control arm assembly **9102** without expanding or collapsing the implant.

[0631] In the specific example of delivery device **9100**, control arm assembly **9102** includes three control arms pairs (e.g., control arm pair **9103**) distributed at 120-degree offsets; however, other implementations may include more or fewer control arm pairs with different distributions. This disclosure generally includes implementations in which the control arm pairs are distributed evenly about the extension member. Among other things, such a configuration promotes uniform expansion and contraction of the control arm assembly and the implant when coupled to the control arm assembly. Nevertheless, this disclosure contemplates that the control arm pairs of the control arm assembly may be unevenly distributed to accommodate different coupling arrangements with

implants, to facilitate non-uniform expansion and contraction, and to provide other similar features and functionalities.

[0632] FIG. **91B** is a detailed view of control arm pair **9103** and is representative of each control arm pair of delivery device **9100**. As shown, control arm pair **9103** includes a proximal control arm **9108**, coupled to a distal control arm **9110**. In the illustrated example, coupling of proximal control arm **9108** to distal control arm **9110** is based on a T-and-slot type coupling. More specifically, proximal control arm **9108** includes a T- or I-shaped protrusion **9112** that is inserted through a corresponding aperture **9114** of distal control arm **9110** and rotated such that distal control arm **9110** is retained by protrusion **9112**, resulting in a coupling **9116** connecting proximal control arm **9108** and distal control arm **9110** in a hinge-like manner. As in previous implementations, coupling **9116** is disposed at a location distal a proximal end **9118** of distal control arm **9110** such that distal control arm **9110** extends beyond coupling **9116** and forms a cantilevered section **9120**.

[0633] Referring back to FIG. **91A**, each proximal control arm may be coupled to a control shaft **9124** of delivery device **9100**. During operation, control shaft **9124** may be longitudinally translated relative to delivery catheter **9104** to drive the proximal control arms. As discussed previously in this disclosure, longitudinal translation of control shaft **9124** in combination with the structural hinged coupling of the distal and proximal control arms results in selective expansion of control arm assembly **9102**. So, for example, distal translation of control shaft **9124** results in distal and laterally/radially outward translation of the proximal control arms which, in turn, pushes the distal control arms laterally/radially outward. Conversely, proximal translation of control shaft **9124** results in proximal and laterally/radially inward translation of the proximal control arms which, in turn, pulls the distal control arms laterally/radially outward.

[0634] As further illustrated in FIG. **91B**, distal control arm **9110** includes a slot **9117** shaped to receive a corresponding coupling feature of an implant. For example, in certain implementations, slot **9117** is sized and shaped to receive an eyelet, such as eyelet **6802** (discussed above in the context of FIGS. **69B-73B**).

[0635] While previous control arm assemblies of this disclosure included expandable elements having a two-piece construction (i.e., a proximal control arm coupled to a distal control arm via a hinged/movable coupling), control arm assemblies may alternatively have a unitary construction. For example, FIGS. **92A** and **92B** illustrate an alternative implementation of a delivery device **9200** including a control arm assembly **9202** for selectively expanding and collapsing an implant (not shown). As with previous control arm assemblies of this disclosure, control arm assembly **9202** is selectively extendible from a delivery catheter **9204** and selectively expandable to control expansion of an implant coupled to control arm assembly **9202**.

[0636] Control arm assembly **9202** includes three unitary control arms (e.g., control arm **9203**) distributed about an extension member **9206** at approximately 120-degree offsets. As with previous control arm assemblies, the specific arrangement of control arm assembly **9202** is intended to be illustrative only and this disclosure contemplates that other arrangements, including those with more or fewer control arms and differing distributions, are within the scope of this disclosure.

[0637] Control arm **9203** (which is generally illustrative of the other control arms of control arm assembly **9202**) includes a proximal arm segment **9208** joined to a distal arm segment **9210** at a flexure **9216**. Proximal arm segment **9208** extends in a radially inward and proximal direction from flexure **9216** and into delivery catheter **9204**. Distal arm segment **9210** extends radially inward and distally from flexure **9216** and is coupled to a distal cap **9238** of extension member **9206**.

[0638] As with previous control arm assemblies, proximal arm segment **9208** extends proximally within delivery catheter **9204** and is coupled to a control shaft **9224** configured to longitudinally translate within delivery catheter **9204**. Longitudinal translation of the control shaft results in proximal arm segment **9208** results in corresponding expansion or collapse of control arm assembly **9202**.

[0639] More specifically, as the control shaft is extended distally, proximal arm segment **9208** is

pushed out of delivery catheter **9204** in a distal and radially outward direction. Due to flexure **9216**, such movement of proximal arm segment **9208** simultaneously causes radial extension of distal arm segment **9210**, resulting, e.g., in the expanded configuration shown in FIG. **92A**. In contrast, as the control shaft is extended proximally, proximal arm segment **9208** is pulled into delivery catheter **9204** in a proximal and radially inward direction. As proximal arm segment **9208** is pulled into delivery catheter **9204** and due to flexure **9216**, distal arm segment **9210** moves radially inward and flattens against extension member **9206**. Accordingly, by translating the control shaft, expansion and collapse of control arm assembly **9202** can be selectively controlled.

[0640] The specific construction and configuration of unitary control arms, such as control arm **9203**, may vary to accommodate different implants, different degrees and/or directions of expansion and contraction, and other similar parameters. However, in at least certain implementations, control arm **9203** may be formed from a shape settable and biocompatible material such as, but not limited to, nitinol. When such a material is used, control arm **9203** may be set into an expanded shape (which may be a fully expanded shape or a partially expanded shape) such that control arm **9203** is biased toward expansion.

[0641] Referring again to FIG. **92A**, distal arm segment **9210** may be configured to have a distally convex curvature. Among other benefits, such curvature may provide additional clearance between distal arm segment **9210** and an implant coupled to control arm assembly **9202**, facilitate force transfer between proximal arm segment **9208** and distal arm segment **9210** during expansion/contraction, and prevent distal buckling of distal arm segment **9210**.

[0642] FIG. **92B** is a detailed view of control arm **9203** in the area of flexure **9216**. As shown, distal arm segment **9210** may include a slot **9217** or similar coupling feature for securing an implant to control arm assembly **9202**. For example, slot **9217** may be configured to receive an eyelet (e.g., eyelet **6802**, shown in FIG. **73A**) of an implant.

[0643] FIGS. **93A-93D** illustrate yet another example of a delivery device **9300** including a control arm assembly **9302** for selectively expanding and collapsing an implant (not shown). Specifically, FIG. **93A** is a proximal perspective view of delivery device **9300**, FIG. **93B** is a detailed view of a control arm **9303** of control arm assembly **9302**, and FIGS. **93C** and **93D** are proximal and distal view of control arm assembly **9302**, respectively.

[0644] As with previous control arm assemblies of this disclosure, control arm assembly **9302** is selectively extendible from a delivery catheter **9304** and selectively expandable to control expansion of an implant coupled to control arm assembly **9302**. In the illustrated implementation, control arm assembly **9302** includes three control arms (e.g., control arm **9303**) distributed about an extension member **9306** at approximately 120-degree offsets, although this disclosure contemplates alternatives including more or fewer control arms and differing distributions of those control arms.

[0645] Control arm **9303** (which is generally illustrative of the other control arms of control arm assembly **9302**) includes a proximal arm segment **9308** joined to a distal arm segment **9310** at a flexure **9316**. When control arm assembly **9302** is in an expanded configuration, proximal arm segment **9308** extends in a radially inward and proximal direction from flexure **9316** and into delivery catheter **9304** while distal arm segment **9310** extends radially inward and distally from flexure **9316**.

[0646] Distal arm segment **9310** is coupled to a distal cap **9338** of extension member **9306**.

[0647] While the functionality of control arm assembly **9302** is similar to that of control arm assembly **9202** and other control arm assemblies provided in this disclosure, control arm assembly **9302** differs in that the control arms of control arm assembly **9302** have a wire-based construction. Referring to control arm **9303** as shown in FIG. **93B**, for example, a primary wire **9305** is continuous and forms each of proximal arm segment **9308**, flexure **9316**, and a portion of distal arm segment **9310**. Distal arm segment **9310** further includes a support wire **9307** extending along the portion of primary wire **9305** of distal arm segment **9310** to provide additional structural support.

[0648] The specific construction and configuration of wire-based control arms, such as control arm **9203**, may vary to accommodate different implants, different degrees and/or directions of expansion and contraction, and other similar parameters. However, in at least certain implementations, control arm **9303** may be formed from a wire of a shape settable and biocompatible material such as, but not limited to, nitinol. When such a material is used, control arm **9303** may be set into an expanded shape (which may be a fully expanded shape or a partially expanded shape) such that control arm **9303** is biased toward expansion.

[0649] As with previous control arm assemblies, control arm assembly **9302** may be selectively coupled to an implant and may include various structural elements to facilitate such coupling. For example, as shown in FIG. **93B**, control arm **9303** includes an end feature **9309** positioned at an extend of distal arm segment **9310** such that end feature **9309** extends beyond flexure **9316** when control arm assembly **9302** is in an expanded state. In the illustrated implementation, end feature **9309** includes a slot **9317** shaped to receive an eyelet (e.g., eyelet **6802**, shown in FIG. **73A**) of an implant; however, this disclosure contemplates that other designs for end feature **9309** may be used to accommodate different implants and/or different implant coupling arrangements.

[0650] As previously noted, distal arm segment **9310** includes each of a portion of primary wire **9305** and support wire **9307**, the latter providing additional structural integrity to distal arm segment **9310**. In control arms including a primary wire and a support wire, the primary wire and the support wire may be coupled in various ways. In the illustrated example, support wire **9307** is coupled to the portion of primary wire **9305** included in distal arm segment **9310** by end feature **9309**. Specifically, end feature **9309** is crimped around each of primary wire **9305** and support wire **9307**, thereby securing primary wire **9305** to support wire **9307**. In other implementations, end feature **9309** may be bonded, fused, welded, or otherwise joined to each of primary wire **9305** and support wire **9307**. Alternatively, or in addition to being joined by end feature **9309**, primary wire **9305** and support wire **9307** may be bonded, fused, welded, or otherwise joined to each other at one or more locations along their lengths.

XXVIII. IMPLANT OCCLUDER AS NOSECONE

[0651] Transcatheter valve replacement procedures generally include inserting a catheter-based delivery device through the vascular system to an implantation location within the heart. Conventional transcatheter delivery devices often include various features to facilitate insertion while minimizing trauma to physiological structures. For example, catheter bodies may be sheathed with a low friction material or coated with a lubricious coating to minimize friction between the delivery device and the walls of the physiological lumen through which the delivery device is inserted.

[0652] Delivery devices may also include a nosecone or other distal tip element to expand the physiological lumen and permit passage of the catheter body. In general, nosecones are designed with a tapered, atraumatic shape and cap the catheter body during insertion of the delivery device.

[0653] While nosecones can be beneficial during insertion of the delivery device, they can add substantial complication the implantation process once the delivery device is in position for actual implantation. Moreover, the nosecone is generally needed for insertion only and becomes redundant following implantation.

[0654] By way of example, certain delivery devices include fixed nosecones that remain in place during implant deployment. As a result, the implant must be deployed around or through the nosecone, complicating and limiting the design of the implant and the deployment process. While certain alternative delivery devices include a removable nosecone to permit distal deployment, such devices similarly suffer from complicated device designs and deployment processes. For example, such devices need to account for removing the nosecone, retaining the nosecone to avoid the nosecone becoming embolic, and controlling the nosecone during removal of the delivery device.

[0655] To address the foregoing issues and to provide other advantages, implant delivery systems according to this disclosure may be configured to maintain the implant in a distal location such that

the implant functions as a nosecone during insertion of the delivery device. More specifically, during insertion, the implant is disposed at a distal end of a delivery catheter and sheathed. In this configuration, a central occluder of the implant projects distally from the sheath, providing a temporary nosecone for the delivery device. A clinician may then insert the delivery device into the patient and navigate to the implantation location with the benefit of the occluder acting as a nosecone. After reaching the implantation site, the clinician can retract the sheath to expose the implant for subsequent implantation. As described throughout this disclosure, the implantation may include various additional steps including, but not limited to, aligning the implant (e.g., using one or more steering mechanisms of the delivery device), selectively expanding/collapsing the implant, (e.g., using a control arm assembly of the delivery device), longitudinally translating the implant relative to the delivery catheter (e.g., using an extension member of the delivery device), and releasing the implant.

[0656] Notably, while the implant occluder provides a nosecone during insertion of the delivery device, deployment of the implant effectively removes the nosecone from the delivery system. As a result, delivery systems according to this disclosure provide the benefit of nosecones during delivery device insertion and location without the downsides of conventional nosecone designs pertaining to implant deployment and delivery device withdrawal (e.g., deploying around or through the nosecone or supporting removal and retention of the nosecone during deployment and withdrawal).

[0657] The foregoing and other aspects of this disclosure related to an implant providing a temporary delivery device nosecone are provided below with reference to the figures.

[0658] FIG. 50 illustrates delivery device 3600 including a sheath 3616 disposed over a delivery catheter 3604 and an implant 3800, as would be configured prior to insertion of delivery device 3600 into a patient. To achieve the configuration shown in FIG. 50, the implant is first coupled to a distal end of the delivery device. For example, the implant may be coupled to a control arm assembly of the delivery device configured to facilitate selective expansion and collapse of the implant, as discussed in previous sections of this disclosure. Once coupled to the control arm assembly, the implant is collapsed/compressed and a sheath (e.g., sheath 3616) is slid over a proximal portion of the implant, thereby maintaining the implant in a compressed state within the sheath.

[0659] FIG. 94A is a partial sectional view of a distal portion of an implant delivery system 9400, with implant delivery system 9400. FIG. 94A illustrates implant delivery system 9400 in a state generally corresponding to that of delivery device 3600 shown in FIG. 50, i.e., with an implant 9450 loaded and prepared for delivery. Implant 9450 includes a central occluder 9452 from which a frame 9454 extends proximally. Implant 9450 is shown in a simplified form for clarity and, as a result, omits certain elements of implants according to this disclosure. Accordingly, implant 9450 may generally correspond to any implant described herein or otherwise within the scope of this disclosure. For example, while implant 9450 is shown in FIGS. 94A-94C as including a fabric-style occluder, implants with other shapes and styles of occluders, such as the “bullnose” style occluder 50 of implant 20, shown in FIG. 2, may also be used and similarly provide a temporary nosecone during delivery of the implant.

[0660] During preoperative preparation of implant delivery system 9400, implant 9450 is first coupled to a control arm assembly 9402, which is supported by an extension member 9404 that extends distally from a delivery catheter 9406. Implant 9450 is then collapsed/compressed and a sheath 9408 is extended over implant 9450, thereby retaining implant 9450 in its compressed state for delivery.

[0661] As described throughout this disclosure, delivery catheter 9406 in combination with control arm assembly 9402, extension member 9404, and other components of implant delivery system 9400 may be configured to perform various functions including, but not limited to, steering one or more sections of delivery catheter 9406, longitudinally extending or retracting extension member

9404, selectively expanding/collapsing control arm assembly **9402**, and retracting sheath **9408**.

[0662] Notably, in the configuration shown in FIG. **94A** (and consistent with the configuration of delivery device **3600** shown in FIG. **50**), central occluder **9452** projects distally from sheath **9408**. As a result, central occluder **9452** forms a nosecone of implant delivery system **9400** to facilitate delivery of the implant delivery system **9400** to an implantation site (e.g., as indicated by arrow **9410**, indicating a distal insertion direction).

[0663] FIG. **94B** illustrates implant delivery system **9400** in a subsequent stage of an example implantation procedure. Specifically, FIG. **94B** illustrates implant delivery system **9400** in a state following location of implant delivery system **9400** at an implantation site and after proximal retraction of sheath **9408**. As shown, retraction of sheath **9408** generally includes proximally translating sheath **9408** (e.g., in the direction of arrow **9412**), while maintaining control arm assembly **9402** in a substantially static position.

[0664] As shown in FIG. **94B**, implant **9450** may at least partially expand once sheath **9408** clears a proximal extent of implant **9450**. For example, implant **9450** may be configured to be biased into an expanded state and may be compressed when disposed within sheath **9408**. Accordingly, once implant **9450** is no longer constrained by sheath **9408**, implant **9450** may be free to expand. In certain implementations, expansion of implant **9450** following retraction of sheath **9408** may be limited, at least in part, by control arm assembly **9402** or a similar mechanism (e.g., the tether-based system of FIGS. **13-22**) of the delivery device for selective and controlled expansion and collapse of implant **9450**.

[0665] During insertion of implant delivery system **9400**, implant delivery system **9400** is generally in the state shown in FIG. **94A** with central occluder **9452** of implant **9450** protruding from sheath **9408**. In this configuration, central occluder **9452** functions as a nosecone or similar atraumatic tip of implant delivery system **9400** to facilitate guidance and expansion of a physiological lumen through which implant delivery system **9400** is delivered. However, because central occluder **9452** is a component of implant **9450**, deploying implant **9450** from sheath **9408** (e.g., as shown in FIG. **94B**) effectively eliminates/removes the nosecone structure from implant delivery system **9400**. As result, transitioning central occluder **9452** from an initial use as a nosecone to its final use as a valve leaflet occluder obviates various issues in conventional nosecone designs discussed above (e.g., having to deploy around or through a fixed nosecone, having to remove and retain a removable nosecone, etc.).

[0666] Referring next to FIG. **94C**, following clearance of sheath **9408**, implant **9450** may be fully deployed, e.g., by actuating control arm assembly **9402** to expand implant **9450** into an expanded state suitable for implantation.

[0667] In general, the overall distance between distal and proximal extents of implant **9450** varies as implant **9450** expands and collapses. In most implementations, the distance will be a maximum when implant **9450** is fully collapsed and a minimum when implant **9450** is fully expanded. As a result, the extent to which control arm assembly **9402**, extension member **9404**, and implant **9450** extend past sheath **9408** and delivery catheter **9406** is generally the greatest during initial deployment of implant **9450** (e.g., during the transition between the state illustrated in FIG. **94A** through the state illustrated in FIG. **94C**) but can be subsequently and optionally reduced once implant **9450** has been expanded. Among other advantages, reducing the extent to which implant **9450** extends relative to delivery catheter **9406** extends the workspace of implant delivery system **9400** by reducing the overall length of a steerable distal section of implant delivery system **9400**.

[0668] As previously discussed in this disclosure, certain implementations may include a control shaft **9414** coupled to extension member **9404** to facilitate translation of control arm assembly **9402**, extension member **9404**, and implant **9450**, relative to delivery catheter **9406** and sheath **9408**. More specifically, control shaft **9414** extends through and is longitudinally translatable relative to delivery catheter **9406**. Control shaft **9414** is further coupled to extension member **9404** such that as control shaft **9414** is translated relative to delivery catheter **9406**, extension member

9404, control arm assembly **9402** (which is coupled to extension member **9404**), and implant **9450** (which is supported on control arm assembly **9402**), may be similarly translated.

[0669] With the foregoing in mind, FIG. **94D** illustrates implant delivery system **9400** with implant **9450** in an optionally retracted position in preparation for final implantation. While not specifically illustrated in FIG. **94A** to **94E**, final implantation of implant **9450** may include aligning implant **9450** relative to the valve annulus and translating implant **9450** such that engagement features (not shown) of implant **9450** engage tissue around the valve annulus and central occluder **9452** is positioned to interact with the native valve leaflets. These steps may include manipulating various elements of implant delivery system **9400** and implant **9450** including, but not limited to, steering delivery catheter **9406**, inserting/withdrawing delivery catheter **9406** and/or implant delivery system **9400** more generally, extending or retracting extension member **9404**, expanding or collapsing control arm assembly **9402** (to expand/collapse implant **9450**), and otherwise manipulating implant delivery system **9400** to properly place implant **9450**. Once implant **9450** is placed, control arm assembly **9402** can be disengaged from implant **9450** (e.g., as described in FIG. **83A-83H**).

[0670] Following implantation of implant **9450** and disengagement of implant **9450** from control arm assembly **9402**, implant delivery system **9400** may be removed from the patient. In at least certain implementations, removal of implant delivery system **9400** may include re-sheathing at least a portion of the distal assemblies of implant delivery system **9400**. As shown in FIG. **94E**, for example, the distal assemblies of implant delivery system **9400** may be re-sheathed for extraction of implant delivery system **9400**. As shown in FIG. **94E**, for example, extension member **9404** and control arm assembly **9402** may be re-sheathed by one or both of retraction into delivery catheter **9406** and distal extension of sheath **9408**.

XXIX. ILLUSTRATIVE ASPECTS OF THE PRESENT DISCLOSURE

[0671] Illustrative examples of the disclosure include, but are not limited to the following:

[0672] Aspect 1-1. A delivery tool for an implantable medical device including a handle body; a threaded shaft extending within the handle body; a shuttle threadedly engaged with the threaded shaft and configured to translate along the threaded shaft in response to rotation of the threaded shaft; a gear assembly drivable by rotating the threaded shaft; a spool coupled to the gear assembly such that the spool is rotatable in response to rotation of the threaded shaft and simultaneously with translation of the shuttle; a control arm shaft coupled to the shuttle and extending distally from the handle body, the control arm shaft translatable by translating the shuttle; and a control arm assembly coupled to a distal end of the control arm shaft, wherein the control arm assembly is laterally expandable in response to translation of the control arm shaft.

[0673] Aspect 1-2. The delivery tool of Aspect 1-1 further including an extension member extending distally relative to the distal end of the control arm shaft, wherein the control arm assembly further includes: a proximal control arm coupled to a distal end of the control arm assembly; and a distal control arm, wherein: a proximal end of the distal control arm is coupled to the proximal control arm at a coupling location, and a distal end of the distal control arm is coupled to a distal end of the extension member.

[0674] Aspect 1-3. The delivery tool of Aspect 1-1 further including at least one cinch line coupled to the spool and extending distally from the handle body such that rotation of the spool results in a change in length of the cinch line extending from the spool.

[0675] Aspect 1-4. The delivery tool of Aspect 1-1 further including a plurality of cinch lines coupled to the spool and extending distally from the handle body such that rotation of the spool results in a simultaneously change in length of each of the plurality of cinch lines extending from the spool.

[0676] Aspect 1-5. The delivery tool of Aspect 1-1, wherein the gear assembly includes a worm gear coupled to the threaded shaft and a worm wheel engaged with the worm gear and coupled to the spool.

[0677] Aspect 1-6. The delivery tool of Aspect 1-1 further including a user input actuatable to rotate the threaded shaft.

[0678] Aspect 1-7. The delivery tool of Aspect 1-6, wherein the user input is a knob coupled to a proximal end of the threaded shaft.

[0679] Aspect 1-8. The delivery tool of Aspect 1-1, wherein the threaded shaft is a first threaded shaft and the delivery tool further includes a second threaded shaft configured to simultaneously translate each of the gear assembly, the shuttle, and the threaded shaft.

[0680] Aspect 1-9. The delivery tool of Aspect 1-8 further including a gear assembly shuttle coupled to the gear assembly and threadedly engaged with the second threaded shaft, the gear assembly shuttle configured to move along the second threaded shaft in response to rotation of the second threaded shaft.

[0681] Aspect 1-10. The delivery tool of Aspect 1-8 further including a first user input actuatable to rotate the first threaded shaft and a second user input actuatable to rotate the second threaded shaft.

[0682] Aspect 1-11. The delivery tool of Aspect 1-8, wherein the first user input is a first knob coupled to a proximal end of the first threaded shaft and the second user input is a second knob coupled to a proximal end of the second threaded shaft.

[0683] Aspect 2-1. A delivery tool for an implantable medical device including: a handle body; a threaded shaft extending within the handle body; a shuttle threadedly engaged with the threaded shaft and configured to translate along the threaded shaft in response to rotation of the threaded shaft; an extension shaft coupled to the shuttle and extending distally from the handle body, the extension shaft translatable by translating the shuttle; and a control arm assembly coupled to a distal end of the control arm shaft, wherein the control arm assembly is longitudinally translatable in response to translation of the extension shaft and laterally expandable independent of being longitudinally translated by the extension shaft.

[0684] Aspect 2-2. The delivery tool of Aspect 2-1 further including an extension member coupled to and extending distally from the extension shaft.

[0685] Aspect 2-3. The delivery tool of Aspect 2-2, wherein the control arm assembly further includes each of a proximal control arm and a distal control arm, wherein: a proximal end of the distal control arm is coupled to the proximal control arm at a coupling location, and the proximal control arm is drivable to laterally translate the coupling location, thereby selectively expanding the control arm assembly.

[0686] Aspect 2-4. The delivery tool of Aspect 2-1 further including an expansion assembly configured to drive expansion and collapse of the control arm assembly independent of longitudinally translating the control arm assembly.

[0687] Aspect 2-5. The delivery tool of Aspect 2-4, wherein longitudinally translating the control arm assembly further longitudinally translates the expansion assembly.

[0688] Aspect 3-1. A delivery tool for an implantable medical device including: a handle body; a frame element supported by the handle body, the frame element defining an aperture and having a longitudinal axis extending through the aperture; a control ring defining a ring orifice and supported by the frame element, wherein the control ring is rotatable about the longitudinal axis and includes a line coupling location; and a protrusion extending into the ring orifice at a radial offset from the longitudinal axis, wherein the protrusion is configured to interfere with a control line extending from the aperture to the line coupling location following a rotation of the control ring.

[0689] Aspect 3-2. The delivery tool of Aspect 3-1 further including a lock configured to selectively prevent rotation of the control ring relative to the frame element.

[0690] Aspect 3-3. The delivery tool of Aspect 3-1, wherein: the line coupling location is a first line coupling location, the control ring includes a second release line coupling location angularly offset from the first release line coupling location; and the protrusion is further configured to interfere with a second control line extending from the aperture to the second line coupling location in

response to a further rotation of the control ring.

[0691] Aspect 3-4. The delivery tool of Aspect 3-3 further including the first control line and a retention element, wherein the first control line is coupled to the retention element such that interference of the first control line with the protrusion results in proximal retraction of the retention element.

[0692] Aspect 3-5. The delivery tool of Aspect 3-4 further including a cinch line, wherein the retention element is configured to retain a distal end of the cinch line prior to proximal retraction of the retention element and to release the distal end of the cinch line when retracted.

[0693] Aspect 3-6. The delivery tool of Aspect 3-5, wherein the cinch line is one of a plurality of cinch lines and the retention element is configured to retain each of the plurality of cinch lines prior to proximal retraction of the retention element and to release each of the plurality of cinch lines when retracted.

[0694] Aspect 3-7. The delivery tool of Aspect 3-3 further including the second control line and a cinch line, wherein the second control line is configured such that interference of the second release line with the protrusion results in proximal retraction of the cinch line.

[0695] Aspect 3-8. The delivery tool of Aspect 3-7, wherein the cinch line is configured to be routed about a portion of the implantable medical device to distribute forces about the implantable medical device during at least one of expansion and contraction of the implantable medical device.

[0696] Aspect 3-9. The delivery tool of Aspect 3-3 further including the second release line and a plurality of cinch lines, wherein the second release line is configured to proximally retract each cinch line of the plurality of cinch lines.

[0697] Aspect 3-10. The delivery tool of Aspect 3-9, wherein: a proximal end of each cinch line of the plurality of cinch lines is anchored within the handle body, the second release line forms a loop within the handle body, and each cinch line of the plurality of cinch lines extends through the loop such that retraction of the second release line proximally retracts each of the plurality of cinch lines.

[0698] Aspect 4-1. A delivery tool for an implantable medical device including: a handle body; a tubular body extending distally from the handle body; and a control arm assembly coupled to a distal end of the tubular body, wherein: the control arm assembly is selectively expandable in a lateral direction, and the tubular body includes a proximal steerable section and a distal steerable section, the proximal steerable section being independently steerable from the distal steerable section.

[0699] Aspect 4-2. The delivery tool of Aspect 4-1, wherein the distal steerable section is steerable along a first plane and the proximal steerable section is steerable along each of the first plane and a second plane orthogonal to the first plane.

[0700] Aspect 4-3. The delivery tool of Aspect 4-1 further including an extension tube disposed within the tubular body and configured to longitudinally translate independent of the tubular body to selectively extend the control arm assembly relative to the tubular body, wherein the extension tube includes an extension tube section having modified flexibility with respect to bending along a steering plane of the tubular body.

[0701] Aspect 4-4. The delivery tool of Aspect 4-3, wherein the extension tube section includes a plurality of longitudinal cuts extending along the extension tube section and perpendicular to the steering plane.

[0702] Aspect 4-5. The delivery tool of Aspect 4-3, wherein the extension tube section includes a helical cut extending along the extension tube section.

[0703] Aspect 4-6. The delivery tool of Aspect 4-1 further including an extension tube disposed within the tubular body and configured to longitudinally translate independent of the tubular body to selectively extend the control arm assembly relative to the tubular body, wherein: the distal steerable section is steerable along a first plane, the proximal steerable section is steerable along each of the first plane and a second plane orthogonal to the first plane, the extension tube includes a

distal extension tube section having modified flexibility with respect to bending along the first plane, the extension tube includes a proximal extension tube section having modified flexibility with respect to bending along each of the first plane and the second plane.

[0704] Aspect 4-7. The delivery tool of Aspect 4-6, wherein the distal extension tube section includes a plurality of longitudinal cuts extending along the distal extension tube section and perpendicular to the first plane.

[0705] Aspect 4-8. The delivery tool of Aspect 4-6, wherein the proximal extension tube section includes a helical cut extending along the extension tube section.

[0706] Aspect 4-9. The delivery tool of Aspect 4-3, wherein the extension tube is formed from nitinol.

[0707] Aspect 5-1. A cardiac valve repair implant including: a central occluder; a frame extending about a central longitudinal axis from the central occluder and self-biasing from a collapsed state to an expanded state, the frame including: an inner frame portion supporting the central occluder; a plurality of spokes extending proximally from the central portion and forming a circumference about the central longitudinal axis; and expandable outer cells disposed between adjacent spokes of the plurality of spokes; and an outer sheet supported on a proximal portion of the frame and extending circumferentially about the proximal portion of the frame, wherein when the frame is in the expanded state, the outer sheet and the central occluder define an annulus between the outer sheet and the central occluder centered about the central longitudinal axis.

[0708] Aspect 5-2. The cardiac valve repair implant of Aspect 5-1, wherein the outer sheet is formed from a knit polyethylene terephthalate material.

[0709] Aspect 5-3. The cardiac valve repair implant of Aspect 5-1, wherein a distal edge of the outer sheet is circular about the central longitudinal axis.

[0710] Aspect 5-4. The cardiac valve repair implant of Aspect 5-1, wherein a proximal edge of the outer sheet is sinusoidal.

[0711] Aspect 5-5. The cardiac valve repair implant of Aspect 5-1, wherein a proximal edge of the outer sheet varies between a first proximal extent and a second proximal extent different than the first proximal extent.

[0712] Aspect 5-6. The cardiac valve repair implant of Aspect 5-1, wherein the outer sheet is coupled to the frame by one or more hems.

[0713] Aspect 5-7. The cardiac valve repair implant of Aspect 5-6, wherein the outer sheet is coupled to the frame by a first hem extending along a proximal edge of the frame and a second hem extending about a proximal edge of the annulus.

[0714] Aspect 5-8. The cardiac valve repair implant of Aspect 5-1, wherein each of the expandable outer cells includes a proximal tip and a distal tip and wherein a suture is wrapped about at least one of the proximal tip and the distal tip.

[0715] Aspect 6-1. A cardiac valve repair implant including: a central occluder including a central longitudinal axis; a frame extending from the central occluder, the frame including a central portion supporting the central occluder and a plurality of spokes extending from the central portion and distributed circumferentially about the central longitudinal axis; an outer sheet supported on a proximal portion of the frame and extending circumferentially about the proximal portion of the frame; and a plurality of eyelets distributed circumferentially about the central longitudinal axis, each eyelet of the plurality of eyelets coupled to and extending from a respective spoke of the plurality of spokes.

[0716] Aspect 6-2. The cardiac valve repair implant of Aspect 6-1, wherein the outer sheet is retained on an outer side of the frame and the plurality of eyelets extend opposite the outer sheet.

[0717] Aspect 6-3. The cardiac valve repair implant of Aspect 6-1, wherein a spoke of the plurality of spokes defines a slot through which an eyelet of the plurality of eyelets extends.

[0718] Aspect 6-4. The cardiac valve repair implant of Aspect 6-3, wherein: the eyelet includes a body portion defining a through hole and a shank portion coupled to the body portion, the shank

portion has a width greater than the body portion, and the eyelet is received by the slot such that the body portion extends through the slot to a first side of the spoke and the shank is retained on a second side of the spoke opposite the first side.

[0719] Aspect 6-5. The cardiac valve repair implant of Aspect 6-3, wherein the eyelet defines a retention hole and the eyelet is coupled to the frame by a suture loop extending through the retention hole and around the frame.

[0720] Aspect 6-6. The cardiac valve repair implant of Aspect 6-1, wherein each of eyelets includes a radiused through hole.

[0721] Aspect 7-1. A cardiac valve repair implant comprises: a central occluder including a central longitudinal axis; a frame extending proximally from the central occluder, the frame centered about and forming a circumference around the central longitudinal axis of the central occluder and self-biasing from a collapsed state to an expanded state; and an outer sheet supported on a proximal portion of the frame, wherein when the frame is in the expanded state, the outer sheet forms an annular surface defining an inner circular opening centered about the central longitudinal axis of the central occluder, wherein: the frame including an inner portion coupled to and supporting the central occluder, and the central occluder has a laminated construction including a first sheet disposed on a distal side of the inner frame portion coupled to a second sheet disposed on a proximal side of the inner frame portion.

[0722] Aspect 7-2. The cardiac valve repair implant of Aspect 7-1 wherein the central occluder has a distally concave shape.

[0723] Aspect 7-3. The cardiac valve repair implant of Aspect 7-1, wherein the first sheet is formed from a substantially impermeable material.

[0724] Aspect 7-4. The cardiac valve repair implant of Aspect 7-3, wherein the second sheet is formed from a permeable material.

[0725] Aspect 7-5. The cardiac valve repair implant of Aspect 7-4, wherein the second sheet is bonded to the first sheet by a liquid bonding material applied to the second sheet.

[0726] Aspect 7-6. The cardiac valve repair implant of Aspect 7-1, wherein the first sheet is formed from expanded polytetrafluoroethylene (ePTFE).

[0727] Aspect 7-7. The cardiac valve repair implant of Aspect 7-1, wherein the second sheet is formed from a fabric.

[0728] Aspect 7-8. The cardiac valve repair implant of Aspect 7-7, wherein the fabric including woven polyethylene terephthalate (PET).

[0729] Aspect 7-9. The cardiac valve repair implant of Aspect 7-1, wherein the first sheet is coupled to the second sheet using a polyurethane compound.

[0730] Aspect 7-10. The cardiac valve repair implant of Aspect 7-9, wherein the polyurethane compound including a siloxane segmented polyurethane and a polymer precursor.

[0731] Aspect 7-11. The cardiac valve repair implant of Aspect 7-10, wherein the polymer precursor is such as tetrahydrofuran (THF).

[0732] Aspect 7-12. The cardiac valve repair implant of Aspect 7-1, wherein the central occluder further comprises a proximal cap.

[0733] Aspect 7-13. The cardiac valve repair implant of Aspect 7-12, wherein the proximal cap including a frame element and a proximal sheet coupled to the frame element.

[0734] Aspect 7-14. The cardiac valve repair implant of Aspect 7-13, wherein the proximal sheet is formed from a porous material.

[0735] Aspect 7-15. The cardiac valve repair implant of Aspect 7-12, wherein the proximal cap has a distally convex shape.

[0736] Aspect 7-16. The cardiac valve repair implant of Aspect 7-12, wherein the proximal cap and the second sheet define an internal volume of the central occluder.

[0737] Aspect 7-17. The cardiac valve repair implant of Aspect 7-16, wherein the internal volume is filled with a solid or expandable material.

[0738] Aspect 7-18. The cardiac valve repair implant of Aspect 7-12, wherein the proximal cap is coupled to at least one of the first sheet and the second sheet by a suture extending around the circumference of the central occluder.

[0739] Aspect 8-1. A delivery device for cardiac valve repair implants, the delivery device including a delivery catheter; an extension member protruding from a distal end of the delivery catheter; and a control arm assembly releasably coupleable to a valve repair implant, the control arm assembly including a plurality of control arms distributed about the extension member, wherein: each control arm of the plurality of control arms includes a distal control arm portion coupled to and extending proximally from a distal end of the extension member and a proximal control arm portion coupled to a proximal portion of the distal control arm, the proximal control arm portion is extendable from the distal end of the delivery catheter by pushing the proximal control arm, and the control arm assembly is configured to laterally expand in response to extending the proximal control arm.

[0740] Aspect 8-2: The delivery device of Aspect 8-1, wherein the plurality of control arms is distributed evenly about the extension member.

[0741] Aspect 8-3: The delivery device of Aspect 8-1, wherein the plurality of control arms consists of three control arms.

[0742] Aspect 8-4: The delivery device of Aspect 8-1, wherein the plurality of control arms consists of six control arms.

[0743] Aspect 8-5: The delivery device of Aspect 8-1, wherein the proximal control arm portion is integrally formed with the distal control arm portion.

[0744] Aspect 8-6: The delivery device of Aspect 8-1, wherein the proximal control arm portion includes a coupling feature to couple the control arm to the valve repair implant.

[0745] Aspect 8-7: The delivery device of Aspect 8-6, wherein the coupling feature is a slot configured to receive an eyelet of the valve repair implant.

[0746] Aspect 8-8: The delivery device of Aspect 8-1, wherein the distal control arm portion and the proximal control arm portion are separately formed.

[0747] Aspect 8-9: The delivery device of Aspect 8-8, wherein the distal control arm portion defines a coupling slot and the proximal control arm portion includes a protrusion shaped to be received and retained by the coupling slot, thereby coupling the distal control arm portion to the proximal control arm portion.

[0748] Aspect 8-10: The delivery device of Aspect 8-1, wherein each control arm is formed from a shape-settable material.

[0749] Aspect 8-11: The delivery device of Aspect 8-1, wherein each control arm is formed from nitinol.

[0750] Aspect 8-12: The delivery device of Aspect 8-1, wherein the proximal control arm portion is integrally formed with the distal control arm portion from a shaped wire.

[0751] Aspect 8-13: The delivery device of Aspect 8-12 further including a support wire extending adjacent the distal control arm portion.

[0752] Aspect 8-14: The delivery device of Aspect 8-1 further including an end feature coupled to an end of the distal control arm portion.

[0753] Aspect 8-15: The delivery device of Aspect 8-14 further including a support wire extending adjacent the distal control arm portion, wherein the end feature is further coupled to the support wire.

[0754] Aspect 8-16: The delivery device of aspect 8-14, wherein the end feature includes a coupling feature to couple the control arm to the valve repair implant.

[0755] Aspect 8-17: The delivery device of aspect 8-16, wherein the coupling feature is a slot configured to receive an eyelet of the valve repair implant.

XXX. CONCLUSION

[0756] While the present disclosure has been described with reference to various implementations,

it will be understood that these implementations are illustrative and that the scope of the present disclosure is not limited to them. Many variations, modifications, additions, and improvements are possible. More generally, embodiments in accordance with the present disclosure have been described in the context of particular implementations. Functionality may be separated or combined in blocks differently in various embodiments of the disclosure or described with different terminology. These and other variations, modifications, additions, and improvements may fall within the scope of the disclosure as defined in the claims that follow.

[0757] In general, while the embodiments described herein have been described with reference to particular embodiments, modifications can be made thereto without departing from the spirit and scope of the disclosure. Note also that the term “including” as used herein is intended to be inclusive, i.e. “including but not limited to.”

[0758] The construction and arrangement of the systems and methods as shown in the various exemplary embodiments are illustrative only. Although only a few embodiments have been described in detail in this disclosure, many modifications are possible (e.g., variations in sizes, dimensions, structures, shapes and proportions of the various elements, values of parameters, mounting arrangements, use of materials, colors, orientations, etc.). For example, the position of elements may be reversed or otherwise varied and the nature or number of discrete elements or positions may be altered or varied. Accordingly, all such modifications are intended to be included within the scope of the present disclosure. The order or sequence of any process or method steps may be varied or re-sequenced according to alternative embodiments. Other substitutions, modifications, changes, and omissions may be made in the design, operating conditions and arrangement of the exemplary embodiments without departing from the scope of the present disclosure.

Claims

1. A delivery device for cardiac valve repair implants, the delivery device comprising: a delivery catheter; a sheath extending around the delivery catheter and including a distal opening; and a control arm assembly releasably coupleable to a cardiac valve repair implant and configured to selectively expand a frame of the cardiac valve repair implant, wherein: the sheath is translatable relative to the delivery catheter and control arm assembly from a distal position to a proximal position, and the control arm assembly is configured to be coupled to the cardiac valve repair implant such that, with the sheath in the distal position, a central occluder of the cardiac valve repair implant protrudes from the distal opening and a frame of the cardiac valve repair implant is retained within the sheath.
2. The delivery device of claim 1, wherein, the control arm assembly is further configured such that, with the sheath in the proximal position and the cardiac valve repair implant coupled to the control arm assembly, the frame is distal the distal opening of the sheath.
3. The delivery device of claim 1, wherein the sheath is further translatable from the proximal position to the distal position.
4. The delivery device of claim 1, the control arm assembly is translatable relative to the delivery catheter.
5. The delivery device of claim 1, the control arm assembly is selectively expandable between a collapsed state and an expanded state.
6. The delivery device of claim 1, further comprising an extension member protruding from a distal end of the delivery catheter, wherein: the control arm assembly includes a control arm including a distal control arm portion coupled to and extending proximally from a distal end of the extension member and a proximal control arm portion coupled to a proximal portion of the distal control arm portion, the proximal control arm portion is extendable from the distal end of the delivery catheter by pushing the proximal control arm portion, and the control arm assembly is configured to expand

in response to extending the proximal control arm portion.

7. The delivery device of claim 1, wherein the delivery catheter includes a proximal steerable portion and a distal steerable portion.

8. The delivery device of claim 7, wherein the distal steerable portion is steerable along a first plane and the proximal steerable portion is steerable along each of the first plane and a second plane orthogonal to the first plane.

9. A system comprising: a cardiac valve repair implant comprising: a central occluder; and a frame extending proximally from and supporting the central occluder; and a delivery device comprising: a delivery catheter; a sheath extending around the delivery catheter and including a distal opening; and a control arm assembly releasably coupled to the cardiac valve repair implant and configured to selectively expand the frame of the cardiac valve repair implant, wherein: the sheath is translatable relative to the delivery catheter and control arm assembly from a distal position to a proximal position, and when the sheath is in the distal position, the central occluder protrudes from the distal opening and the frame is retained within the sheath.

10. The system of claim 9, wherein, when the sheath is in the proximal position, the frame is distal the distal opening of the sheath, thereby permitting the frame to expand.

11. The system of claim 9, wherein: the control arm assembly is translatable relative to the delivery catheter, and translation of the control arm assembly further translates the cardiac valve repair implant relative to the delivery catheter.

12. The system of claim 11, wherein, when the sheath is in the proximal position, the control arm assembly is translatable to dispose the frame distal the distal opening of the sheath, thereby permitting the frame to expand.

13. The system of claim 9, wherein the control arm assembly is selectively expandable between a collapsed state and an expanded state to selectively control expansion of the cardiac valve repair implant.

14. The system of claim 9, wherein: the delivery device further includes an extension member protruding from a distal end of the delivery catheter, the control arm assembly includes a control arm including a distal control arm portion coupled to and extending proximally from a distal end of the extension member and a proximal control arm portion coupled to a proximal portion of the distal control arm portion, the proximal control arm portion is extendable from the distal end of the delivery catheter by pushing the proximal control arm portion, and the control arm assembly is configured to expand in response to extending the proximal control arm portion.

15. The system of claim 9, wherein the central occluder includes a sheet of material disposed on a distal side of the frame.

16. The system of claim 15, wherein the sheet of material is formed from expanded polytetrafluoroethylene (ePTFE).

17. The system of claim 9, wherein the frame is self-biasing into an expanded state.

18. A method of repairing target cardiac valves, the method comprising: delivering an implant in a collapsed state into an atrium adjacent a target cardiac valve, wherein: the implant includes a central occluder and a frame extending proximally from the central occluder, delivering the implant includes transporting the implant using a delivery device having a sheath that is selectively retractable, and during delivery, the central occluder extends from a distal opening of the sheath while the frame is retained within the sheath; deploying the implant by each of retracting the sheath and transitioning the implant into an expanded state, wherein, when in the expanded state, the central occluder and the frame form an annular structure defining an inner circular opening centered about a central longitudinal axis of the central occluder; approaching the target cardiac valve with the implant in the expanded state; and positioning the central occluder in an orifice of the target cardiac valve and a distal side of the annular structure against an annular region of cardiac tissue surrounding the target cardiac valve such that the inner circular opening opens over the orifice of the target cardiac valve.

19. The method of claim 18, wherein: the delivery device further includes a delivery catheter, during delivering of the implant, the implant is supported at a distal end of the delivery catheter, and deploying the implant further includes distally translating the implant relative to the distal end of the delivery catheter.

20. The method of claim 18, wherein: the delivery device further includes a control arm assembly releasably coupled to the implant and configured to selectively expand the frame of the implant, and deploying the implant further includes expanding the control arm assembly to transition the implant into the expanded state.
